Right Order, Wrong Size: A Verified Reproduction of the Robotic World Model and the Uncertainty It Reports

Anonymous authors
Paper under double-blind review

Abstract

We rebuild the *Robotic World Model* (RWM; arXiv:2501.10100v1) and its uncertainty-aware follow-up (arXiv:2504.16680v1), matching the released code's outputs, losses and gradients. The base paper's central training claim reproduces under a rule committed in advance (seed 1): over 3 seeds, training on the model's own rollouts beats teacher forcing 4.61× at 368 steps, though not at one step on short windows. Retrained on fixed folds holding out each episode once (2,500 iterations, not 10,000), its direction **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS** (20 trajectories). At 368 steps RWM beats MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines built to our reading, all worse than predicting no change; matched only in size, the transformer is unresolved (PARTIAL). On accuracy alone, two shorter histories and both longer training forecasts beat the original's setting at our budget, no reading favouring it; trained longer, it passes each on some reading (post hoc): the ranking depends on training budget. Magnitudes rest on 4 held-out trajectories, 0.133% of the reference's data, one robot, gait and terrain. The follow-up's uncertainty gets the order right and the size wrong: ensemble disagreement correlates +0.605 with error but is 33.4× too small at 100 steps on training data. Predicted step size ranks error nearly as well over whole trajectories, worse on shorter units at 100 steps. Members share 89.15% of parameters; independent models are 2.03× better calibrated, still overconfident. The implemented loss provably drives the discarded per-member σ to zero. Per-horizon rescaling brings the released checkpoint's coverage within 10 points of nominal for disagreement at every horizon on training episodes left out of each fit; on episodes our ensembles never saw, only 17 of 36 cells. The released evaluation is one step stale; over all ten episodes this raises the checkpoint's short-horizon relative-L1 error. We train no policy: we bound what the uncertainty reports, not its cost.

1 Introduction

A world model that reports its own uncertainty is more useful than one that does not, and the uncertainty-aware Robotic World Model reports one. This paper asks what that number means, and the title gives the answer: it gets the order of the model's errors right and their size wrong.

We set out to reproduce the base paper: rebuild the proprioceptive dynamics model from scratch, check it against the released implementation, and test the central training claim, which holds at long horizons. The rebuild made a second question cheap to ask: *is the predicted σ calibrated?* Neither of the two the checkpoint emits is. On data it trained on, the per-member σ is too small by 1,827× at h = 1 to 20,669× at h = 368, by construction (§6.3), and the ensemble disagreement the method uses by 8.3× to 34.4×. The disagreement still ranks realised error, the use the method makes of it (§6.6).

This is a reproduction in the stronger sense: the contribution is not that the numbers came out the same, but what re-measuring the method reveals about where it is robust and where it is not. Three things distinguish it from a re-run of the authors' code. **We rebuilt rather than imported**, and matched the rebuild to the reference before any training (Appendix A), so a later discrepancy belongs to the method, not to our wiring. **Decision rules were committed to git before the data**, with timestamps a reader can check (§8, Figure 1); several returned verdicts against the original or could not settle the question, and we report each

(Appendix E). **We keep our withdrawn findings in the record.** The ledger keeps 24 superseded entries, each beside the evidence that withdrew it: nine claims withdrawn on evidence, eight framings withdrawn, and the rest early hypotheses closed as housekeeping (§8 and the supplementary `docs/BUILD_CHECKS.md`; every pre-registered rule, with its lead time and verdict, is in Appendix E). §9 gives the lessons in a form a practitioner can use without reading the rest.

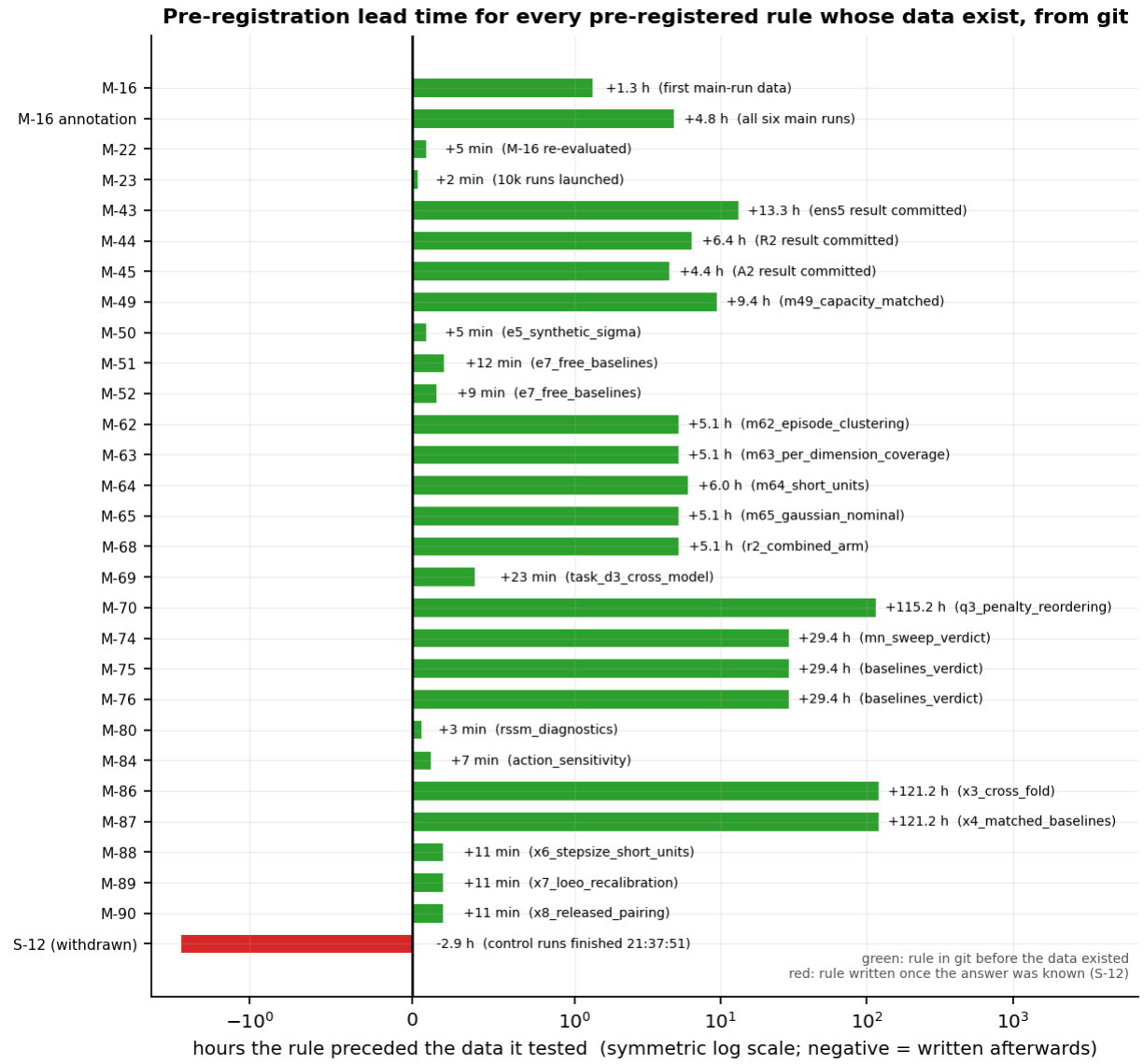


Figure 1: Pre-registration lead time for every pre-registered rule whose data exist (Appendix E), with M-16's annotation beside its rule, from git commit timestamps on a symmetric-logarithmic axis. Positive is a rule committed before the data that tested it existed; negative is a rule written afterwards. A lead of a few minutes means the rule was committed just before its runs were launched or its readings computed. The one negative bar, labelled the Task 3 duplication rule, is §7.4's duplication control, withdrawn as a pre-registration in this paper (§8).

Contributions.

- **The uncertainty gets the order right and the size wrong, in the first calibration measurement we are aware of for this released checkpoint** (Lu et al. (2022) measure this family

of penalties on models they train themselves; §2). Ensemble disagreement ranks realised error, correlating +0.419 with it with rollout and forecast depth held fixed, yet on data the checkpoint trained on it is 8.3× smaller than that error at h = 1 and 33.4× at h = 100 (§6.2, §6.6). It beats 1 of the 2 free baselines added here; the model's own predicted step size ranks error at +0.4697 against its +0.6053 over the 20 whole trajectories, a margin they cannot resolve at h = 368, while on 70 shorter units at h = 100 a rule committed before its reading finds disagreement ahead, +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896] (rule X6: **DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE**; §6.6, §11).

- **The base paper's central training claim reproduces, and reverses at one step.** A rule committed before the runs, run on seed 1 of each arm, found autoregressive training ahead by 4.43× at h = 368; 3 seeds at 10,000 iterations extend it: the factor is 4.61×, and 2.58× at h = 100, on the held-out pair's 4 independent 400-step trajectories (§5); retrained on fixed folds with each of the ten episodes held out once, the direction replicates, +2.2275 [+1.3683, +3.5053] at h = 368 over 20 trajectories at 2,500 iterations, not 10,000 (rule X3: **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS**). At one step a second pre-registered rule, on 60 independent 33-row units, finds a gap of -0.0194 [-0.0310, -0.0093] in favour of **teacher forcing** (§5).

- **Two more of the base paper's claims, tested under rules committed before the runs.** RWM is ahead at h = 368 of MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines built to our reading of its specification and trained with RWM's settings, whether teacher-forced as the original trains them or autoregressively, on the held-out pair's 4 independent trajectories at 2,500 iterations, though every baseline is worse there than predicting no change; matched to RWM's parameter count, the MLP stays behind and the transformer cannot be told apart (rule X4: **PARTIAL**; size is one axis), and neither reading our RSSM's forecast from its prior's expected or sampled latent nor retraining it with two other settings on one seed removes its open-loop collapse (rule X1, exploratory: **NOT RESCUED BY THE SETTINGS TRIED**; §5.3). On accuracy alone at our budget, four of the eight one-factor neighbours of the original's (M, N) = (32, 8) beat it, two shorter histories at under half its cost per iteration and both longer training forecasts at more (no reading the rule reports puts the centre ahead of any of them), but trained longer the centre passes each of them on at least one reading (post hoc), so the ranking depends on the training budget; the original chose the centre as a trade-off with training time, which its own printed hours are consistent with and we do not test (§5.2).

- **The $\sigma = 0$ optimum of the implemented objective.** The implemented state loss is minimised at $\sigma = 0$, so the per-member σ the method discards collapses by construction: derived, and demonstrated against known noise (§6.3).

- **Trunk-sharing, tested.** The five members share one trunk, one recurrent state and 89.15% of each member's parameters, so their spread can express only uncertainty the trunk already carries (§6.4). Under a rule committed before the runs, on the held-out pair's 4 independent trajectories, 5 independently initialised full models are 2.03× better calibrated than the shared-trunk arms, against a pre-registered minimum detectable effect of 1.45×, and still 5.2× overconfident at h = 100; they also differ in capacity and data order, so this bounds the sharing effect rather than isolating it (§6.8).

- **Per-horizon recalibration, with mixed evidence.** One multiplier per horizon, fitted on one episode and scored on the other, brings every released-checkpoint coverage estimate near nominal where a global one does not, though no single cell is resolvable and the cells are unseen only by the multiplier, since the checkpoint trained on both episodes (§6.7); on Arm A, which never saw them, its own multipliers manage 17 of 36 disagreement cells. Fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth, the disagreement's coverage over all 20 trajectories is within the band at every horizon (rule X7: **WITHIN BAND AT 6 OF 6 HORIZONS**), again on episodes the checkpoint trained on.

- **The released evaluation is misaligned by one step; over all ten episodes it raises the checkpoint's relative-L1 error up to h = 32, and from h = 100 the change is not resolved.** Evaluation feeds the action from *t−1* where training pairs states and actions index-for-index, and shifting its action index by one step fixes it. On all ten episodes' 20 independent trajectories, all of

them training data for this checkpoint, the stale action raises its relative-L1 error by 55.0% [26.3, 92.7] at h = 1 and 37.4% [21.3, 65.4] at h = 32, and changes it by 8.2% [-10.4, 24.9] at h = 100 and -4.6% [-13.4, 3.2] at h = 368; on the held-out pair's 4 it raises it at every horizon reported, by 7.9% [3.1, 13.0] at h = 368 (§7.2).

- **A from-scratch reimplementation verified at the gradient level.** Outputs match the released module bitwise, and losses and gradients match to 0.000e+00 across 7 loss terms and 106 parameter tensors, before any training (Appendix A).

2 Related work

This paper asks whether an ensemble-disagreement penalty is calibrated, and separates its use as a *ranking* from its use as a *scale*. Both questions have a literature, and one paper asked almost exactly ours four years earlier; below we say which parts of what follows are new. Supplementary S4 gives the rest of this section in full.

The direct precedent. Lu, Ball, Parker-Holder, Osborne and Roberts (*Revisiting Design Choices in Offline Model-Based Reinforcement Learning*, ICLR 2022) compare uncertainty heuristics in offline model-based RL under protocols built, in their words, to "capture the specific covariate shift induced by model-based RL", in order to assess calibration. They report Spearman rank and Pearson bivariate correlation against true model error **separately**, and observe that "despite the similar rank correlations ρ, the bivariate correlations r can vary considerably": a configuration can keep the ordering while the penalty's size relative to the error changes. That is our ranking-versus-scale distinction, on the same family of penalties. They also find the ensemble standard deviation, the exact quantity `system_dynamics.py:126` computes and `envs/base.py:166` applies, to track model error *better* than the penalties of MOPO and MOReL, being "strikingly similar" to the latter but better behaved; §6.6 finds the same quantity a usable ranking signal.

What is new here is four things. Lu et al. measure models they train themselves, on simulated benchmarks, and their statistics describe ordering and shape, not coverage. We measure a **released checkpoint** from a pipeline its authors deployed on hardware, where reading the penalty as an interval has consequences. We measure **coverage** against a nominal. We verify our reimplementation against the reference at the gradient level before any training (Appendix A). And §6.3 derives the $\sigma = 0$ optimum for the objective the released code *substitutes*, squared error on a reparameterised sample, rather than for the likelihood the parameterisation was built around.

Where the parameterisation comes from. The clamp of the bounded log-σ head whose optimum §6.3 shows is $\sigma = 0$ is inherited, line for line, from the probabilistic ensembles of Chua, Calandra, McAllister and Levine (PETS, NeurIPS 2018), but the objective is not: the released code replaces PETS's likelihood with squared error on a sampled prediction and ties the upper bound to the floor. So **a descendant of this lineage that made the same substitution, and left nothing pushing its variance floor back up, would inherit the same optimum**, a hypothesis about mechanism untested in any other descendant (§11). Of 13 public repositories the survey looked at, 10 carry the construction, the ones its protocol counts as examined, and 1 of those trains it against a sampled squared error, only in an optional mode, so on this sample of convenience the substitution is rare (Appendix I).

The method's family. MOPO (Yu et al., NeurIPS 2020) penalises the reward by an ensemble uncertainty estimate and MOReL (Kidambi et al., NeurIPS 2020) detects unknown states by pairwise ensemble disagreement, both branching short model rollouts from real states as MBPO (Janner et al., NeurIPS 2019) does. The follow-up we reproduce puts MOPO's penalty into MBPO's loop, which is what "MOPO-PPO" names.

What "ensemble" is supposed to mean. Deep ensembles (Lakshminarayanan, Pritzel and Blundell, NeurIPS 2017) are networks trained from *different random initialisations and different data orderings*, whereas the released checkpoint's five members share one GRU trunk, one recurrent hidden state and 89.15% of each member's state-prediction parameters (§6.4).

Three sources of uncertainty, and the one nobody here estimates. Abbas, Sokota, Talvitie and White (ICML 2020) separate aleatoric noise, parameter uncertainty and **model inadequacy**; the checkpoint we measure has no estimate of the third, the component that compounds with rollout depth (§6.5).

Why miscalibration is the expected finding. Networks are miscalibrated (Guo et al., ICML 2017), more so under covariate shift (Ovadia et al., NeurIPS 2019), and a rollout manufactures its own shift, increasing with depth, so our contribution on this axis is the *magnitude* and the *mechanism*, not the direction.

Recalibration. §6.7's per-horizon multiplier is a coarse instance of calibrated regression (Kuleshov, Fenner and Ermon, ICML 2018), and Malik et al. (ICML 2019) recalibrate a dynamics model's uncertainty inside model-based RL, arguing that "good uncertainties must be calibrated"; what §6.7 adds is the horizon index, and the finding that a single global multiplier **fails**.

§6.4's mechanism is known, and we say so. That heads sharing a trunk under-report disagreement is established (Lee et al., arXiv:1511.06314; Fort, Hu and Lakshminarayanan, arXiv:1912.02757; BatchEnsemble, ICLR 2020; MIMO, ICLR 2021). **What is ours is finding it in a released robotics checkpoint, with the sharing quantified at 89.15% of each member and its cost bounded by the 2.03× an independent ensemble gains (§6.8).**

And the objective in §6.3 has a neighbour. Seitzer, Tavakoli, Antic and Martius (ICLR 2022) identify failure modes of σ heads trained by maximising log-likelihood; the released state loss is not a log-likelihood at all, so the failure §6.3 derives is more basic than theirs.

3 Setup

Data. The released dataset is 10,000 rows of ANYmal D proprioceptive state and policy actions at 50 Hz: ten concatenated 20-second episodes, with a termination column that is identically zero, so nothing in the file marks the boundaries.

The segments are not all the same length. The first episode is 999 rows and the other nine are 1,000 each, with a reset at rows 999, 1,999 … 9,999 and 1 orphan row at the end of the file that begins an eleventh episode and ends immediately: $999 + 9 \times 1{,}000 + 1$. We recover the boundaries from the data: at every reset row the twelve joint velocities, the four HAA joint positions and all twelve actions are exactly zero, and no other row has that fingerprint. Ten equal segments of 1,000 would give one fewer crossing window and one more usable one, so the counts below differ by one from that reading; `results/step0_regimes.json` re-derives the crossing count from the segment lengths alone, and the two agree.

A window is 40 rows, 32 of history and 8 of forecast, and the reference window builder marks all 9,961 windows valid, including 352 that splice one episode's end onto the next one's start. The usable, episode-respecting count is 9,609: 10,000 rows, less 39 that cannot start a full window, less 352 that cross a boundary. The contamination rate is 3.53%.

Model. A GRU-based ensemble predicting the next proprioceptive state, with a mean head and a bounded log-σ head, plus auxiliary heads for contact and termination. The paper describes two loss terms; the implementation has 7. Before any training, our rebuild's outputs match the released module's bitwise, and its losses and gradients match to 0.000e+00 across those 7 terms and 106 parameter tensors (Appendix A).

Evaluation. Two arenas, kept separate throughout: *out-of-sample*, the two episodes withheld from training, and *in-sample*, the eight used for it. The released evaluation draws its trajectories from training data, and the original does not distinguish the two. **The released checkpoint trained on all ten episodes, so it has no held-out arena in this dataset**, and every figure for it is in-sample; later sections refer back to this as the in-sample caveat of §3. More data cannot be generated from either repository this reproduction pins (supplementary S1).

Effective sample size. Trajectory count is not sample size. Two 400-step trajectories whose spans overlap are not independent evidence, and the out-of-sample arena contains only 4 mutually non-overlapping 400-step trajectories. A bootstrap over whole trajectories at that size has 256 distinct resamples, so its intervals are quantised at that resolution. Every long-horizon verdict in this paper is computed with a bootstrap

over independent trajectories, every table reports that count, and §8 reports both resampling units where they differ. Later sections refer back to this as the n = 4 caveat of §3. One trajectory can carry much of a long-horizon effect: a one-step shift of the action moves the released checkpoint's 368-step relative-L1 error on single trajectories of its own training episodes by anywhere from -47.4% to +35.2% (§7.2), which illustrates why 4 trajectories bound every long-horizon claim.

3.1 Metrics

Each metric is stated as implemented, because a reader who cannot see the denominator cannot check the headline. Appendix G gives each metric's formula and the check on the coverage nominal.

Relative-L1 is the reference's own metric, reproduced in behaviour (`model_training.py:203`) so that our numbers are comparable to the upstream's printed one. At each forecast step it is the summed absolute error over the state dimensions divided by the summed absolute true state, on config-normalised states, averaged flat over trajectories and over the steps after the first 32, which are teacher-forced. The denominator, a 45-term sum in normalised space, is recomputed at every step, so it can pass through zero, which is why this metric goes non-finite on low-dimensional state groups and why a second one exists.

Normalised RMSE fixes the denominator once: the root of the squared error pooled over the state dimensions, divided by the dimensions' mean standard deviation over the training episodes only, a constant stored in `results/step4_0a_results.json` and never recomputed per step or derived from held-out data. A value of 1.0 means no better than predicting the training mean. **The aggregation is form 1**, a ratio of means; a mean of per-dimension ratios would give whichever dimension has the smallest scale unbounded leverage (Appendix G).

Coverage at $\pm\mathbf{k}\sigma$ is the fraction of (trajectory, forecast step, state dimension) triples, pooled with equal weight, whose absolute error falls within k times the σ predicted for that triple. It is two-sided, so its calibrated targets are **68.27%** at $\pm1\sigma$ and **95.45%** at $\pm2\sigma$.

The overconfidence factor ρ is the mean absolute error over the mean predicted σ, a ratio of means. $\rho = 1$ is *not* calibration, since a calibrated Gaussian has $\rho = \sqrt{2/\pi} = 0.7979$, so ρ is reported as a magnitude of miscalibration and coverage as the calibrated reading.

Which metric each headline uses. The A/B training claim (§5) is relative-L1, because the claim is about reproducing the upstream's comparison and that is the upstream's metric. The calibration claims (§6.2) are the overconfidence factor and coverage, because neither error metric involves σ. The ranking claims (§6.6) are Pearson correlations between the applied scalar penalty and total absolute error, because a ranking claim is about order rather than scale. Every headline number in the abstract names its metric. §7.2's alignment defect is given in both metrics, over all ten episodes and on the held-out pair. Over all ten episodes the two metrics agree that the stale action raises error at h = 8 and 32 and that from h = 100 the change is not resolved, and they differ at h = 1, where relative-L1 resolves the rise and nRMSE does not.

Horizons. Curves are reported at $h \in \{1, 8, 32, 100, 128, 368\}$. Every horizon-indexed quantity is cumulative over steps 1..h, not the value at step h. Two of those are load-bearing and the rest are landmarks. **h = 100** is the method's own imagination rollout length, the horizon over which the uncertainty-penalised policy loop actually runs this model (arXiv:2504.16680 Table S9 in v1 and Table S11 in v3, with the same value). **h = 368** is the upstream's open-loop diagnostic length: `len_eval_trajectory` = 400 minus the 32-step teacher-forced prefix, the curve the follow-up plots as its uncertainty figure. It is 3.68× the method's own rollout length and is not a deployment horizon. Every table keeps both: h = 368 makes our numbers comparable to the original's *figure*, and h = 100 to its *method*.

3.2 What each claim rests on

Every headline claim in this paper is measured on the out-of-sample or in-sample arena above, or on all ten episodes together, at a stated number of independent units (400-step trajectories unless the row says otherwise). Each is also at a stated checkpoint: the released one, or ours at a stated number of training iterations. Appendix D's second table, "What each tested claim rests on", gives each claim's arena, sample

size, checkpoint and verdict. It is generated from the artifacts each claim is computed from, so no arena label, sample size or checkpoint in it is typed by hand.

4 What the original papers claim, and which claims we test

A reproduction that does not say what it left alone invites the reader to assume it tested everything. It did not.

We tested six claims and left six untested. The six are the base paper's autoregressive-versus-teacher-forcing comparison and its claim that teacher forcing generalises poorly (§5), its configuration claim (§5.2) and its claim against MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines (§5.3), and the follow-up's two claims about what its uncertainty outputs report (§6). **Every one of the six we did not test needs a simulator or hardware we do not have**: zero-shot transfer, the sample-efficiency result, the comparisons against SHAC and Dreamer, generality across robot morphologies, offline MBRL on real robots and the core claim that penalising rewards by disagreement improves the learned policy. **Five of them are claims about policy learning or hardware** — every one but generality across robot morphologies, which needs a simulator and recorded data from other robots but is a claim about the model rather than about a policy. This work trains no policy and runs on two CPU cores. The counts and lists are generated from the classification tags in the verdict column of Appendix D's first table, so none of them is typed. §11 states what the untested claims bound, and supplementary S1 what testing them would take.

For four of the six claims we tested, the original reports no quantitative figure. Each is asserted qualitatively and shown in a plot, with no number in text, caption or table; §6.6's coefficient is the first figure attached to the follow-up's "strong correlation" between disagreement and error. The exceptions are the configuration claim and the teacher-forcing claim, whose values one heatmap prints in every cell (§5.2). Appendix L sets its teacher-forcing cell beside ours, which uses a different definition of teacher forcing. Where a magnitude is legible only from a plotted curve we say so rather than estimating it from the axis.

Appendix D's first table gives it in full, claim by claim, with what the original states, where it states it, and our verdict.

5 The base paper's central claim reproduces

Claim under test. Training the dynamics model on its own autoregressive rollouts beats training it with teacher forcing, at long forecast horizons.

Rule, committed in advance (rule M-23; Appendix E gives its commit and lead time), naming conditions rather than outcomes. Three conditions, all required: the out-of-sample gap at $h = 368$ excludes zero under a bootstrap over independent trajectories; the sign is consistent across episodes; and the effect survives at 10,000 iterations rather than only at the paper's 2,500. The rule was run on seed 1 of each arm: autoregressive 0.3509 against teacher forcing 1.5540 at $h = 368$, 4.43×, gap interval [0.56, 2.05]. The 10,000-iteration runs of seeds 0 and 2 were trained after the verdict (the ledger records them on 2026-08-22), so the three-seed figures below extend it and carry none of its weight. The rule is anchored at $h = 368$, the upstream's **open-loop diagnostic** length and not a deployment horizon (§3.1), and its verdict is returned there; we do not re-anchor a discharged rule. The method's own horizon is $h = 100$, so the comparison is reported there too, and the two differ in size.

Result. Every condition holds. We give the evidence in order of how little it depends on the small held-out sample.

The sign test, which does not depend on n. At $h = 368$ the per-episode gap favours autoregressive training on **10 of 10** episodes, an exact two-sided binomial test with $p = \mathbf{0.0020}$. At $h = 100$ it is **10 of 10**, $p = \mathbf{0.0020}$, and at $h = 1$ it is 3 of 10, the same story the interval tells. It uses no bootstrap or multiplicity correction, and episodes, unlike §6's state dimensions, are separable units, so a binomial null is admissible. **Its scope is narrower than the arena labels suggest**: 8 of the 10 episodes are training data for *both* arms. The test is a valid **paired** comparison, since both arms saw identical data and an episode-level difference is due to

the training rule rather than to memorisation, but it is not ten out-of-sample episodes and does not measure generalisation. The out-of-sample effect size below carries that burden, on 4 independent trajectories.

The in-sample arena, where the sample is larger. The same comparison on the eight training episodes has 16 independent 400-step trajectories against the held-out arena's 4, 4× more. It gives the same direction at every horizon and checkpoint but one: at h = 8 after 500 iterations teacher forcing leads in-sample, with an interval that excludes zero at both trajectory lengths (`results/review_bootstrap_unit.json`).

The out-of-sample effect size, at every horizon. At h = 368, the rule's horizon, the three-seed extension puts autoregressive training at **0.3582 ± 0.0283** against teacher forcing's **1.6497 ± 0.2858** (standard deviation over seeds, `ddof=1`), a factor of **4.61**×. Arm B predicts each of the window's 8 forecast targets from true inputs, where the original's teacher forcing is $N = 1$, and the direction holds under both definitions (Appendix L). At h = 100, the method's own imagination rollout length and the horizon everything in §6 is anchored to, the same three seeds give **2.58**×. Quoting one and not the other would be a choice, so we report the curve (Figure 2): same rollouts, same 3 seeds at 10,000 training iterations, same held-out arena, n_independent = 4, with a cluster bootstrap over whole trajectories. The two floor columns are each arm's error divided by the hold-last floor's, so a value below one beats the floor:

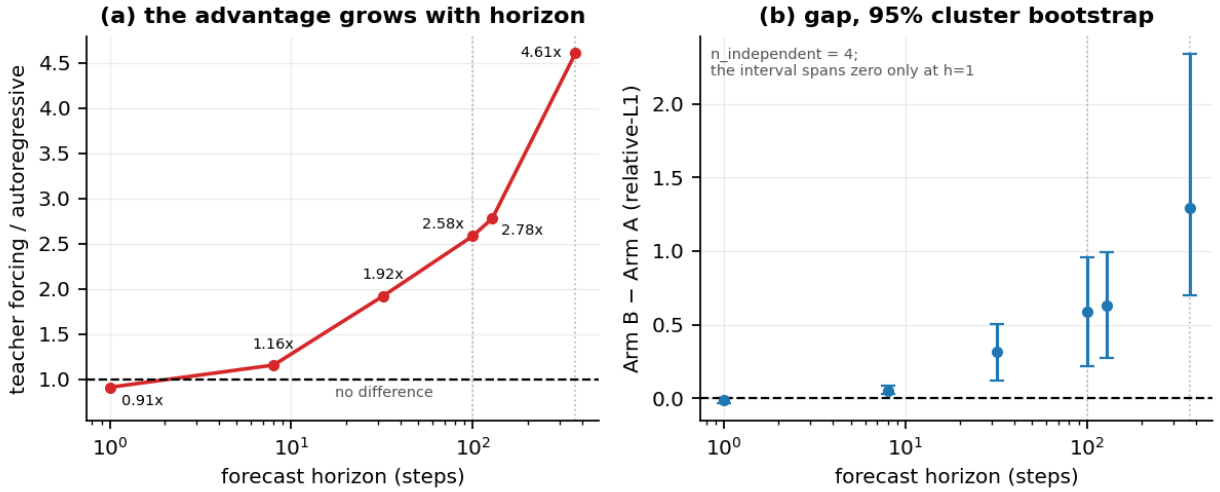


Figure 2: The autoregressive-versus-teacher-forcing advantage as a function of forecast horizon, out-of-sample over three seeds at 10,000 training iterations, on the held-out pair's 4 independent 400-step trajectories. (a) the ratio, which grows monotonically with depth: h = 368 is the end of a trend rather than a selected point, and the method's own rollout length of h = 100 sits partway along it. (b) the same comparison as a gap with its 95% cluster-bootstrap interval over whole trajectories; the interval spans zero only at h = 1, where teacher forcing is ahead – a lead a shorter evaluation unit resolves as real, not nominal (§5, M-64). Rule M-23 was run at h = 368 on seed 1 of each arm; these three-seed values, and every other horizon, were computed afterwards.

h	autoregressive	teacher forcing	ratio	gap [95% CI]	excludes 0	hold-last floor	A ÷ floor	B ÷ floor	episodes A leads
1	0.1447 ± 0.0023	0.1319 ± 0.0172	0.91×	-0.0128 [-0.0329, +0.0013]	**no**	0.0796	1.82×	1.66×	3/10
8	0.3087 ± 0.0318	0.3572 ± 0.0088	1.16×	+0.0485 [+0.0271, +0.0844]	yes	0.3298	0.94×	1.08×	10/10
32	0.3415 ± 0.0491	0.6555 ± 0.0699	1.92×	+0.3140 [+0.1233, +0.5047]	yes	0.5950	0.57×	1.10×	10/10
100	**0.3700 ± 0.0290**	**0.9561 ± 0.0211**	**2.58**×	**+0.5861 [+0.2174, +0.9547]**	**yes**	0.7558	**0.49**×	**1.27**×	**10/10**
128	0.3558 ± 0.0231	0.9881 ± 0.0376	2.78×	+0.6324 [+0.2716, +0.9931]	yes	0.7999	0.44×	1.24×	10/10
368 *(the rule's horizon)*	**0.3582 ± 0.0283**	**1.6497 ± 0.2858**	**4.61**×	**+1.2915 [+0.7004, +2.3390]**	**yes**	0.9930	**0.36**×	**1.66**×	**10/10**

The advantage does grow monotonically with forecast depth. Over 400-step trajectories the gap excludes zero at 5 of 6 horizons and spans it at h=1. So h = 368 is the end of a trend rather than a point we picked, h = 100 sits partway along it, and the claim is weakest inside the horizon the model is trained on. **Only the h = 368 row is the rule's horizon, and the rule ran on seed 1 alone.** Every value in

the table is a three-seed mean computed after the data existed, so by this paper's own standard (§8) none carries a pre-registration's weight. That is the same treatment §6.6 gives the expectation we held about the counter-baseline, and nothing in the table discharges or re-opens the rule. Teacher forcing is more than twice as variable across seeds as autoregressive training at h = 368, so a single-seed comparison of these two arms is unreliable; Appendix L gives the seed spread and the four per-trajectory gaps, 4 of 4 positive.

At h = 1 the table understates the evidence, and the correction runs against us. The row rests on 4 independent 400-step trajectories, a unit only the longest horizon needs. Under a rule committed before the index was built (rule M-64, Appendix E), we rebuilt it at 33 rows, 32 of history and one forecast step, non-overlapping within an episode: 60 units on the same two episodes. The gap is -0.0194 [-0.0310, -0.0093]: it **excludes zero, in favour of teacher forcing** (0.85×). Both readings are reported: the rule above was discharged on the 400-step unit, and the short unit resolves the sign. At one step **autoregressive training is worse**, the direction the sign test and, on the 400-step unit, the hold-last floor already pointed.

Against a baseline, because neither number means anything without one. The hold-last floor, predicting that nothing changes, scores **0.9930** at h = 368, where autoregressive training beats it by **2.8**× (2.0× at h = 100) and **teacher forcing is 1.66× worse than assuming nothing changes at all** (1.27× at h = 100). Those are 400-step units, on which the floor beats teacher forcing at every horizon and the autoregressive arm at h=1. On M-64's shorter units teacher forcing beats the floor at h = 1, 8, 32 and 100, and both arms beat it at h = 1 (Appendix L).

What is small, and where it resolves. At h = 8, the horizon the model is trained on, the advantage is small: the table's 10,000-iteration gap there excludes zero only with all 3 seeds pooled. At the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints the out-of-sample gap excludes zero in **0 of 4** h = 8 cells, and an earlier rule anchored there (rule M-16) returned **CANNOT BE SETTLED AT THIS BUDGET**. **The advantage is small at the training horizon and large beyond it**: at long horizons the out-of-sample gap excludes zero in **4 of 4** cells at those checkpoints, each still excluding it after correction for the family of 8 comparisons. Appendix L sets these cells and our arms beside the released checkpoint they reimplement.

Held out in turn, every episode tests the claim out of sample once. The 4 trajectories above are one fold. Both arms were trained on four more such splits, fixed in advance, so that each episode is held out in exactly one of five (rule X3, committed before the runs; 2,500 iterations, 3 seeds). Over the 20 independent out-of-sample trajectories of all ten episodes, the gap at h = 368 is +2.2275 [+1.3683, +3.5053], favouring autoregressive training: **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS**. All 10 of the 10 episodes favour it (P = 0.002), and every fold's own interval excludes zero, its gap running from +0.6554 to +3.9828 (Appendix L). At one step teacher forcing still leads on short units, -0.0090 [-0.0126, -0.0053] over 300 33-row units. These are 2,500-iteration models, not the 10,000-iteration ones behind the factor above, which X3 does not re-read; its interval resamples trajectories, carrying every seed, and its folds pair episodes in index order rather than by speed. The 4 trajectories of §5's arena are no longer the only out-of-sample evidence.

5.1 The data budget, which is the one part of the sample-efficiency claim we can measure

The base paper's headline is a sample-efficiency result about policy learning and hardware, which we cannot test, but its *world-model* half is a quantity we can count exactly: **our arms consume 7,991 distinct state transitions, 751× less data than the reference's 6,000,000, 0.133% of its world-model budget**. On that budget the training result above still reproduces. Appendix L gives the count and its three limits, the first being that this is not the policy-learning comparison.

5.2 The configuration claim: history and forecast horizons

Claim under test. The model reads a history of M past steps and, in training, forecasts the next N steps from its own predictions. The base paper sweeps both and says that moderate values give an optimal trade-off between accuracy and training time, with (M, N) = (32, 8) as the instance (§IV-C). Its heatmap prints the error of every cell, and the centre's is the tied-lowest, level with its longest-forecast neighbour (`docs/presubmission/ORIGINAL_SPECS.md` a.5). Its second heatmap prints training hours: 1.07 for the centre and 2.27 for (32, 32), 2.12×, so on the original's own figures the centre matches that neighbour's printed error,

0.47, in under half the time. Our measured cost per iteration for the same pair is 1.81× (the table's last column).

Rule, committed in advance (rule M-74, Appendix E). It tests the accuracy half only: whether the centre has the lowest error among its eight one-factor neighbours in the original's grid, M of 1, 2, 8 and 16 at the centre's N and N of 1, 2, 16 and 32 at its M. Each is trained as Arm A is, for 2,500 iterations on three seeds. The statistic is a configuration's relative-L1 at h = 368 minus the centre's, averaged over trajectories and tested by an exact bootstrap over trajectories, with Holm's correction holding the chance of any false "better" in the family at $\alpha = 0.05$. Training time is reported and governs nothing: hours on two CPU cores are not what the original timed on a GPU.

(M, N)	relative-L1, h = 100	relative-L1, h = 368	difference from the centre [95% interval]	result	cost per iteration, relative to the centre
(32, 8), the centre	0.4798	**0.5856**	—	—	1.00
(1, 8)	0.3796	0.5340	-0.0516 [-0.1835, +0.0400]	not resolved	0.23
(2, 8)	0.3524	0.4717	-0.1139 [-0.2988, -0.0088]	**configuration better**	0.26
(8, 8)	0.4043	0.4852	-0.1004 [-0.2449, -0.0167]	**configuration better**	0.40
(16, 8)	0.4467	0.6161	+0.0305 [-0.0008, +0.0720]	not resolved	0.60
(32, 1)	1.0903	3.7198	+3.1342 [+1.3012, +6.5096]	centre better	0.81
(32, 2)	0.8886	2.0374	+1.4518 [+0.6250, +2.6933]	centre better	0.95
(32, 16)	0.3544	0.3347	-0.2509 [-0.5218, -0.0956]	**configuration better**	1.35
(32, 32)	0.3348	0.2987	-0.2869 [-0.5951, -0.1005]	**configuration better**	1.81

Arena: out-of-sample held-out pair, episodes 1 and 8, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 4. Each row is the mean over three seeds at 2,500 iterations (`results/mn_sweep_eval.json`). A difference is positive when the centre is better, and "result" is after Holm (`results/mn_sweep_verdict.json`). The last column is a configuration's steady training time per iteration over the centre's, timed without contention (`results/mn_compute_matched.json`); hours per run, and the 8 of 24 sweep runs that overlapped other logged CPU work, are in Appendix B. The hold-last floor is 0.7558 at h = 100 and 0.9930 at h = 368. The nRMSE readings quoted alongside the rules here and in §5.3 are pooled as §3.1 defines it, recomputed afterwards (post hoc; Appendix U).

Result: NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET. (32, 32), (32, 16), (8, 8) and (2, 8) beat the centre (two shorter histories and both longer training forecasts), (32, 2) and (32, 1) are worse, and (1, 8) and (16, 8) cannot be told apart from it. At h = 368 the lowest error is (32, 32)'s, 0.2987 against the centre's 0.5856, a difference of -0.2869 [-0.5951, -0.1005]. The verdict does not rest on the anchor: on the in-sample arena's 16 independent 400-step trajectories, all four readings there return the same verdict, and among the held-out readings the rule reports alongside, every one agrees except nRMSE at h = 1, which returns CANNOT BE DISTINGUISHED. Per configuration, no reading puts the centre ahead of any of the four winners, though several leave a winner unresolved: all four at h = 1 on the held-out pair in both metrics, the two longer forecasts also at h = 8, and (2, 8) on held-out nRMSE at h = 368, (8, 8) on in-sample relative-L1 at h = 368 and (32, 32) on in-sample nRMSE at h = 100. Per episode, the centre is ahead of (2, 8) on 1 and of (8, 8) on 2 of the ten, and of neither other winner on any.

At our budget, shorter histories win. The original's error falls steeply from M = 1 to M = 8 and then flattens (`ORIGINAL_SPECS.md` a.5). On the governing reading ours does not fall steeply: (2, 8) and (8, 8), histories shorter than the centre's, beat it, and no shorter history is resolvably worse. Other readings the rule reports, though, put shorter histories behind it: (1, 8) on in-sample relative-L1 and nRMSE at h = 368, and (16, 8) on held-out nRMSE at h = 368. That is a statement about learning speed at this budget, not about converged accuracy: trained four times as long, the centre passes both winning shorter histories on three of the four readings (Appendix U). So it does not contradict the original's steep fall to M = 8, whose training budget the original does not state. The original's direction on N holds: the shortest forecasts are far worse, which is §5's teacher-forcing result again, and the longest are better, so the centre's tie with its longest-forecast neighbour becomes a loss.

Accuracy at equal compute (post hoc). The shorter histories that win cost less per iteration than the centre, 0.40× for (8, 8) and 0.26× for (2, 8), so their wins at 2,500 iterations need no compute correction. The longer forecasts' wins do. Trained to 5,000 iterations, 1.11× the computation of (32, 32), the centre splits the readings with it; trained to 10,000, 2.21× its computation, it is ahead on both in-sample readings

and neither held-out difference is resolved. Which setting is most accurate therefore depends on how long each is trained (Appendix U gives every reading); none of this re-opens rule M-74.

Limits. One factor is varied at a time, so no interaction between M and N is tested. Our data budget is 0.133% of the reference's (§5.1), and the original states neither the ablation's budget, its evaluation data nor the horizon behind its error, so the verdict holds at our budget and no further: a larger one may favour a longer history. All 48 runs at 2,500 iterations are still lowering their training loss at the end (post hoc; Appendix U), so the ranking is at this budget, not at convergence, and it changes with training length. With 4 independent trajectories, the rule's minimum detectable effect at h = 368, the difference its first Holm step would usually detect, is about 14.5% of the centre's error.

5.3 The architecture claim: MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines

Claim under test. The base paper compares RWM with three **architecture baselines**: other network designs trained on the same data to make the same predictions. They are a multilayer perceptron (MLP) over a flattened window of history; a recurrent state-space model (RSSM; Hafner et al., ICML 2019), in the form DreamerV2 refined (Hafner et al., ICLR 2021); and a decoder-only transformer. It says RWM "consistently achieves the lowest prediction errors across all environments" (§IV-D), gives no number (Fig. 7), and trains the baselines teacher-forced.

What we built. The pinned upstream code has an MLP but no RSSM or transformer, so all three are ours, the MLP following the upstream one. They follow the shapes in the original's Table S7 as we read it, with 610,484 (MLP), 3,180,468 (RSSM) and 132,148 (transformer) parameters against RWM's 714,164. Where the table is silent they take RWM's data, windows, objective, optimiser, iterations and seeds, and the RSSM takes its latent, activation and KL settings from DreamerV2. Each choice is a row of `docs/presubmission/BASELINE_SPECS.md`. Only the predicted state is compared.

Two rules, committed in advance (M-75 and M-76, Appendix E). M-75 trains the baselines teacher-forced, as the original does. M-76 trains them autoregressively, as RWM is, so that training rule and architecture are not confounded. Both take Arm A at 2,500 iterations as RWM and test each baseline's relative-L1 at h = 368 against it, on §5.2's arena with §5.2's bootstrap and Holm correction.

model	parameters	relative-L1, h = 100	relative-L1, h = 368	difference from RWM [95% interval]	result	cost per iteration, relative to RWM
RWM (Arm A, autoregressive)	714,164	0.4798	**0.5856**	—	—	1.00
MLP, teacher-forced †	610,484	1.2057	145.1650	+144.5794 [+14.8420, +373.9553]	RWM better	0.07
RSSM, teacher-forced	3,180,468	2.2128	6.3718	+5.7862 [+2.6251, +10.8616]	RWM better	2.37
transformer, teacher-forced †	132,148	2.0607	15.1548	+14.5692 [+8.7931, +24.0102]	RWM better	0.91
MLP, autoregressive	610,484	0.5400	1.4628	+0.8772 [+0.4248, +1.5662]	RWM better	0.08
RSSM, autoregressive †	3,180,468	3.2660	10.6405	+10.0549 [+5.7436, +18.1659]	RWM better	1.99
transformer, autoregressive	132,148	0.5821	1.8771	+1.2915 [+0.7258, +1.8079]	RWM better	0.97
MLP, autoregressive, size-matched (X4)	713,171	0.5893	1.4696	+0.8840 [+0.2036, +1.6334]	RWM better	—
transformer, autoregressive, size-matched (X4)	686,196	0.5846	0.7911	+0.2055 [-0.0969, +0.7399]	CANNOT BE SETTLED	—

Arena as in §5.2: out-of-sample held-out pair, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 4. Each row is the mean over three seeds at 2,500 iterations (`results/baselines_eval.json`). A difference is positive when RWM is better, and "result" is after Holm (`results/baselines_verdict.json`). The last column is timed beside RWM in one sitting (`results/mn_compute_matched.json`); hours per run are in Appendix B. † marks a diverged row, whose mean run-away rollouts dominate; no verdict depends on that magnitude, only on the sign, which favours RWM on every trajectory (Appendix L). The two size-matched rows (rule X4) are trained autoregressively for 2,500 iterations on three seeds and scored on the same arena (`results/x4_matched_baselines.json`); they were not timed in that sitting, so their last cell is empty.

Result: REPRODUCES with the baselines teacher-forced, and RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE with them trained autoregressively. RWM is ahead of baselines built to our reading of Table S7 and trained with RWM's settings for 2,500 iterations: all six comparisons favour it, with intervals that exclude zero. That says less than it seems at h = 368, where every baseline row, in both regimes, is above the hold-last floor and RWM is below it: no baseline beats predicting no change. The second verdict compares architectures at one training regime and is not a verdict on the original's claim, which the first carries. The lead is a long-horizon one, and the rules' relative-L1 readings at other horizons on the held-out

pair say where it starts. Teacher-forced, the baselines fall resolvably behind from h = 32 (the transformer from h = 8). Trained autoregressively, the RSSM falls behind from h = 8, but the MLP and the transformer only from h = 100, the method's own horizon, where they trail by 0.060 [0.024, 0.096], about 12.5% of RWM's 0.4798, and 0.102 [0.034, 0.185]. Before those horizons, on the held-out pair, a baseline cannot be told apart from RWM: at h = 1 both rules return CANNOT BE SETTLED, and at h = 8 both return PARTIAL. Post hoc, with nRMSE pooled as §3.1 defines it, two in-sample readings differ from the per-trajectory average the rules' evaluator used. Teacher-forced, all three baselines lead RWM at h = 1 (M-75's reading there becomes DOES NOT REPRODUCE, from CANNOT BE SETTLED), the same one-step lead for teacher forcing as §5's. Trained autoregressively, the MLP's deficit at h = 100 is no longer resolved (PARTIAL, from RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE; Appendix L). Neither changes a verdict; both rules govern at h = 368 on relative-L1.

Our RSSM is not an informative comparison. Teacher-forced, it has collapsed open-loop by h = 32 (1.0182 against the floor's 0.5950), and trained autoregressively it does not perform comparably to RWM, as the original says an RSSM does (10.6405 against 0.5856 at h = 368). A diagnostic committed before its readings existed (rule X1, exploratory; it re-opens neither rule) returns **NOT EVALUATION-LIMITED** for its Part A, which reads the forecast from other latents, and **NOT RESCUED BY THE SETTINGS TRIED** for its Part C, which retrains the model. The failure may still be our RSSM rather than the architecture (Appendix L), so the architecture claim rests on the MLP and the transformer.

Limits. One robot on flat ground; the original has several environments. The baselines are our reading of a table that fixes their shapes and nothing else. Their loss, optimiser and budget are RWM's, not tuned for them. Their sizes are Table S7's. Matched to RWM's parameter count instead (rule X4, committed before the runs; the table's last two rows), the autoregressive MLP and transformer return **PARTIAL**. At h = 368 the MLP trails RWM by 0.884 [0.204, 1.633] (RWM BETTER), and the transformer's 0.206 [-0.097, 0.740] cannot be settled (p = 0.625; CANNOT BE SETTLED), as at h = 100 and h = 32, which return PARTIAL too. Matching the parameter count is one axis; the shapes and settings stay our reading of Table S7, and the size-matched RSSM was not run. With 4 independent trajectories, the minimum detectable effect at h = 368 is about 12.0% of RWM's error, well below every difference here.

6 Neither of the checkpoint's uncertainty outputs is usable as an interval

How this section runs. §6.1–§6.2 settle which quantity the method uses and measure it; §6.3–§6.4 examine why each output fails; §6.5–§6.6 separate the magnitude of the failure from its ordering, and test the ordering against free baselines; §6.7–§6.8 ask what would fix it.

6.1 Which quantity the method actually uses

The released checkpoint emits **two** uncertainty quantities, and the method consumes only one of them. This has to be settled before any calibration number means anything.

`system_dynamics.py:125` computes an **aleatoric** term, the mean over ensemble members of each member's predicted σ. `system_dynamics.py:126` computes an **epistemic** term, the standard deviation across the members' mean predictions. In `envs/base.py:142` the aleatoric term is bound to a local variable that is never read again; the epistemic term is stored, returned to the policy loop at `:158`, and applied at `:166` as a reward penalty with weight -1.0.

The paper agrees with its code. arXiv:2504.16680**v1** Eq. 4 defines the penalised quantity as $u = \mathrm{Var}_b[\mu_b]$, the variance across ensemble members (the numbering is unchanged in the current v3), and Eq. 5 applies it as $\tilde{r} = r - \lambda u$. The per-member predicted variance enters the training objective and nothing downstream.

Eq. 4 specifies a **variance** where `system_dynamics.py:126` computes a **standard deviation**, which with $\lambda = 1$ differ by a square. The first author confirms that the code's quantity is the intended one, and that the aleatoric term is reported for analysis and never used downstream (personal communication, quoted with the first author's permission; Appendix H gives the exchange). We measure the code's quantity throughout. So the discard is the intended design, not an implementation slip. We report both quantities below. Our

own arms are ensemble size 1, where the epistemic term is identically zero by construction, so the epistemic measurement is possible only on the released checkpoint.

What the follow-up does and does not claim. It does not claim its uncertainty is a calibrated interval. Its §5.1 claims the epistemic term "closely follows the trend of the prediction error" and that this "justifies its role as a trust metric", and of the aleatoric term it observes only that it "remains low, reflecting small stochasticity in the environment". Our measurement **supports the first claim**: the epistemic ordering is real (§6.6), though weaker per dimension than it looks (§6.5). What follows is therefore not a refutation of a calibration claim nobody made, but three things the papers do not address: that the aleatoric head is discarded before use, that neither quantity is usable as a scale, and that the low aleatoric value has a different cause than the one offered.

6.2 The measurement

For each model we compute the mean predicted σ, the mean absolute realised error, and the fraction of realised errors falling inside $\pm 1\sigma$. A calibrated Gaussian puts 68.27% inside $\pm 1\sigma$ (§3.1).

On the held-out pair, the only arena on which our arms can be scored fairly (n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories), every model's aleatoric head is overconfident by between one and four orders of magnitude over the whole 368-step rollout (Figure 3; Appendix M gives the four models' table); for the released checkpoint that arena is in-sample (the in-sample caveat of §3). That is the quantity §6.1 shows the method discards.

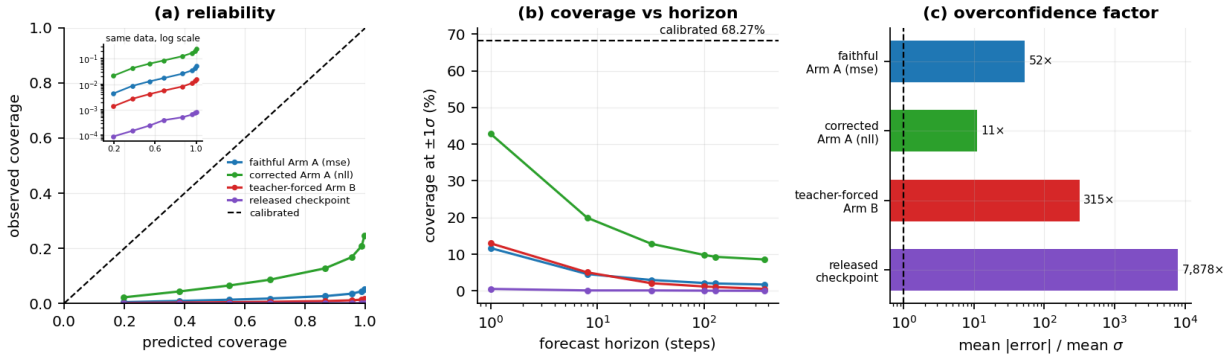


Figure 3: Calibration of all four models on the held-out pair's 4 independent 400-step trajectories, our arms at 2,500 training iterations. The released checkpoint trained on these episodes, so for it this arena is in-sample (§3). (a) reliability: observed against predicted coverage, with the calibrated diagonal; the inset repeats the same points with observed coverage on a log scale, where the four models separate. (b) coverage at $\pm 1\sigma$ against forecast horizon, log scale, against the 68.27% a calibrated Gaussian gives. Every curve sits far below the diagonal and falls further with horizon. (c) the overconfidence factor for each model: mean absolute error divided by mean predicted σ, log scale, with the dashed line where error equals σ.

The quantity the method does use is also uncalibrated. It is measured on the released 5-member checkpoint over all 10 episodes, at n_independent = **20** non-overlapping 400-step trajectories. The checkpoint trained on all ten, so restricting it to the held-out pair would buy no independence and cost four fifths of the sample; Appendix M compares that version with this one.

h	aleatoric err/σ [95% CI]	aleatoric $\pm 1\sigma$	epistemic err/σ [95% CI]	epistemic $\pm 1\sigma$ [95% CI]	epistemic $\pm 2\sigma$	dims r>0	permutation P
1	1,827× [915, 3,110]	0.11%	**8.3**× [6.1, 9.7]	16.22% [13.44, 18.89]	30.11%	44/45	0.0056
100	11,683× [7,970, 15,846]	0.04%	**33.4**× [28.7, 39.0]	4.61% [4.12, 5.09]	9.27%	45/45	0.2769

The $h = 1$ and $h = 100$ rows; Appendix M gives every horizon. No permutation P in the arena survives Holm–Bonferroni, so that column is a consistency check on direction only.

Read the h = 1 row first. At one step the disagreement the method penalises rewards with is already **8.3**× **[6.1, 9.7]** smaller than realised error, with $\pm 1\sigma$ coverage of 16.22% [13.44, 18.89] against a calibrated 68.27%. The discarded per-member σ is 1,827× out at h = 1 as well. Everything further down the table is deterioration from a starting point that is already broken.

Why that row, and not the deep ones. The obvious objection is that a per-step σ is a *conditional* quantity: it says how uncertain the next state is given this input, and in an open-loop rollout the input is the model's own previous output, wrong by an amount σ never claimed to describe. Comparing it with *accumulated* rollout error would then make the 368-step figure an artifact of that mismatch. (§6.5 answers a different objection, that a model trained on 8 steps cannot be expected to speak about 368.) **h = 1 answers it at no extra cost.** At one step there is no accumulation: the input *is* the true state, and σ is asked exactly the question it was trained to answer, and the row above is its answer: whatever compounding does at depth, it did not produce that row.

And that row is measured on data the checkpoint trained on: all ten episodes, 10 of 10 of them (`results/insample_framing.json`). In-sample measurement biases *toward* better calibration, so the 8.3× at h = 1 is if anything flattering: an upper bound on how well this checkpoint is calibrated. So the horizon curve is not the claim; it is the shape of the deterioration, and the claim is the h = 1 row. We keep h = 100 because it is where the method actually deploys, and h = 368 because it is the upstream's own diagnostic length.

At h = 100, the method's own imagination rollout length, epistemic is 349× better than aleatoric and still wrong by **33.4**× **[28.7, 39.0]**, with $\pm 1\sigma$ coverage of 4.61% [4.12, 5.09] where a calibrated Gaussian gives 68.27%. At one step epistemic is 220× better than aleatoric, and at h = 368 600×. **The gap between the two uncertainty terms is itself horizon-dependent, which is why each figure above names its horizon.** At the open-loop diagnostic horizon of h = 368 it is 34.4× [29.8, 40.3] with 3.59% coverage, barely different from h = 100. **Total** uncertainty, $\texttt{sqrt(aleatoric}^2 \texttt{ + epistemic}^2\texttt{)}$, equals the epistemic value to four significant figures at every horizon, because the aleatoric term is too small to move it.

A constant scale error would not matter, and this one is not constant. The penalty enters as $\tilde{\texttt{r}} = \texttt{r} - \lambda\texttt{u}$, so a u uniformly c times too small is arithmetically identical to running with $\lambda/\texttt{c}$, and λ is tuned. Rescaling σ by the single constant that best calibrates it, fitted and scored on the same data and so an upper bound on what *any* constant achieves, needs 10.4 at h = 1 and 43.2 at h = 368, a factor of 4 across the rollout (a rule committed in advance; Appendix E). No single λ is both of those. The mechanism is §6.5's: σ grows far more slowly than error, which grows by an order of magnitude, so the ratio runs 8.3× at h = 1, 33.4× at h = 100 and 34.4× at h = 368. The penalty is applied at every step of a 100-step imagination rollout, so its *profile across the rollout* is wrong in a way no rescaling can correct: deep-rollout states are under-penalised relative to their realised risk. This bounds what the quantity reports across depth, not what the distortion costs a trained policy (the policy caveat of §11).

Two rules committed in advance check how these numbers are read (Appendix M). Resampling whole episodes rather than 400-step trajectories changes no verdict in the one arena with the power to show it, the out-of-sample cells being uninformative by design (rule M-62: **NO MOVE**). The epistemic term's one-step coverage failure is spread across the 45 state dimensions rather than carried by a few (rule M-63: **UNIFORM**).

The released checkpoint is no longer the only ensemble measured. Three Arm A arms at ensemble size 5 (§6.6; out-of-sample, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, 2,500 training iterations) are **better calibrated than the released checkpoint and fail the same way**: 10.5× [9.0, 11.5] overconfident at h = 100 against its 25.7× on the same held-out pair, with 8.19% coverage where a calibrated Gaussian gives 68.27%. §6.4 establishes that the two are the same architecture in the respect that matters here, and Appendix M gives the arms' table at every horizon.

The scalar penalty as actually applied, `means.std(0).sum(-1)` at `envs/base.py:166`, correlates **+0.605** with total absolute error over the rollout, 95% CI [+0.545, +0.694] from a bootstrap over whole trajectories, n_independent = 20 (7,360 pooled trajectory-step points). The interval resamples whole trajectories, not trajectory-step pairs, which would narrow it by about the square root of the rollout length.

6.3 Why the aleatoric head collapses: the optimum is $\sigma = 0$

This subsection explains the aleatoric column and only that column, and leaves the epistemic one open: ensemble disagreement is not shaped by the mechanism below, and why *it* is miscalibrated is not established here. It also supplies the alternative explanation promised in §6.1. The follow-up reads the low aleatoric value as reflecting "small stochasticity in the environment". The observation is correct and the reading is not: σ is low because $\sigma = 0$ is the optimum of the loss that trains it, and it would be low on any dataset, stochastic or not.

The state loss is squared error on a *sample* drawn from the predicted Gaussian, not a likelihood:

$$\mathcal{L} \;=\; \mathbb{E}\big[(\mu + \sigma\varepsilon - y)^2\big] \;=\; (\mu - y)^2 + \sigma^2$$

which is minimised at $\sigma = 0$ for any μ. There is no log-σ term to oppose it. The bound term that appears to oppose it does not, because `max_logstd` is not an independent parameter — it is constructed as `min_logstd + exp(log_delta_logstd)`, so

$$\overline{\log \sigma_{\max}} - \overline{\log \sigma_{\min}} \;=\; \overline{\exp(\log \Delta_{\log \sigma})}$$

and `min_logstd` cancels algebraically, taking no gradient from that term. The floor the interval closes onto therefore freezes while the interval closes: a one-way ratchet.

The derivation above covers two terms, and the objective has 7. Back-propagated one at a time, exactly 2 reach σ (`state` and `bound`) and the other 5 give a gradient of exactly zero (Appendix J).

The derivation says the collapse happens on any dataset, and that is testable. Under a rule committed before the runs (rule M-50, Appendix E) we trained the released head, unmodified but over a one-dimensional state with no recurrent trunk, on synthetic data whose known noise varies 25× across the input range. **Under the implemented objective σ sits 21.7× below the true noise and does not track it at all**, while under the authors' unused likelihood branch it recovers the true level to a median ratio of 0.9779, seed-variably. The rule returns **OBJECTIVE-DRIVEN**, which establishes the contrast and not the size of the recovery (Appendix J).

We predicted the collapse from this algebra before training, then observed it: across all 28 runs at the released width outside §5.2's sweep the log-σ range moves linearly in iteration count, falling under sampled MSE and rising under the corrected one (Figure 4a; Appendix J lists the runs and which the rate is fitted on).

Two different things are being explained here, and §6.5 separates them. *Magnitude collapse is objective-driven.* It occurs in all 17 sampled-MSE runs at a rate of -9.3857e-05 per iteration with a standard deviation of 6.0e-07, **including the teacher-forced arm**, which shares the objective, and reverses to +3.2296e-05 in the 5 runs that change it. *Input-independence is not.* It varies by a factor of 15.6 between two arms trained under the same objective, so the objective cannot be what produces it.

Under the corrected objective the sign flips (Figure 4b), the strongest evidence that the mechanism is the objective and not the optimiser, the data or the architecture.

The correction fails differently rather than succeeding. The reference contains an unused `gaussian_nll` branch. Running it reverses the collapse and improves the magnitude from 52.2× to 10.9× overconfident. It does not produce a usable estimate, and it destroys something the faithful arm had: the σ-versus-error ordering falls from 39/45 dimensions positively correlated to 21/45, which is chance. Neither ordering survives multiplicity correction (Appendix J).

6.4 Why the epistemic term may be miscalibrated: the members are not independent models

§6.3 explains the aleatoric column and leaves the epistemic one open. This subsection supplies a candidate, structurally symmetric to §6.3's, from source and from the checkpoint's own tensors; nothing here is trained

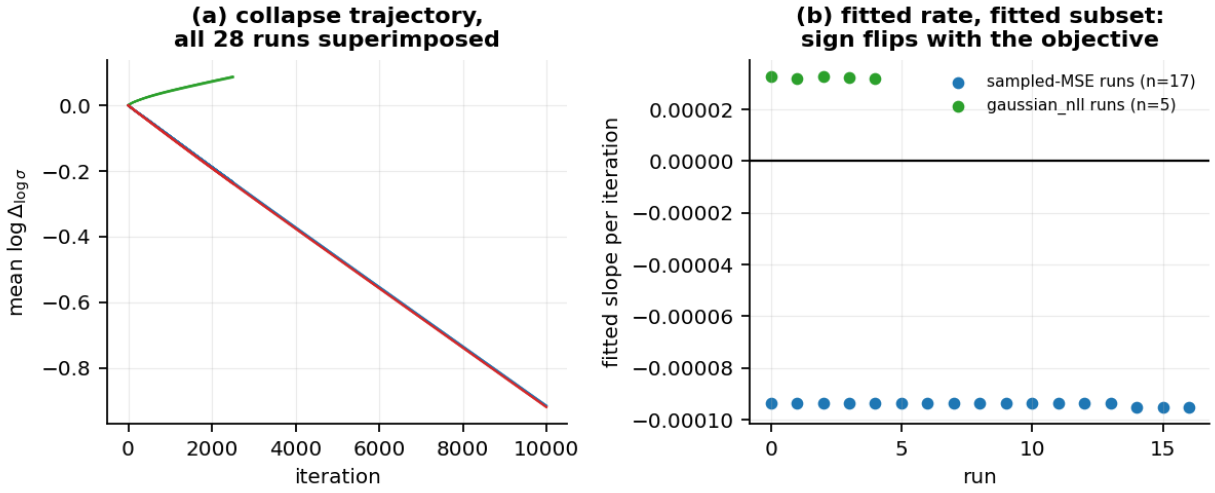


Figure 4: The variance collapse is objective-driven. (a) mean $\log \Delta_{\log \sigma}$ against training iteration for each of the 28 runs of the collapse family, which is every run of §5–§7 at the released width outside §5.2's sweep (Appendix J). The runs are drawn individually but are visually coincident within each objective, so the 28 read as two lines, one falling and one rising – which is the point: the trajectory does not vary visibly from run to run. (b) the fitted per-iteration slope for each run, grouped by objective: negative and tightly clustered under sampled MSE, positive under `gaussian_nll`. The sign flip is the evidence that the objective, not the optimiser or the data, produces it.

and nothing is inferred from a measurement. The effect is known (§2). What is ours is finding it in a released robotics checkpoint, with the sharing quantified at 89.15% of each member and its cost bounded by the 2.03× an independent ensemble gains on the overconfidence factor (§6.8).

The released five-member ensemble is not five models. The code builds one trunk, replicates only the heads, evaluates the trunk once and hands every head the same feature vector, then takes the spread across the heads as the epistemic term (Appendix J gives the lines).

The parameter counts make the scale of the sharing concrete. The state pathway is a 636,672-parameter two-layer GRU trunk plus five heads of 77,492 parameters each. Per member, 636,672 of 714,164 parameters — **89.15%** — are numerically identical to every other member's. Only 10.85% differ. Across the whole released object, the two shared trunks are 63.81% of 1,995,569 parameters.

The sharing is stronger than the parameter count suggests. The trunk owns a *single* recurrent hidden state (`rnn.py:40`), and an autoregressive rollout feeds the ensemble **mean** back into it (`system_dynamics.py:115`; `src/rwm_model.py:223` in our reimplementation). So the five members do not roll out independently at all. There is exactly one hidden-state trajectory between them, and disagreement at step t is the spread of five two-layer MLPs read off a single 256-dimensional vector.

Members which share a feature extractor have correlated errors by construction, and their spread cannot express uncertainty the shared trunk does not already carry. Where a deep ensemble varies initialisation *and* data ordering across whole models, here only the output heads differ, so the quantity the method penalises rewards with is a lower bound on epistemic uncertainty by construction. It is the same shape of finding as §6.3: not a training failure, a structural one.

This applies to our own arms identically, which is why §6.2's comparison is fair. Our ensemble-5 arms build, evaluate and read their trunk the same way, and their tensor names and parameter counts match the released checkpoint's exactly on all 3 arms checked (`results/v1_ensemble_topology.json`; Appendix J), so §6.2's comparison is of two instances of one architecture.

What this is and is not. It is a *candidate* mechanism, established structurally. It does not show that trunk-sharing is *the* explanation for §6.2's miscalibration; architecture could be a minor contributor to a failure dominated by something else. That needs an ensemble which shares nothing, pre-registered and reported in §6.8. The topology is a fact about the released artifact; the mechanism is a hypothesis about that fact.

6.5 The failure is one of magnitude; the ordering is weaker than it looks

Adding the teacher-forced arm, trained for §5, sharpens the finding (our arms at 2,500 training iterations; the released checkpoint as released). Arm B's σ is 15.6× more input-dependent than the faithful arm's, and it has the largest mean correlation of the four (r = 0.257). It is still 315× overconfident. So σ *collapsing in magnitude* is objective-driven, and σ *becoming input-independent* is not: the teacher-forced arm collapses in magnitude exactly like the autoregressive ones, same objective and same rate, while keeping that variation across inputs. Appendix K gives the four models' table, its arenas and a candidate mechanism.

The same pattern holds for the quantity the method uses. On the held-out pair (n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, in-sample for the checkpoint), the epistemic term correlates positively with realised error on **45 of 45** dimensions at h = 368 while being 39.7× overconfident there, and its σ grows 1.59× from h = 1 to h = 368 while its error grows 13.33×. Under a permutation null that keeps the coupling between dimensions, nothing in this family survives Holm–Bonferroni in any of the three arenas, and out of sample at the 400-step unit nothing could, since its smallest attainable P already exceeds the smallest Holm threshold: at h = 368 the tests are underpowered at every sample size we can reach (Appendix K).

So this section's claim is: **the magnitude failure is established and large; the ordering points the right way for the epistemic term and the faithful and teacher-forced arms, not for the corrected arm or the released aleatoric head (supplementary S3), and is not established at conventional significance once the dependence between dimensions is respected. The failure is specifically magnitude calibration, in both components.**

The structural excuse does not survive. One could argue that a model trained on an 8-step horizon cannot be expected to report calibrated uncertainty about step 368. It cannot report it about step 8 either. Inside the trained horizon, σ is flat while error grows (Figure 5; out-of-sample held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, in-sample for the released checkpoint; Appendix K gives all four models): the faithful arm's σ *declines* (0.9241×) while its error grows 3.49×. The coverage collapse in Figure 3(b) is therefore driven entirely by growing error against a fixed σ.

6.6 Ensemble disagreement beats the trivial baseline

The follow-up justifies ensemble disagreement as a trust metric on the grounds that it "closely follows the trend of the prediction error". §6.5 shows the per-dimension version of that claim is weaker than it looks. This section finds that the *scalar* the method applies tracks error well, which coexists with §6.5 without contradiction, and asks the question that matters more to a practitioner: **does disagreement beat something free?** The quantity is a usable ranking signal and is still not an interval.

Error in an autoregressive rollout grows with depth, so the trivial competitor to any trust metric is the forecast step index — a counter. It needs no ensemble, no second forward pass and no model. If a counter ranks error as well as disagreement does, the ensemble is not earning its cost. Neither paper runs this comparison, so we do. All three correlations below are on the scalar the method applies, `means.std(0).sum(-1)` at `envs/base.py:166`, against total absolute error, on the released checkpoint over all ten episodes, n_independent = 20 trajectories, with 95% intervals from a bootstrap over whole trajectories.

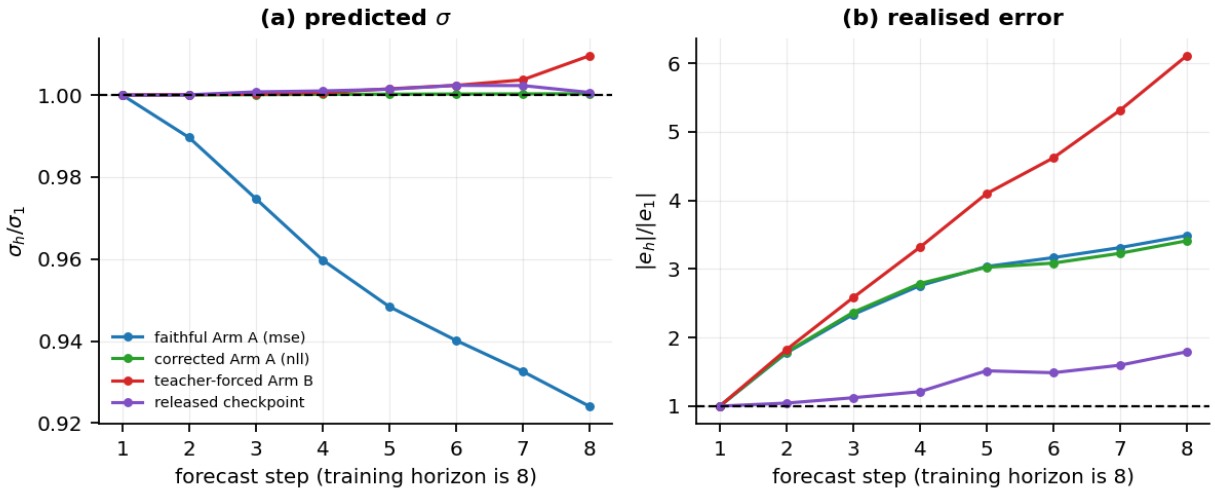


Figure 5: Why the coverage collapse is a horizon effect. Both panels are normalised to forecast step 1, on the out-of-sample held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories; our arms at 2,500 training iterations, the released checkpoint as released; it trained on these episodes, so for it this arena is in-sample (§3). (a) predicted σ barely moves, and for the faithful arm it declines. (b) realised error grows 1.79× to 6.11× over the same steps, across the four models. The gap between the panels is the collapse.

h	r(step index, |error|)	r(disagreement, |error|)	partial r(disagreement, |error| · index)	paired difference, disagreement − index
1	—	**+0.994** [+0.918, +0.999]	—	—
8	+0.181 [+0.108, +0.349]	**+0.738** [+0.537, +0.807]	+0.757 [+0.540, +0.822]	+0.556 [+0.241, +0.679]
32	+0.174 [+0.131, +0.336]	**+0.735** [+0.577, +0.823]	+0.756 [+0.604, +0.841]	+0.561 [+0.298, +0.674]
100	+0.490 [+0.394, +0.604]	**+0.628** [+0.574, +0.839]	+0.584 [+0.516, +0.815]	+0.138 [+0.034, +0.362]
128	+0.526 [+0.421, +0.643]	**+0.671** [+0.604, +0.846]	+0.617 [+0.534, +0.812]	+0.145 [+0.011, +0.324]
368	+0.269 [+0.106, +0.431]	**+0.605** [+0.545, +0.694]	+0.596 [+0.526, +0.687]	+0.337 [+0.147, +0.544]

(h=1 has a single forecast step, so the index is constant and its correlation — and therefore the partial and the difference — undefined. The epistemic correlation is not, and it is the largest anywhere in this work: at one step, ensemble disagreement is very nearly a perfect ranking of realised error.)

Disagreement wins at every horizon tested. Over the full h = 368 rollout the counter reaches +0.269 against disagreement's +0.605, and the index leads in 0 of 5 horizons.

The last column is the test of whether disagreement beats the counter. Both correlations are measured on the *same* trajectories, so the paired difference, resampling whole trajectories and recomputing *both* inside each draw, is the right test (Appendix N). It excludes zero at **5 of 5** horizons. The distinction matters at 2 of them: at h=100 and h=128 the marginal intervals *do* overlap. h=128 is where the counter is strongest (+0.526) and the margin narrowest: the paired difference there is +0.145 [+0.011, +0.324], which excludes zero only just: +0.011 is the smallest lower bound in the table, at the 400-step unit. At h = 100 the paired difference is +0.138 [+0.034, +0.362], which also excludes zero.

The third column asks whether disagreement merely re-encodes the clock. Partialling the step index out of both variables *lowers* disagreement's correlation by 0.010, from +0.605 to +0.596. Almost none of what disagreement knows is explained by how deep into the rollout you are: it carries real information about *this* rollout.

What survives removing each confound (Appendix N). Across 5 models of how far into the rollout a step is, the weakest figure is +0.582, so disagreement is not re-encoding the clock; but the pooled figure is in large part a between-rollout effect, so the statistic that matters holds both the rollout and the depth constant. Pre-registered as rule M-45, it gives +0.419 [+0.318, +0.576] at n_independent = 20 400-step trajectories, and the

rule returns **DISAGREEMENT CARRIES WITHIN-ROLLOUT INFORMATION**: disagreement still tracks error rather than merely reporting which episode is hard.

Per horizon, the within-rollout effect is materially smaller than the pooled figure and not established at short horizon (Appendix N gives its table).

Does it hold on a model we trained? Three Arm A arms at ensemble size 5 lead the index in **12 of 12** seed-horizon cells, but under a rule committed before the runs (rule M-43) the paired difference excludes zero at only 1 of 4 horizons. It returns **DOES NOT GENERALISE**: at n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories it was under-powered, which we measured after the fact (Appendix N). So the ranking finding is established on the released checkpoint and supported but not established on a model we trained.

We ran the baseline test expecting it to go the other way: the expectation we held about the counter-baseline was that it would match disagreement. It was not committed to git before the data existed, so by this paper's own standard (§8) it is not a pre-registration (Appendix N). It did not go that way against the counter. It went that way against something else.

One adversary is one, so we added two more, and the ranking claim survives only one of them. Under a rule committed before either was computed (rule M-51, corrected by rule M-52), we added two baselines needing no ensemble and no second model: `step-size`, the magnitude of the model's own predicted state change $\|\mu_t - \mu_{t-1}\|$, and `entry-res`, its one-step error just before the forecast window opens (Appendix N gives what each costs).

baseline	r(baseline, error)	margin	partial r(disagreement given baseline)	beaten?
forecast step index *(the existing adversary)*	+0.2686	+0.3368	+0.5957	—
`step-size` — $\|\mu_t - \mu_{t-1}\|$	**+0.4697**	+0.1357	+0.5430	**no**
`entry-res` — one-step error before the window	+0.1471	+0.4582	+0.5948	yes

r(disagreement, error) = +0.6053 on the released checkpoint over all ten episodes, n_independent = 20 400-step trajectories. Minimum detectable effect, estimated before either baseline existed: 0.2891 on a margin, 0.1131 on a partial.

The verdict is SURVIVES entry-res ONLY, and the reason is the row a reader should look at twice. Disagreement beats 1 of the 2 free baselines added here. The magnitude of the model's own predicted state change ranks realised error at +0.4697, against +0.6053 for the five-member ensemble disagreement the method is built on. The margin between them, +0.1357, is **below** the 0.2891 this sample size can resolve, so at n_independent = 20 400-step trajectories we cannot say the ensemble ranks better than a subtraction. If the observed margin is the true one, settling it needs 25 of them, an estimate under an assumed effect (§11, supplementary S2).

On shorter units, at h = 100, the margin resolves. The 20 whole trajectories cannot settle it at h = 368, so a rule committed before its reading (rule X6, Appendix X) put the same comparison to 70 non-overlapping units of 132 rows, the model's history plus h = 100 forecast steps, cut inside the same ten episodes, on the same checkpoint. At h = 100 the margin is +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896]: the interval excludes zero, the rule's criterion, so it returns **DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE**. Disagreement correlates +0.6808 with error there against step size's +0.3992, and keeps +0.6361 [+0.5567, +0.7466] with step size partialled out (Appendix X). The units are this checkpoint's training data, units from one episode are not independent of each other, and the interval resamples units, not episodes, so the margin at h = 100 is resolved on this checkpoint's training episodes and no further; the margin at h = 368 is not re-tested.

Disagreement does still carry information the subtraction does not. With `step-size` partialled out it retains +0.5430, far above the 0.1131 MDE for that test, and holding the forecast step exactly fixed it keeps +0.7392 against `step-size`'s +0.5196. It is not re-encoding predicted step size. What is not established is that it adds enough to be worth five models. The rule fixed this reading in advance: the partial is the load-bearing test and the margin is corroboration, so a baseline passing the partial while failing the margin does not refute the ranking claim. **It does refute a framing.** "Disagreement ranks error well" is supported. "You need the ensemble to rank error" is not.

On this axis the follow-up's claim survives adversarial testing against a real baseline, and that is the strongest form of support this paper offers any claim of either original work — now with the qualification that a free baseline comes closer to it than the counter did.

6.7 One constant scalar does not fix it; a per-horizon one lands within the band, though no single cell is resolvable at this arena

Recalibrating a dynamics model's uncertainty inside model-based RL is not new (§2). What is new here is the conditioning variable, the *forecast horizon*, and one negative result: a single global multiplier **fails** where a per-horizon one shows no sign of failing. An open-loop rollout's error accumulates with depth while its predicted σ does not (§6.5), so a horizon-blind recalibration cannot follow the thing it is trying to correct, and this section measures that.

If σ had the right shape and the wrong scale, a single multiplier would repair it, and the finding would be a units problem with a one-line remedy. We tested that. A scalar was fitted on **one** held-out episode and evaluated on the **other**, in both directions, so it is never fitted on its own test set.

Two senses of "unseen", kept apart from here on. A cell is *unseen by the multiplier* when the multiplier scoring it was fitted on the other episode, and *unseen by the model* when the model never trained on that episode. The two held-out episodes are unseen by our arms' models, which trained on the other 8, but not by the released checkpoint, which trained on all ten (§3). **Every released-checkpoint cell in this section is therefore unseen by the multiplier only.**

Fitting at one step works at one step and nowhere else. On the epistemic term a constant scalar brings h = 1 coverage to 63–74% against the 68.27% target and leaves h = 368 at 17–21%, and fitted over the whole rollout it over-covers at one step while still falling short at the far end (Appendix T). A constant multiplier cannot track an error that grows while σ does not (§6.5), so for a *constant* scale "right shape, wrong scale" does not survive.

On the released checkpoint a per-horizon scalar lands near target, and this is the one concrete remedy in this paper; on a model that has not seen the test episodes the evidence is mixed. One multiplier per horizon is fitted on one held-out episode and evaluated on the other, in both directions, so no multiplier is ever scored on the episode that produced it: each direction fits on n_independent = 2 of the two episodes' 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories and is scored on the other 2. On the released checkpoint every point estimate lands within 10 points of the 68.27% target for both quantities, **12 / 12** epistemic and **12 / 12** aleatoric cells, against 2 of 12 for the constant scalar. **That absolute test is UNPOWERED here:** the 10-point band is resolvable at 0 of 12 quantity-by-horizon pairs, so a cell inside the band is compatible with a true coverage well outside it. **On Arm A at ensemble size 5, where the episodes are unseen by the model as well, its own multipliers manage 17 of 36 epistemic and 10 of 36 aleatoric cells**. So the recipe does not carry over intact to a model that has not seen the test episodes (Appendix T gives the table and every deviation).

Three cautions. The per-horizon scalar has one free parameter per horizon against the constant one's one, so it *must* fit better in sample; only cells unseen by the multiplier are evidence, and those are the cells reported. **The count is thinner than it looks:** the 12 cells are 6 horizons × two fold directions on the same 4 trajectories, each multiplier fitted on n_independent = 2 and scored on the other 2. They are not 12 independent successes and no P-value attaches to the count, which is reported so a reader can see how thin the evidence is; later sections refer back to this as the §6.7 caution, which the nine-episode fit below narrows for the released checkpoint. And the correction is a calibration patch, not a fix: it leaves σ carrying no more information than before and rescales it by how far ahead you are looking. On the released checkpoint it nevertheless brings every estimate unseen by the multiplier near what the interval claims, which is what a downstream user needs, and it costs one lookup table.

Fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth (rule X7). A rule committed before its reading (Appendix Y) repeats the design over all ten episodes: for each, the per-horizon multiplier is fitted on the other nine episodes' trajectories with the same fitting function and scored on its own. Each of the 20 trajectories is thus scored once, by a multiplier not fitted on it, and each horizon's coverage carries a 95%

interval. On the epistemic term every one of those intervals lies inside the 10-point band, all of them between 61.2% and 74.9%: **WITHIN BAND AT 6 OF 6 HORIZONS**. Appendix Y gives the aleatoric term and the constant multiplier alongside. Those trajectories are unseen by the multiplier, not by the model, which trained on all ten episodes, so for the released checkpoint each horizon's coverage is now resolved within the band, though the six horizons share those trajectories and are not independent tests; the Arm A result stands as it is.

The multipliers are a property of the model, not of the horizon. Fitted on Arm A and scored on the released checkpoint, and the reverse, on the same 4 held-out trajectories, rule M-69 returns **DOES NOT TRANSFER — A PROPERTY OF THE MODEL** on the paired change in coverage the arena can resolve: 52 of 72 governing cells, which are not independent tests, have an interval wholly outside the ±10-point band, and Arm A's multipliers are 0.0069× to 1.36× the released checkpoint's at the same horizon (Appendix T).

So the accurate form of this section is: **a constant scalar does not repair the interval; on the released checkpoint a per-horizon one brings every estimate unseen by the multiplier within the band, though no single cell is resolvable at this arena, and does so across episodes but not across models. On episodes unseen by the model as well, Arm A's own multipliers manage 17 of 36 epistemic cells, so there the evidence is mixed.** Fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth, the released checkpoint's epistemic coverage over all 20 trajectories is within the band at every horizon.

6.8 Testing the mechanism: an ensemble that shares nothing, alone and with the corrected objective

§6.4 establishes the topology as a fact and the mechanism as a hypothesis. Two rules committed to git before any of their artifacts existed test it, each with a minimum detectable effect estimated in advance (Appendix E). The first scores 5 independently initialised full models, Arm A at ensemble size 1 trained at 5 seeds, together as an ensemble at evaluation time. Each member keeps its own recurrent hidden state and the ensemble mean is fed back to all of them, so the rollout differs from the shared-trunk one only in what is under test. The second repeats it with every member trained under `gaussian_nll`, so the two fixes are measured on the same models. Both are scored on the held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, every model at 2,500 training iterations, against each of the shared-trunk seeds separately (Appendices O and P give the tables).

Rule M-44 returns MECHANISM SUPPORTED. All 6 of its 6 conditions hold against every one of the 3 shared-trunk seeds: at h = 100 the overconfidence factor improves **2.03**× against a minimum detectable effect of 1.45×, coverage rises a mean of +7.12 points against 2.26, and every paired interval excludes zero. σ itself grows 1.65× there, **71%** of the improvement, so the trunk-sharing mechanism is the larger part of the effect where the method operates. At h = 368, 57% is the ensemble simply predicting better (Appendix O).

Rule M-68 returns THE COMBINATION IMPROVES CALIBRATION, branch 2 of the four it names: all 5 of its 5 conditions hold, a **1.94**× improvement against a minimum detectable effect of 1.218×. That is essentially what independence gave alone. Against the independent arm, which differs in the loss and nothing else, switching to `gaussian_nll` multiplies the overconfidence factor by 1.044× [1.029, 1.054], slightly the wrong way and below what the design can resolve (Appendix P). **The two fixes do not add**: the objective's separate contribution is at most small, which the design can bound but not establish as zero. Once stated that is no surprise: the objective governs the aleatoric head, and the epistemic term is a spread across members the loss never sees.

What the arms bound, and what they do not repair. Independently seeded runs differ in data ordering as well as initialisation, and the independent members carry 3.49× the shared-trunk arms' state-pathway parameters, so these comparisons bound the architectural effect rather than isolating it. At matched capacity the improvement falls to 1.79× against a minimum detectable effect of 2.00×, so that rule returns **UNDER-POWERED — favours the matched ensemble by less than the MDE** (rule M-49, supplementary S2). Neither arm is an interval: at h = 100 the independent ensemble is 5.2× overconfident with 15.31% coverage and the combined arm 5.4× with 15.53%, where a calibrated Gaussian gives 68.27%. §6.7's per-

horizon multiplier remains the only correction in this paper whose estimates all land within the band, though only on the released checkpoint and with no single cell resolvable at this arena.

7 Defects in the released pipeline

Appendix H lists the ledger's other confirmed contributions that the body does not state, among them defects in the released data pipeline and departures of the released code from the paper's description.

7.1 Ten unmarked episode boundaries. §3. The window builder reads a termination column that is identically zero, so it marks all 9,961 windows valid.

7.2 Training and evaluation disagree on action alignment, and evaluation is the broken one. Row t holds the action that *produced* state t. The data say so directly: at every reset row all twelve actions are exactly zero (§3), and a policy network with biases cannot emit exact zeros, so those zeros mark the absence of a producing action — the reset produced that state, not a policy step. They are what Isaac Lab, in which the data were recorded, writes at a reset: `ActionManager.reset()` sets its stored actions to zero (`action_manager.py:350-365` in Isaac Lab). The training path pairs states and actions index-for-index, which is causally correct; the evaluation path feeds the action from $t-1$ to predict state t, stale by one step.

What the stale pairing costs depends on the horizon. All ten episodes are this checkpoint's training data, so the held-out pair is not more honest here, only smaller, and the larger arena leads. Over all ten episodes' 20 independent trajectories the stale action raises the released checkpoint's relative-L1 error by 55.0% [26.3, 92.7] at h = 1, 54.4% [37.5, 82.3] at h = 8 and 37.4% [21.3, 65.4] at h = 32. From h = 100 the change is not resolved: 8.2% [-10.4, 24.9] there and -4.6% [-13.4, 3.2] at h = 368, where single trajectories run from -47.4% to +35.2%. In nRMSE the rise is resolved at h = 8 and 32 (31.5% [24.7, 68.2] and 17.4% [7.7, 47.4]) but not at h = 1 (7.4% [-14.8, 87.8]), and from h = 100 it is not resolved either (7.9% [-18.9, 32.9] there, -2.1% [-10.0, 3.9] at h = 368). Each is a 95% interval from a cluster bootstrap over whole trajectories, both pairings inside each draw (`results/alignment_by_horizon.json`, `results/alignment_defect_ci.json`).

On the held-out pair's 4 independent trajectories the stale action raises the error at every horizon reported: by 34.2% [10.6, 75.0] at h = 1 and by 22.5% [6.3, 41.7] at h = 100, where all ten episodes resolve no change. At h = 368 it raises it by 7.9% [3.1, 13.0] on relative-L1 and 6.6% [1.0, 8.0] in nRMSE (Appendix V gives the per-trajectory values). Shifting the evaluation loop's two action slices by one step (`model_training.py:129` and `:132`) aligns it with training; our harness does this with `action_offset = 1` (`src/score_reference.py:180-190`).

For models trained under the causal pairing, the stale one also raises error, and how much depends on the arena (three-seed means, computed post hoc; Appendix V gives every model at every horizon, each with its interval). A percentage change depends on how accurate the model already is as much as on how much the action matters. Measured as the shift in the forecast itself on their own training data, our 10,000-iteration Arm A and the released checkpoint move about equally at h = 8, and at h = 100 the released checkpoint's forecast moves more (Appendix V).

Our models do use the action. Given another trajectory's actions, their error at h = 8 on their own training episodes' 16 trajectories rises by +676.3% [+454.8, +1060.0] at 10,000 iterations, and at 2,500 iterations by +227.8% [+131.6, +398.2], so rule X2, committed before its readings existed, returns **RESPONDS TO THE ACTION** at both checkpoints (Appendix V). That shows the forecasts depend on the action, not that they predict a different action's consequences correctly: every action in the data comes from one policy.

Rule X8 re-scores four of our rules with the released evaluation's timing, on the held-out pair's 4 trajectories, through each rule's own evaluator (the configuration and baseline rules at 2,500 iterations, the A/B comparison at 10,000), and all four keep their verdicts, **SAME VERDICT**, though 22 of their alongside readings change (Appendix Z); this concerns our models, not the original's printed numbers.

7.3 No held-out evaluation. Evaluation trajectories are drawn from training data. For the released checkpoint, trained on the entire file, no held-out measurement is possible at all, and neither pinned repository can generate the data that would make one possible (§3).

7.4 What the spliced windows cost: nothing measurable in rollout. A contaminated arm trained with 195 spliced windows added, at 2.47% contamination (below the pipeline's 3.53%, by design, so that no held-out row leaks), raises training loss by 21.57% where a duplication control adding the same number of exact copies raises it by 0.90%. In rollout, over 32 cells (the held-out pair and the training episodes, 200 and 400-step trajectories, the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints, n_independent 4 to 39), it is hurt in 0 and helped in 9 (Figure 6a), the signature of regularisation. At this rate the splices do not harm rollout; the unmarked boundaries remain a real defect on leakage grounds (Appendix Q).

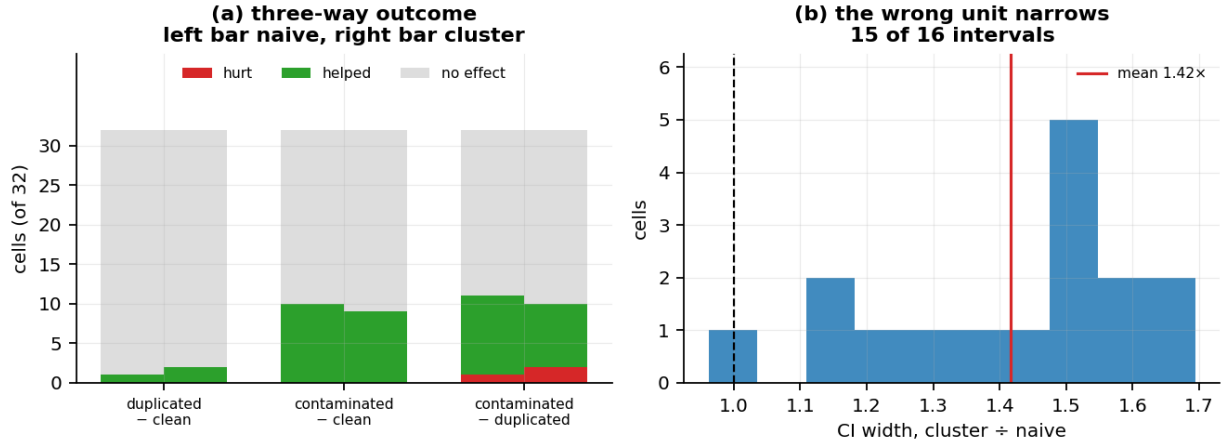


Figure 6: The contamination control. (a) outcome across 32 cells for each arm pair (the held-out pair and the training episodes, 200 and 400-step trajectories, the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints, n_independent 4 to 39), naive bootstrap on the left of each position and cluster bootstrap on the right; the duplication control is inert. (b) a different family, the 16 cells of §5's A/B gap at the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints (§8): distribution of the ratio of cluster to naive confidence-interval width, with the mean marked. Resampling pooled seed × trajectory values rather than whole trajectories narrows 15 of the 16 intervals.

7.5 The released artifacts do not reproduce the released checkpoint's variance state. Read as a clock, §6.3's collapse rate puts the checkpoint's variance state out of reach of a constant-rate run from the released initialisation at the configured learning rate, at every iteration count the release, the paper and the checkpoint tag state. The first author's account, that the release is several revisions removed from the setup that trained it, supplies a mechanism, a warm start or a different initialisation, so this is a documentation gap between a release and a run rather than an inconsistency (Appendix F and the supplementary `docs/APPENDIX_G_VARIANCE_ARITHMETIC.md`).

8 Method

An append-only ledger. Every claim here has a permanent identifier, an evidence class (source, data, run, external, inference) and a status, in `FINDINGS_LEDGER.md` (309 entries). Claims are never edited in place: one that turns out to be wrong is marked superseded, pointed at what replaced it, and kept.

Pre-registration, and one failure of it. Decision rules were committed to git before the data that tested them, with one exception. Figure 1 and Appendix E give the lead time for each of the 28 whose data exist; 27 are positive and 1 is not. Every positive bar is a difference of two commit timestamps. **The negative one is not**: it is the duplication-control rule (§7.4), whose *data* side is the moment the control runs finished, a line in `results/control_driver.log` rather than a commit, dated from the commit that introduced that line. The rule was stated in conversation before the runs and reached git **2.9 hours after they finished**, and we found it only by auditing our own `git log`. The measurement stands, because the arm was built without reference to its outcome, but the claim that it was pre-registered does not, and it is withdrawn. A discipline that is only checked when it succeeds is not a discipline.

Nine claims withdrawn on evidence, and eight framings withdrawn rather than numbers, out of 24 superseded entries kept in the record (the supplementary `docs/BUILD_CHECKS.md` lists them). The most consequential of the framings withdrawn is the inference from per-dimension sign counts to a binomial P-value, which assumed an independence the 45 state dimensions do not have (§6.5). Found by our own pre-submission audit, it withdraws the strength of evidence behind what an earlier draft called its strongest result.

A statistic that was resampling the wrong unit. Our bootstrap pooled three seeds over a shared trajectory set and resampled the pooled vector while reporting the independent-trajectory count, so each trajectory appeared three times. Resampling trajectories instead widens intervals by a mean 1.42× and changes 1 of 16 verdicts, in the out-of-sample h = 8 cell at 200-step trajectories and 2,500 iterations, already recorded as unresolvable. Every long-horizon verdict survives; both units are reported.

Reproducibility, and a build that checks its own prose. Every measured number in this paper is substituted from an artifact on each build, and a quick run on a clean clone (`./reproduce.sh --quick --force`, which skips training) rewrites 0.73% of the numeric values under `results/` that the comparison counts; the rest are carried in and prove nothing about reproduction. **The number of regenerated values that differ and are themselves a measurement, a statistic or the verdict of a test is 0.** The clean-clone gate requires that none differ at all; 3 do, so it fails and is published as failing. The supplementary `docs/BUILD_CHECKS.md` gives the accounting and the checks the build runs on this paper's own prose.

9 Actionable lessons

Six things a practitioner can apply without reading the rest of this paper.

Use ensemble disagreement as a ranking signal, but price it against the free alternatives first. Do not read it as a distance. And expect it to degrade with horizon. On the released checkpoint's own training episodes, at one forecast step it ranks whole rollouts almost perfectly, +0.994 [+0.918, +0.999] across the 20 trajectories, a ranking of *rollouts* rather than of moments within one, because at h=1 there is only one moment. Over the full rollout it falls to +0.605 [+0.545, +0.694]: excellent where you can check it cheaply and merely good where you most need it. It beats the forecast step index at every horizon we tested, on a paired test that excludes zero at 5 of the 5 horizons where the index is defined, and retains +0.596 once that index is partialled out (§6.6). **On whole trajectories, what it does not clearly beat is the model's own predicted step size**, which costs nothing and needs no ensemble: over the 20 400-step trajectories that ranks error at +0.4697 against disagreement's +0.6053, a margin of +0.1357, below the 0.2891 that sample can resolve. On 70 shorter units of the same episodes a later rule resolves the margin at h = 100, +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896] (rule X6, §6.6), on the checkpoint's training data only; the margin at h = 368 is not re-tested. Disagreement carries information the subtraction does not, retaining +0.5430 once step size is partialled out, and with both the forecast depth and the rollout held constant it still correlates +0.419 [+0.318, +0.576] with error (§6.6); but a practitioner about to pay for five members should price the subtraction first. And it is too small to be an interval by a wide margin: at h = 100, the horizon the method rolls out over, 33.4× [28.7, 39.0] on the released checkpoint over all ten episodes, and on the held-out pair 10.5× [9.0, 11.5] on the ensemble-5 arms we trained, against the released checkpoint's 25.7× there. A risk gate or safety margin that reads σ as a distance is not supported at any horizon, on either.

If you need the interval, rescale per horizon, not globally, and refit on your own model. One multiplier per forecast horizon, fitted on one episode and scored on another, brings every released-checkpoint coverage estimate within 10 points of nominal, though this arena cannot resolve any single cell to that band. Fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth, the epistemic coverage over all 20 trajectories lies within it at every horizon (rule X7, §6.7). A single global multiplier manages 2 of the 12 epistemic ones (§6.7). That checkpoint trained on both episodes; on Arm A, whose model never saw them, its own multipliers manage 17 of 36 epistemic cells. The cells are not independent trials (the §6.7 caution), so read the sweep as consistency and the per-cell deviations as the evidence. The fitted epistemic multipliers span 9.31× across horizons, which is precisely why one number cannot serve.

Do not convert per-dimension sign counts into P-values. State dimensions in a robot are physically coupled and share a forecast-depth trend, so an independent-trials null is badly wrong, in our tables by up to $10^{13}\times$ (§6.5, Appendix K). Permute whole trajectories instead. An earlier draft of this paper used the binomial version, and it made our weakest evidence look like our strongest.

Count independent trajectories, not trajectories. Two 400-step windows that overlap at all are one piece of evidence, not two. The held-out arena here contains 4 independent 400-step trajectories however many windows are drawn from it, and that number bounds every long-horizon magnitude (§3), though §5's direction is re-tested on all ten episodes, each held out once on fixed folds (rule X3: **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS**, 20 trajectories at 2,500 iterations, not 10,000). Reporting an interval beside a trajectory count rather than an independent-trajectory count overstates precision. Resampling pooled seed × trajectory values instead of trajectories narrows intervals by a further 1.42× (§8).

Anchor a decision rule to the horizon the claim is about. Our first pre-registered rule was anchored at h = 8, the training forecast horizon, and returned **CANNOT BE SETTLED AT THIS BUDGET**; the claim was about deployment horizons. The rule was correct in form and pointed at the wrong regime, a failure mode pre-registration does not protect against on its own.

Check that the implemented loss is the described loss before reproducing any number from it. The paper describes two loss terms; the implementation has 7. The predicted variance has an optimum at zero under the implemented one, which is why the released checkpoint's σ is 11,683× smaller than its own error at h = 100, and 20,669× at h = 368. Reading the loss took an afternoon and explained a result that would otherwise have looked like a training bug.

10 Broader impact

This is a reproduction of a dynamics model on public simulation data. It creates no new capability, uses no personal data and deploys nothing.

The findings bear on one practice, and it is not the one the original method uses. The follow-up applies ensemble disagreement as a reward penalty. For that use, our measurements support its ordering (§6.6), with the qualification that a free signal ranks error nearly as well. A different use is reading the same number as an error bar, a safety margin, or a trigger for handing control to a fallback controller. The original papers neither make nor recommend that use, and it is the use our measurements rule out. At the method's own 100-step horizon, the disagreement is 33.4× smaller than realised error and covers 4.61% of outcomes where 68.27% is expected. We say this because the released checkpoint exposes the quantity, and it is easy to read as an interval.

We do not claim the original method is unsafe. No policy is trained here. The one policy-free test we ran found that correcting the scale per horizon leaves every pairwise ordering of accumulated penalty unchanged on the available trajectories, a test whose null is partly structural (§11).

11 Limitations

Limits that belong to one result are stated beside it: the budget and our reading of Table S7 (§5.2, §5.3), the mechanism of §6.4 as a hypothesis, the per-dimension tests' power (§6.5, Appendix K), the ensemble-5 replication (§6.6), the recalibration's two episodes (§6.7), which its nine-episode fit widens to all ten for the released checkpoint, and what the independent ensemble bounds (§6.8). supplementary S2 gives each of those, and every limitation below, in full.

What this study cannot address. One robot, one gait (a trot) and one flat terrain, with every command drawn from one bounded box, so "generalisation" here means across velocity commands only. No policy is trained: no policy-learning result of either paper is reproduced or tested, the sample-efficiency comparison included, and nothing here uses a GPU. Our arms use 0.133% of the reference's world-model data (§5.1). And the released checkpoint trained on all ten episodes, so it has no held-out arena, and neither pinned

repository can generate the data that would give it one (supplementary S1). None of this can be lifted on CPU, and nothing in this paper claims otherwise.

Effective sample size bounds the long-horizon magnitudes. The headline magnitudes rest on the held-out pair, 4 independent 400-step trajectories (the n = 4 caveat of §3); the direction is re-tested on all ten episodes, each out of sample once on fixed folds (rule X3: **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS**, 20 trajectories at 2,500 iterations, not 10,000; §5). A larger dataset cannot be generated here (supplementary S1), so the released checkpoint's lack of a held-out arena is a constraint, not a choice.

On whole trajectories, the ranking claim is not established as needing an ensemble. The model's own predicted step size ranks error nearly as well, by a margin those 20 trajectories cannot resolve at h = 368; if the observed margin is the true one, settling it needs 25 independent 400-step trajectories, a required-sample-size estimate under an assumed effect (supplementary S2). On 70 shorter units cut inside the same episodes, which are the checkpoint's training data, a rule committed before its reading finds disagreement ahead at h = 100, +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896] (rule X6: **DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE**; §6.6, Appendix X); the margin at h = 368 is not re-tested.

We did not measure what the miscalibration costs. The penalty the follow-up applies is 33.4× overconfident at h = 100, the horizon its own imagination rollouts run to, but its only use is to shape policy learning, and a test of that cost needing no policy, rule X5, could not be run, because the released data do not record the velocity command its reward terms score against (Appendix W). **The finding bounds what the quantity reports, not what it costs**, and the ratio is not a measure of harm. Other sections refer back to this as the policy caveat of §11. A proxy that needs no policy, the ordering of the penalty accumulated along whole rollouts before and after the per-horizon correction, finds none of the 6 pairs among the held-out pair's 4 trajectories reordered (in-sample for the checkpoint; rule M-70: **DOES NOT REORDER**). That proxy orders the penalty alone, though, not the penalised return, its null is partly structural, and its interval is degenerate (supplementary S2).

No family-wide correction is applied across our own pre-registered rules. There are 28 of them (Appendix E), each reported, once its data exist, against the thresholds it was committed with (one is withdrawn as a pre-registration because it reached git after its data, §8); a reader who prefers a corrected family threshold can apply it from that count.

Other descendants of the PETS parameterisation. We did not test whether the $\sigma = 0$ optimum affects them: the hypothesis is well-founded only for one that makes the same substitution and leaves nothing pushing its floor back up, and is untested for any (§2, Appendix I).

12 Conclusion

The Robotic World Model's central training claim reproduces at long horizons, and the margin is large there, though teacher forcing leads at one step on the short windows built for it. RWM is ahead at h = 368 of the baselines we built to our reading of it and trained with its settings, though there none of them beats predicting no change. Matched to RWM's parameter count, size being one axis, the transformer cannot be told apart from it (rule X4: PARTIAL). On accuracy alone, four other history and forecast lengths beat its chosen ones at our budget, no reading the rule reports putting the chosen ones ahead of any of them, in a ranking that changes when the chosen setting trains longer; it chose them as a trade-off with training time (§5.2, §5.3). Neither uncertainty output of the follow-up that adds them reports what a reader would take it to report. At h = 100, the horizon the method's own imagination rollouts run to, the aleatoric σ is 11,683× smaller than its own error, because the objective's optimum is $\sigma = 0$ and the term that should prevent this cancels out of the gradient. The epistemic term the method actually penalises with is better by a factor of 349 and still 33.4× [28.7, 39.0] overconfident, both figures at h = 100 on the 20 trajectories of the checkpoint's own training episodes.

The ranking use the follow-up claims survives a real test. On the released checkpoint, ensemble disagreement beats the forecast step index at every horizon and, with both the rollout and the depth held constant, still correlates +0.419 [+0.318, +0.576] with realised error (§6.6). A free subtraction, though, the model's own predicted step size, ranks error nearly as well, +0.470 against disagreement's +0.605, by a margin 20 whole

trajectories cannot resolve at h = 368 (SURVIVES entry-res ONLY: disagreement beats the one-step error before the window, but not the model's predicted step size); on 70 shorter units of the same episodes, at h = 100, disagreement is ahead (rule X6, +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896]). The scale may be repairable per horizon on the released checkpoint, where, fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth, the epistemic coverage over all 20 trajectories is within the band at every horizon (rule X7: **WITHIN BAND AT 6 OF 6 HORIZONS**), but on a model that never saw the test episodes the evidence is mixed (§6.7). Per dimension, no ordering reaches significance after multiplicity correction once the coupling between dimensions is respected (§6.5). As the scalar the method applies, ensemble disagreement gets the order right and the size wrong: it should not be read as a scale, and a ranking use deserves its own validation on the deployment distribution (supplementary S3).

What should travel from this paper, and what should not. *Properties of the objective and of how its bounds are built*, such as §6.3's $\sigma = 0$ optimum, are the ones to expect elsewhere, and only where both are present together, a hypothesis §2 states and leaves untested outside this codebase. *Properties of this released artifact*, its one-step misalignment, its shared trunk and its specific overconfidence factors, should be checked rather than assumed in any other. *Properties of this dataset and its arenas* are limits on what could be resolved, not findings in either direction (supplementary S3 gives all three, and why §5.2's verdict should not travel either).

13 Data and code

The full repository — code, every artifact under `results/`, and `FINDINGS_LEDGER.md` with the complete claim record including the retractions — accompanies this submission as anonymised supplementary material, and will be released under a permanent archival identifier on acceptance. Neither upstream repository is redistributed; `setup.sh` fetches both at pinned commits and verifies two SHA-256 hashes.

The repository's history was rewritten once, and §8 depends on that history, so we say what changed. A supplementary file quoting private correspondence was committed and briefly published before consent to quote it had been given; it was purged from the history rather than merely deleted, because a deletion commit leaves the content recoverable from a public repository indefinitely. Purging a path rewrites every commit from the one that introduced it onward, so **37 of the 39 commits Figure 1 cites keep their identifiers and two do not**: the two made between that file's introduction and the purge. Timestamps, content and ordering are unchanged; only the hashes moved, and for that reason Figure 1 finds its first rules' commits by subject and the later ones by the commit that introduced their ledger heading, never by a stored hash alone. The transcript itself reaches reviewers in the anonymised supplementary archive, which is not published.

The pre-registration argument in §8 rests on commit timestamps, and those are author-settable via `git commit --date`. That matters, because §8 is load-bearing. Two things address it. The supplementary material includes an anonymised `git log` covering every commit cited here, so the ordering in Figure 1 is checkable at review time. In the submitted paper and bundle, commit identifiers are replaced by stable anonymous labels, with ordering, timestamps and subjects unchanged, and the map from label to identifier is disclosed on acceptance. And **the repository was archived by a third-party archive before submission**, under a permanent identifier whose visit timestamp is not author-controllable. Neither the identifier nor the date of that visit appears here: both resolve to a named repository, and a date is a one-field lookup away from an origin. They are disclosed on acceptance.

What that archive establishes should be stated precisely, because it is easy to overclaim. It does **not** prove any individual commit date is genuine. It proves that the repository, with the whole pre-registration history in the form this paper cites, existed no later than that archival moment, as recorded by a third party with no interest in the claim — so nothing in the record can have been back-dated afterwards. That bounds §8 rather than proving it, and a reviewer should read it as such.

On anonymity. The code and data for this work are public, as they are for most reproducibility work, and the submission is anonymised: its bundle is scrubbed, asserted clean of a deny-list, and excludes the

files that carry identity. Why the repository stays public, which §8's checkability depends on, is recorded in `docs/DOUBLE_BLIND_DECISION.md`.

14 References

1. C. Li, A. Krause, M. Hutter. *Robotic World Model: A Neural Network Simulator for Robust Policy Optimization in Robotics.* arXiv:2501.10100**v1**, 17 January 2025; current version v5, 14 December 2025, under the same title. Presented as a workshop poster at NeurIPS 2025 (*Embodied World Models for Decision Making*); the venue's page does not say whether the workshop is archival. *Read at v1, whose Roman-numeral sectioning our references follow; v2 (23 April 2025) renumbered to Arabic and moved IV-C into Appendix A.4.1.*

2. C. Li, A. Krause, M. Hutter. *Offline Robotic World Model: Learning Robotic Policies without a Physics Simulator.* arXiv:2504.16680**v1**, 23 April 2025; current version v3, 8 January 2026, retitled *Uncertainty-Aware Robotic World Model Makes Offline Model-Based Reinforcement Learning Work on Real Robots.* Presented as a workshop poster at ICLR 2026 (*The 2nd Workshop on World Models: Understanding, Modelling and Scaling*); the venue's page does not say whether the workshop is archival. *Read at v1. §5.1 and Eq. 4–5 keep their numbers there; every figure and appendix table has moved, and the model is renamed RWM-O to RWM-U — the same model, with the letter re-expanded from "Offline Robotic World Model" to "Uncertainty-Aware Robotic World Model". The two names never co-occur: v1 uses RWM-O 39 times and no RWM-U, v3 the reverse. The crosswalk is in* `results/original_paper_figures.json`.

3. Z. Abbas, S. Sokota, E. J. Talvitie, M. White. *Selective Dyna-style Planning Under Limited Model Capacity.* ICML 2020. arXiv:2007.02418, 2020.

4. R. Agarwal, M. Schwarzer, P. S. Castro, A. Courville, M. G. Bellemare. *Deep Reinforcement Learning at the Edge of the Statistical Precipice.* NeurIPS 2021. arXiv:2108.13264, 2021.

5. S. Albanie, J. F. Henriques, L. Bertinetto, A. Hernández-García, H. Doughty, G. Varol (eds.). *NeurIPS 2021 Workshop on Pre-registration in Machine Learning.* PMLR 181, 2022. https://proceedings.mlr.press/v181/

6. A. N. Angelopoulos, S. Bates. *A Gentle Introduction to Conformal Prediction and Distribution-Free Uncertainty Quantification.* arXiv:2107.07511, 2021.

7. S. Bengio, O. Vinyals, N. Jaitly, N. Shazeer. *Scheduled Sampling for Sequence Prediction with Recurrent Neural Networks.* NeurIPS 2015. arXiv:1506.03099, 2015.

8. L. Bertinetto, J. F. Henriques, S. Albanie, M. Paganini, G. Varol (eds.). *NeurIPS 2020 Workshop on Pre-registration in Machine Learning.* PMLR 148, 2021. https://proceedings.mlr.press/v148/

9. A. C. Cameron, J. B. Gelbach, D. L. Miller. *Bootstrap-Based Improvements for Inference with Clustered Errors.* Review of Economics and Statistics 90(3), 2008. doi:10.1162/rest.90.3.414

10. K. Chua, R. Calandra, R. McAllister, S. Levine. *Deep Reinforcement Learning in a Handful of Trials using Probabilistic Dynamics Models.* NeurIPS 2018. arXiv:1805.12114, 2018.

11. S. Fort, H. Hu, B. Lakshminarayanan. *Deep Ensembles: A Loss Landscape Perspective.* arXiv:1912.02757, 2019.

12. C. Guo, G. Pleiss, Y. Sun, K. Q. Weinberger. *On Calibration of Modern Neural Networks.* ICML 2017. arXiv:1706.04599, 2017.

13. D. Hafner, T. Lillicrap, I. Fischer, R. Villegas, D. Ha, H. Lee, J. Davidson. *Learning Latent Dynamics for Planning from Pixels.* ICML 2019 (PMLR 97). arXiv:1811.04551, 2019.

14. D. Hafner, T. Lillicrap, M. Norouzi, J. Ba. *Mastering Atari with Discrete World Models.* ICLR 2021. arXiv:2010.02193, 2021.

15. M. Havasi, R. Jenatton, S. Fort, J. Z. Liu, J. Snoek, B. Lakshminarayanan, A. M. Dai, D. Tran. *Training independent subnetworks for robust prediction.* ICLR 2021. arXiv:2010.06610, 2021.

16. P. Henderson, R. Islam, P. Bachman, J. Pineau, D. Precup, D. Meger. *Deep Reinforcement Learning that Matters.* AAAI 2018. arXiv:1709.06560; doi:10.1609/aaai.v32i1.11694, 2018.

17. M. Janner, J. Fu, M. Zhang, S. Levine. *When to Trust Your Model: Model-Based Policy Optimization.* NeurIPS 2019. arXiv:1906.08253, 2019.

18. R. Kidambi, A. Rajeswaran, P. Netrapalli, T. Joachims. *MOReL : Model-Based Offline Reinforcement Learning.* NeurIPS 2020. arXiv:2005.05951, 2020.

19. D. P. Kingma, J. Ba. *Adam: A Method for Stochastic Optimization.* ICLR 2015. arXiv:1412.6980, 2015.

20. V. Kuleshov, N. Fenner, S. Ermon. *Accurate Uncertainties for Deep Learning Using Calibrated Regression.* ICML 2018. arXiv:1807.00263, 2018.

21. B. Lakshminarayanan, A. Pritzel, C. Blundell. *Simple and Scalable Predictive Uncertainty Estimation using Deep Ensembles.* NeurIPS 2017. arXiv:1612.01474, 2017.

22. N. O. Lambert, A. Wilcox, H. Zhang, K. S. J. Pister, R. Calandra. *Learning Accurate Long-term Dynamics for Model-based Reinforcement Learning.* IEEE CDC 2021. arXiv:2012.09156; doi:10.1109/cdc45484.2021.9683134, 2021.

23. S. Lee, S. Purushwalkam, M. Cogswell, D. Crandall, D. Batra. *Why M Heads are Better than One: Training a Diverse Ensemble of Deep Networks.* arXiv:1511.06314, 2015.

24. L. Lindemann, M. Cleaveland, G. Shim, G. J. Pappas. *Safe Planning in Dynamic Environments using Conformal Prediction.* IEEE RA-L 2023. arXiv:2210.10254; doi:10.1109/lra.2023.3292071, 2023.

25. C. Lu, P. J. Ball, J. Parker-Holder, M. A. Osborne, S. J. Roberts. *Revisiting Design Choices in Offline Model-Based Reinforcement Learning.* ICLR 2022 (Spotlight). arXiv:2110.04135, 2022.

26. A. Malik, V. Kuleshov, J. Song, D. Nemer, H. Seymour, S. Ermon. *Calibrated Model-Based Deep Reinforcement Learning.* ICML 2019 (PMLR 97:4314-4323). arXiv:1906.08312, 2019.

27. I. Osband, C. Blundell, A. Pritzel, B. Van Roy. *Deep Exploration via Bootstrapped DQN.* NeurIPS 2016. arXiv:1602.04621, 2016.

28. I. Osband, J. Aslanides, A. Cassirer. *Randomized Prior Functions for Deep Reinforcement Learning.* NeurIPS 2018. arXiv:1806.03335, 2018.

29. Y. Ovadia, E. Fertig, J. Ren, Z. Nado, D. Sculley, S. Nowozin, J. V. Dillon, B. Lakshminarayanan, J. Snoek. *Can You Trust Your Model's Uncertainty? Evaluating Predictive Uncertainty Under Dataset Shift.* NeurIPS 2019. arXiv:1906.02530, 2019.

30. M. Seitzer, A. Tavakoli, D. Antic, G. Martius. *On the Pitfalls of Heteroscedastic Uncertainty Estimation with Probabilistic Neural Networks.* ICLR 2022. arXiv:2203.09168, 2022.

31. K. Stankeviciute, A. M. Alaa, M. van der Schaar. *Conformal Time-series Forecasting.* NeurIPS 2021. https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper_files/paper/2021/hash/312f1ba2a72318edaaa995a67835fad5-Abstract.html

32. E. Talvitie. *Self-Correcting Models for Model-Based Reinforcement Learning.* AAAI 2017. arXiv:1612.06018; doi:10.1609/aaai.v31i1.10850, 2017.

33. A. Venkatraman, M. Hebert, J. A. Bagnell. *Improving Multi-Step Prediction of Learned Time Series Models.* AAAI 2015. doi:10.1609/aaai.v29i1.9590

34. Y. Wen, D. Tran, J. Ba. *BatchEnsemble: An Alternative Approach to Efficient Ensemble and Lifelong Learning.* ICLR 2020. arXiv:2002.06715, 2020.

35. T. Yu, G. Thomas, L. Yu, S. Ermon, J. Zou, S. Levine, C. Finn, T. Ma. *MOPO: Model-based Offline Policy Optimization.* NeurIPS 2020. arXiv:2005.13239, 2020.

Entries 3–35 are generated from `results/t1_bibliography_verified.json`*. Each was checked against the paper itself: title and full author list from the arXiv record or, for an entry with no arXiv id, from its DOI's Crossref record or its proceedings page; venue from the record or the paper's first page; and every sentence this paper attributes matched verbatim against that paper's own text: 33 of 33 entries and 19 of 19 attributed fragments, 3 of them single common words whose match verifies nothing about the attribution (ledger* `D-35`*). No entry was added that was not verified.*

A Verification chain

What every downstream number rests on. Each level was passed before the next was attempted.

level	claim	result
shapes	parameter counts match the reference	exact
wiring	inference outputs match the reference module	**0.000e+00**, bitwise
indexing	the harness feeds the actions it claims	bitwise against the raw CSV
residual	the zero-delta model is the hold-last floor	1.192e-07
objective	**losses and gradients match**	**0.000e+00 across 7 terms, 106 tensors**
trainer	can memorise a single batch	1,506× loss reduction

B Reproducing

```
./setup.sh                      # clone upstreams at pinned commits
python3.11 -m venv .venv && . .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
./reproduce.sh --quick --force # everything except training
```

`--force` matters: a clean clone already contains each stage's declared output, so without it every stage skips.

Runtime. Training stages are excluded by `--quick`, which is what makes the quick path practical. Training all 33 runs takes **49.8 hours** of recorded wall clock on two CPU cores: 19.7 hours for the 6 runs at 10,000 iterations and 30.1 for the remaining 27 at 2,500. The longest single run is 4.4 hours. Every figure here is read from the `wall_clock_s` field of the run artifacts rather than estimated.

5 of those 33 runs, 1.9 hours, are `M-49`'s capacity-matched arm at `rnn_hidden_size 124` rather than the released 256. They are part of this project's CPU spend and are counted in the total above — the other 47.9 hours are the 28 runs at the released width, and the two parts are asserted to make the total rather than stated beside it. They are **not** part of the 28 runs of §6.3's σ-collapse family, because §6.3's rate is a property of one architecture and mixing widths into it would make "nearly identical across runs" a claim about two different models. Every run artifact records the width it trained at, and `paper_numbers.py` selects the collapse family by that field rather than by filename; `docs/BUILD_CHECKS.md`, shipped as supplementary, records how that selection came to be made.

The pre-submission runs are counted separately. §5.2's sweep and §5.3's baselines added 42 runs and **28.3 hours**: 24 sweep runs (13.4 h), then 9 teacher-forced and 9 autoregressive baseline runs (7.9 h and 7.0 h), read from `results/presubmission_runtime.json`. They are outside the total above, whose remainder that paragraph describes as released-width runs, which the baselines are not. Of these, 8 overlapped other CPU work a session logged, which inflates their wall clock and changes no weight; the artifact lists each overlap. Rule X1's Part C (§5.3) ran 2 more teacher-forced RSSM runs from a second queue, 4.2 hours, which are in neither total; 1 of them overlapped CPU work a session logged. Rules X3 and X4 (§5, §5.3)

ran 30 more runs from a third queue, 26.5 hours (24 for X3, 17.7 h; 6 for X4, 8.8 h), also in neither total; 4 of them overlapped CPU work a session logged while that queue ran. That queue's log lost its first runner's lines when another session resumed it, so 4 of its runs are timed by the log and the rest by their weights files, as `results/presubmission_runtime.json` records run by run; the resumed runner's runs overlap no logged work because that session logged none. X1's rows follow the baselines', and X3's and X4's close the table. Per run family, every run at 2,500 iterations (the sweep's centre is §5's Arm A, whose runs are counted above):

run family	runs	hours per run, mean	runs that overlapped other CPU work
(1, 8) (§5.2)	3	0.15	0
(2, 8) (§5.2)	3	0.16	0
(8, 8) (§5.2)	3	0.30	1
(16, 8) (§5.2)	3	0.51	2
(32, 1) (§5.2)	3	0.51	0
(32, 2) (§5.2)	3	0.74	3
(32, 16) (§5.2)	3	0.78	1
(32, 32) (§5.2)	3	1.32	1
MLP, teacher-forced (§5.3)	3	0.04	0
RSSM, teacher-forced (§5.3)	3	1.88	0
transformer, teacher-forced (§5.3)	3	0.71	0
MLP, autoregressive (§5.3)	3	0.06	0
RSSM, autoregressive (§5.3)	3	1.53	0
transformer, autoregressive (§5.3)	3	0.74	0
RSSM, teacher-forced, PlaNet's KL settings (rule X1, §5.3)	1	2.11	1
RSSM, teacher-forced, DreamerV2's layer-normalised cell (rule X1, §5.3)	1	2.10	0
Arm A, autoregressive, each episode held out in turn (rule X3, §5)	12	0.74	2
Arm B, teacher-forced, each episode held out in turn (rule X3, §5)	12	0.73	2
MLP, autoregressive, size-matched (rule X4, §5.3)	3	0.10	0
transformer, autoregressive, size-matched (rule X4, §5.3)	3	2.83	0

C What testing the untested claims would require

This appendix is now section S1 of the supplementary material (`docs/SUPPLEMENT.md`).

D Every claim of the originals, and what we did with it

The body's §4 summarises the first table. It is here in full because the third column — what the original actually reports — is the answer to a question a reader of any reproduction should ask, and because "no quantitative figure" is itself a finding that deserves to be checkable row by row. Its verdict cells quote figures from the sections they cite, each on that section's arena, n_independent and checkpoint; the second table gives them claim by claim.

*Section references follow arXiv:2501.10100**v1**, which uses Roman-numeral sectioning. v2 renumbered to Arabic and moved IV-C's material into Appendix A.4.1. References to arXiv:2504.16680 follow **v1**, which is the version we read; it is now at v3 (8 Jan 2026), where §5.1 and Eq. 4–5 keep their numbers but every figure and appendix table has moved — Figure 2 (right) became Figure 3 (right), and the model was renamed RWM-O to RWM-U, which is a re-expansion of the letter ("Offline Robotic World Model" to "Uncertainty-Aware Robotic World Model") rather than a second variant: no version of the paper contains both names. All locations, and the occurrence counts that establish that, are recorded in `results/original_paper_figures.json`.*

claim, and where	tested	what the original reports	verdict
RWM-AR consistently outperforms RWM-TF (2501.10100 §IV-D)	**yes**	**no quantitative figure.** "significantly outperforms"; the gap is plotted in Fig. 7 and stated nowhere in text, caption or table	**reproduces** at long horizon (§5); retrained on fixed folds with each episode held out once it replicates, +2.2275 [+1.3683, +3.5053] at h = 368 over all ten episodes' 20 trajectories at 2,500 iterations, not 10,000 (rule X3: **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS**, §5, Appendix L), and scored with the released evaluation's timing rule M-23's verdict stands (rule X8: **SAME VERDICT**, Appendix Z)
Teacher forcing gives "poor autoregressive performance" (§IV-C)	**yes**	**quantitative**: Fig. 6 prints e for the teacher-forced N=1 row, 3.99 at (32, 1) against 0.47 at the centre, on unstated data and horizon; the passage itself gives no number	reproduces, and more strongly: on the 400-step unit Arm B is worse than the hold-last floor at every horizon (on M-64's shorter units only at the longest they reach), and §5.2's (32, 1) is 6.35× the centre's error at h = 368
M=32, N=8 gives the optimal trade-off between accuracy and training time (§IV-C)	**yes**	**quantitative**: Fig. 6 prints the error and the training hours of every cell of its grid, and the centre's error is the tied-lowest (`docs/presubmission/ORIGINAL_SPECS.md` a.5)	**NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET** on accuracy alone (§5.2): (32, 32), (32, 16), (8, 8) and (2, 8) beat it at our budget (no reading its rule reports puts the centre ahead of any of them), but the ranking depends on training length: trained longer, the centre passes each of them on at least one reading (post hoc, §5.2, Appendix U). The trade-off with training time is not tested; the original's printed hours are consistent with it. Under the released evaluation's timing the rule keeps its verdict (rule X8: **SAME VERDICT**, Appendix Z)
Beats MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines (§IV-D)	**yes**	**no quantitative figure.** "consistently achieves the lowest prediction errors across all environments"; plotted in Fig. 7, with no number in text, caption or table	**REPRODUCES** with the baselines teacher-forced, as the original trains them, and **RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE** with them trained autoregressively, which compares architectures at one training regime rather than testing this claim (§5.3). Both are the rules' verdicts at h = 368; from h = 32 and h = 128 respectively, every reading the rules report gives them, and at shorter horizons they split. The baselines are built to our reading of Table S7 and trained with RWM's settings; at h = 368 every one is worse than predicting no change, and rule X1's other read-outs and retraining variants did not rescue our RSSM (**NOT RESCUED BY THE SETTINGS TRIED**), so the RSSM comparison stays uninformative and the claim rests on the MLP and the transformer. Matched to RWM's parameter count, they return **PARTIAL** (rule X4): the MLP is behind (RWM BETTER) and the transformer cannot be settled (CANNOT BE SETTLED), matching size being one axis only (§5.3). Under the released evaluation's timing both rules keep their verdicts (rule X8: **SAME VERDICT**, Appendix Z). One robot where the original has several

claim, and where	tested	what the original reports	verdict
Zero-shot hardware transfer (§IV-E)	no	—	`[hardware: zero-shot transfer]` no hardware; this is a dynamics-model reproduction
Policies transfer to hardware from ~6M state transitions against ~250M for the model-free baseline (§IV-E) — the paper's headline sample-efficiency result	no	**6M against 250M state transitions** at equal real tracking reward (0.90 +- 0.04 against 0.90 +- 0.03), Table I — the only table of numbers in either paper	`[policy, hardware: the sample-efficiency result]` **not tested.** It is a claim about policy learning and hardware deployment, and requires the RL loop, a simulator and an ANYmal. We reproduce the dynamics model only; no policy is trained anywhere in this work, so no transition count of ours is comparable
MBPO-PPO beats SHAC and Dreamer (§IV-E)	no	—	`[policy: the comparisons against SHAC and Dreamer]` no policy learning reproduced
Generality across quadruped, humanoid, manipulation (§IV-D)	no	plotted in Fig. 7; no numbers in text	`[model: generality across robot morphologies]` one released dataset, ANYmal D flat
Epistemic "closely follows the trend of the prediction error", justifying "its role as a trust metric" (2504.16680v1 §5.1)	**yes**	**no quantitative figure.** A "strong correlation" is asserted with no coefficient, interval or sample size; plotted in Fig. 2 (right)	**supported as a scalar ranking, against a real baseline** — the applied scalar correlates +0.605 [+0.545, +0.694] with realised error at n_independent = 20, beats the forecast-index counter at every horizon — though **not** the free `step-size` counter over whole trajectories at h = 368, +0.4697 against +0.6053, a margin below the 0.2891 minimum detectable effect (SURVIVES entry-res ONLY: disagreement beats the one-step error before the window, but not the model's predicted step size), which on 70 shorter units at h = 100 it does beat, +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896] (rule X6: **DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE**, Appendix X) — and survives 5 controls on forecast depth — the linear partial that keeps +0.596, and four harder ones — plus a sixth on trajectory difficulty — the last giving +0.419 [+0.318, +0.576] with both the rollout and the depth held constant (§6.6, M-45). **Weaker per-dimension**: at h = 368 the 45-of-45 sign count gives a permutation P of 0.0435 (out-of-sample) and 0.0775 (in-sample), and no cell survives multiplicity correction (§6.5). **Not supported as a scale**: 33.4× overconfident at h = 100, the method's own rollout length, and 34.4× at the h = 368 diagnostic horizon; a per-horizon rescaling brings the released checkpoint near nominal, but on a model that has not seen the test episodes it does so in only 17 of 36 cells (§6.7)

claim, and where	tested	what the original reports	verdict
Aleatoric "remains low, reflecting small stochasticity" (2504.16680v1 §5.1)	**yes**	**no quantitative figure.** "Low" is relative to the epistemic curve on the same axes of Fig. 2 (right); no absolute value, and no comparison against realised error	the observation holds; the explanation does not (§6.3)
Offline MBRL on real robots (2504.16680v1)	no	—	`[policy, hardware: offline MBRL on real robots]` not tested
Penalising rewards by ensemble disagreement improves the learned policy (2504.16680v1 Eq. 4–5, §5) — the follow-up's core method claim	no	Fig. 3 (right) plots epistemic uncertainty under three penalty weights during training; no numbers	`[policy: the core claim that penalising rewards by disagreement improves the learned policy]` **not tested.** We measure the penalty quantity itself — what it is (§6.1), how well it ranks error (§6.6), whether it is calibrated (§6.2) — but never train a policy with or without it. Our findings bound what the quantity *reports*, not what it *costs* (§11); a test of the cost needing no policy, rule X5, could not be run (Appendix W)

What each tested claim rests on. The second table is §3.2's: one row per headline claim of this paper, with the section that owns it. Each row gives its own arena and number of independent units, its checkpoint, whether that arena is in-sample for the model measured, the verdict as its rule or analysis returned it, and whether it survives multiplicity correction. It is generated from the artifacts each claim is computed from (`results/evidence_summary.json`).

claim (§)	arena (n_ independent)	checkpoint	in-sample for the model measured?	verdict	survives multiplicity correction?
Autoregressive training beats teacher forcing at h = 368 (§5)	out-of-sample (4)	10,000 iterations	no	gap excludes zero, favouring autoregressive training (under the released evaluation's timing, rule X8: SAME VERDICT)	not applicable at 10,000; the 500- and 2,500-iteration cells survive Holm (Appendix L)
The same comparison reverses at h = 1, at the short unit M-64 built (§5)	out-of-sample (60)	10,000 iterations	no	gap excludes zero, favouring teacher forcing	not applicable
The same comparison at h = 368, retrained on fixed folds with each episode held out once, at 2,500 iterations (rule X3) (§5)	all ten episodes (20)	2,500 iterations	no	REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS: gap +2.2275 [+1.3683, +3.5053]; 10 of 10 episodes positive	not applicable

claim (§)	arena (n_ independent)	checkpoint	in-sample for the model measured?	verdict	survives multiplicity correction?
(M, N) = (32, 8) is the optimal configuration on accuracy alone (the accuracy half of the trade-off) (§5.2)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET; 4 of 8 neighbours beat the centre, and no reading the rule reports puts the centre ahead of any of them; the ranking depends on training length (Appendix U) (under the released evaluation's timing, rule X8: SAME VERDICT)	yes
RWM beats MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines trained with RWM's settings, at h = 368 (teacher-forced, as the original trains them; the RSSM comparison uninformative, rule X1) (§5.3)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	REPRODUCES; every reading the rule reports returns it from h = 32, and below that the readings split; at h = 368 every baseline is worse than predicting no change (under the released evaluation's timing, rule X8: SAME VERDICT)	yes
RWM beats MLP, RSSM and transformer baselines trained with RWM's settings, at h = 368 (trained autoregressively: architecture at one training regime, not the original's claim; the RSSM comparison uninformative, rule X1) (§5.3)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE; every reading the rule reports returns it from h = 128, and below that the readings split; at h = 368 every baseline is worse than predicting no change (under the released evaluation's timing, rule X8: SAME VERDICT)	yes
RWM beats MLP and transformer baselines matched to its parameter count, at h = 368 (rule X4; size is one axis) (§5.3)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	PARTIAL: MLP RWM BETTER, transformer CANNOT BE SETTLED	yes
Ensemble disagreement is smaller than realised error, at h = 1 (§6.2)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	overconfident; the ratio interval excludes 1	not applicable

claim (§)	arena (n_ independent)	checkpoint	in-sample for the model measured?	verdict	survives multiplicity correction?
Ensemble disagreement is smaller than realised error, at h = 100 (§6.2)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	overconfident; the ratio interval excludes 1	not applicable
The aleatoric σ head has collapsed and is orders of magnitude smaller than realised error, at h = 1 (§6.2)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	overconfident; the ratio interval excludes 1	not applicable
Disagreement ranks realised error better than the forecast step index, at h = 100 (§6.6)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	paired difference excludes zero	not applicable
Disagreement ranks realised error better than the model's own predicted step size, over whole 400-step trajectories at h = 368 (§6.6)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	SURVIVES entry-res ONLY (disagreement beats the one-step error before the window, but not the model's predicted step size): step size not beaten, the margin below the minimum detectable effect; the partial survives	could not at this n
The same comparison on shorter units, at h = 100 (rule X6) (§6.6)	all ten episodes (70)	released	yes	DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE: margin +0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896], against a minimum detectable effect of 0.1713	not applicable
With both the rollout and the depth held constant, disagreement still tracks error (§6.6)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	interval excludes zero and clears the minimum detectable effect	not applicable
A per-horizon multiplier brings coverage near nominal where a constant one does not (§6.7)	held-out pair (4)	released	yes	every released-checkpoint point estimate unseen by the multiplier within tolerance; on Arm A at 2,500 iterations, unseen by its model too, 17 of 36 epistemic cells; tolerance not resolvable at this arena	could not at this n

claim (§)	arena (n_ independent)	checkpoint	in-sample for the model measured?	verdict	survives multiplicity correction?
A per-horizon multiplier fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth (rule X7) (§6.7)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	WITHIN BAND AT 6 OF 6 HORIZONS for the disagreement; the aleatoric term, alongside, WITHIN BAND AT 3 OF 6 HORIZONS	not applicable
An ensemble that shares no trunk is better calibrated than the released topology (§6.8)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	MECHANISM SUPPORTED	not applicable
The same contrast at matched capacity (§6.8)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	UNDER-POWERED — favours the matched ensemble by less than the MDE	could not at this n
Independence and the corrected objective together improve on the released topology (§6.8)	out-of-sample (4)	2,500 iterations	no	THE COMBINATION IMPROVES CALIBRATION	not applicable
The released evaluation pairs states and actions one step stale (§7.2)	all ten episodes (20)	released	yes	defect confirmed in the code; raises error up to h = 32 on relative-L1; not resolved from h = 100	not applicable

E Every pre-registered rule, its lead time and its verdict

§8's argument rests on decision rules committed to git before the data that tested them, and the body names those rules by identifier. An identifier with no table behind it is either decoration or an instruction to open a 734 KB ledger, so here is the table. It is generated from `FINDINGS_LEDGER.md` and `results/appendix_g_rules.json`; nothing in it is typed.

Lead time is the rule's commit timestamp subtracted from the commit that first held the data it tested, never by a stored hash: the first rules' commits are found by *subject*, because the history was rewritten once and two of the commits Figure 1 cites changed hash (Data and code), and the later rules' by the commit that introduced their ledger heading. Positive means the rule was in git before the data existed. This is the same computation Figure 1 plots. A rule whose data do not exist yet has neither a lead time nor a verdict, and Figure 1 leaves it out until they do.

rule	what it governs	commit	lead time	tested by	verdict
`M-16`	The Arm A / Arm B comparison	`C004` Step 5: pre-register the decision rule before launching any main run	+1.3 h	first main-run data	CANNOT BE SETTLED AT THIS BUDGET
`M-22`	Whether episode difficulty biases the A/B comparison	`C013` Pre-register the Task 4b difficulty-bias rule, and the two-arena convention	+5 min	M-16 re-evaluated	RESOLVED — branch 1, 4c not run

rule	what it governs	commit	lead time	tested by	verdict
M-23	The 10,000-iteration comparison	C016 5.1: pre-register M-23, the long-horizon decision rule	+2 min	10k runs launched	RESOLVED — reproduces at long horizon
M-43	The ensemble-5 replication	C081 PRE-REGISTER the ensemble-5 replication rule, before the runs exist	+13.3 h	ens5 result committed	DOES NOT GENERALISE
M-44	The trunk-sharing mechanism	C090 PRE-REGISTER M-44 and M-45, with the power check M-43 was committed without	+6.4 h	R2 result committed	MECHANISM SUPPORTED
M-45	The within-trajectory control	C090 PRE-REGISTER M-44 and M-45, with the power check M-43 was committed without	+4.4 h	A2 result committed	DISAGREEMENT CARRIES WITHIN-ROLLOUT INFORMATION
M-49	Pre-registered: does trunk-sharing survive capacity matching?	C123 M-49: pre-register the capacity-matched test, with the MDE that bounds it	+9.4 h	results/m49_ capacity_ matched.json	UNDER-POWERED — favours the matched ensemble by less than the MDE
M-50	Pre-registered: is the sigma collapse driven by the objective, on data whose noise is known?	C127 M-50 pre-registered, and a different-architecture run stopped contaminating §6.3	+5 min	results/e5_ synthetic_ sigma.json	OBJECTIVE-DRIVEN
M-51	Pre-registered: does the ranking claim survive more than one free adversary?	C128 M-51 pre-registered: two more free adversaries for the ranking claim	+12 min	results/e7_ free_baselines .json	SURVIVES entry-res ONLY
M-52	M-51 named a quantity that does not exist, and what replaced it	C129 M-52: M-51 named a quantity that does not exist, corrected before it ran	+9 min	results/e7_ free_baselines .json	SURVIVES entry-res ONLY
M-62	Pre-registered: does any headline verdict change when the bootstrap resamples episodes rather than 400-step trajectories?	C154 M-62 to M-65: four rules committed before the data that will test them	+5.1 h	results/m62_ episode_ clustering.json	NO MOVE
M-63	Pre-registered: is the h=1 coverage failure uniform across the 45 state dimensions, or carried by a few?	C154 M-62 to M-65: four rules committed before the data that will test them	+5.1 h	results/m63_ per_ dimension_ coverage.json	UNIFORM
M-64	Pre-registered: does the horizon-scoped power increase from shorter evaluation units change any verdict at h $\leq$ 128?	C154 M-62 to M-65: four rules committed before the data that will test them	+6.0 h	results/m64_ short_units .json	MOVES, at one cell

rule	what it governs	commit	lead time	tested by	verdict
M-65	Pre-registered: is the Gaussian nominal of 68.27% defensible, or is the error distribution heavy-tailed?	C154 M-62 to M-65: four rules committed before the data that will test them	+5.1 h	results/m65_ gaussian_ nominal.json	NOT HEAVY-TAILED, in every one of 48 model x horizon cells
M-68	The combined arm: independence and the corrected objective together	C180 Pre-register M-68: the combined arm's rule, its verdict branches and its minimum detectable effect	+5.1 h	results/r2_ combined_arm .json	THE COMBINATION IMPROVES CALIBRATION
M-69	The cross-model transfer of the per-horizon multiplier table	C182 Pre-register M-69: the cross-model transfer rule, its criterion and its minimum detectable effect	+23 min	results/task_ d3_cross_ model.json	DOES NOT TRANSFER — A PROPERTY OF THE MODEL
M-70	Whether the per-horizon correction reorders cumulative penalties	C206 Pre-register M-70: whether the per-horizon correction reorders cumulative penalties	+115.2 h	results/q3_ penalty_ reordering.json	DOES NOT REORDER
M-74	The configuration claim: is (M, N) = (32, 8) optimal?	C225 PRE-REGISTER the M/N sweep and architecture-baseline rules, before the runs exist	+29.4 h	results/mn_ sweep_verdict .json	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
M-75	The architecture claim, baselines teacher-forced, as the original trains them	C225 PRE-REGISTER the M/N sweep and architecture-baseline rules, before the runs exist	+29.4 h	results/ baselines_ verdict.json	REPRODUCES
M-76	The architecture claim, baselines trained autoregressively, as RWM is	C225 PRE-REGISTER the M/N sweep and architecture-baseline rules, before the runs exist	+29.4 h	results/ baselines_ verdict.json	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
M-80	X1: is our RSSM's long-horizon failure a matter of how its forecast is read, of its training settings, or of neither?	C301 PRE-REGISTER RSSM diagnostic X1, before its readings exist	+3 min	results/rssm_ diagnostics.json	NOT RESCUED BY THE SETTINGS TRIED
M-84	X2: do our trained models condition their forecasts on the action they are given?	C409 PRE-REGISTER action-sensitivity rule X2, before its readings exist	+7 min	results/action_ sensitivity.json	RESPONDS TO THE ACTION at 2,500 and at 10,000 iterations
M-86	X3: does the base claim replicate when each episode is held out in turn?	C490 PRE-REGISTER X3 cross-fold replication and X4 size-matched baselines, before their runs exist	+121.2 h	results/x3_ cross_fold.json	REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS
M-87	X4: is RWM still ahead of baselines matched to its size?	C490 PRE-REGISTER X3 cross-fold replication and X4 size-matched baselines, before their runs exist	+121.2 h	results/x4_ matched_ baselines.json	PARTIAL
M-88	X6: does ensemble disagreement beat the model's own predicted step size on more, shorter units?	C496 PRE-REGISTER X5–X8, inference-only rules, before their readings exist	+11 min	results/x6_ stepsize_ short_units .json	DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE

rule	what it governs	commit	lead time	tested by	verdict
M-89	X7: per-horizon recalibration, fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth	C496 PRE-REGISTER X5–X8, inference-only rules, before their readings exist	+11 min	results/x7_loeo_recalibration.json	WITHIN BAND AT 6 OF 6 HORIZONS (epistemic)
M-90	X8: would any verdict change under the released evaluation's action timing?	C496 PRE-REGISTER X5–X8, inference-only rules, before their readings exist	+11 min	results/x8_released_pairing.json	SAME VERDICT for M-74, M-75, M-76 and the A/B comparison
S-12	"Task 3's duplication rule was pre-registered"	C025 Task 3: the duplication control confirms R-47's mechanism and refutes its statistic	-2.9 h	control runs finished 21:37:51	RETRACTED

M-69's discharge commit was amended 2 minutes after it was created, so its lead time is +21 min by that commit's author time and +23 min by its committer time. Both are positive, so the rule reached git before its data on either reading.

28 rules, 28 with a computed lead time, of which 27 are positive and 1 negative. **The negative one is kept deliberately.** S-12 withdraws the claim that the Task 3 duplication rule was pre-registered; the control runs had finished before any threshold reached git. A table that dropped it would be asserting exactly what the ledger retracts.

M-52 is in the table and that is deliberate. It is the one mid-flight amendment to a pre-registration in this project: M-51 named a baseline that does not exist in the artifact it named — the residual on the last teacher-forced step of the history window, which the rollout helper never computes because it copies the history rather than predicting it — and M-52 names the replacement, committed before the replacement's statistic was computed. A table of pre-registrations that omitted the one amendment would be a highlights reel, so the table's rows are selected by each entry's Status line and their count is asserted against the set scripts/ledger_check.py reports.

What each rule says, in its own committed words is in the supplementary material, as docs/APPENDIX_G_RULES.md — every rule's text unabridged, generated from the ledger by the same script that generates this table. Quoting all 28 in full here would add pages to an appendix whose job is to be checkable at a glance, and quoting them in part would ship quotations ending mid-sentence. The table is the claim; the supplementary is the evidence.

F The variance-state arithmetic behind §7.5

§7.5 states the conclusion. The arithmetic and the five assumptions it rests on are in docs/APPENDIX_G_VARIANCE_ARITHMETIC.md, shipped as supplementary, kept out of the body because the numbered claim it once supported is retracted (S-19) and because a forensic case the section then defuses with the author's own reply is not what a reader needs in the body of a reproduction.

So the finding is not that the release is internally inconsistent. It is that **the released artifacts do not reproduce the released checkpoint's variance state, and the author's account is that the released repository is not the one that trained it.** That is a **documentation gap between a release and a run**: common, worth recording, and much less interesting than an inconsistency. The σ collapse is linear in iteration count and its rate is nearly identical across our runs (§6.3), which makes it a clock, and read as a clock it puts the checkpoint's variance state out of reach of a constant-rate run from the released initialisation at the configured learning rate, at every iteration count the release, the paper and the checkpoint tag state. The first author's account is that the released repository is several revisions removed from the setup that trained the checkpoint, which supplies a mechanism, a warm start or a different

`log_delta_logstd` initialisation, that would explain it with no inconsistency at all. We report the arithmetic because it is what let us detect the gap at all, not as a charge against the work.

G The metrics' formulas, the two nRMSE aggregations, and the comparison one of them inverted

The metrics' formulas (§3.1). §3.1 states each metric in words. Its formulas, as implemented, and the check on the coverage nominal stood there as follows.

Relative-L1 is the reference's own metric, reproduced in behaviour (`model_training.py:203`) so that our numbers are comparable to the upstream's printed one. On config-normalised states, per forecast step,

$$r_t \;=\; \frac{\sum_{d=1}^{45} \left|\hat{s}_{t,d} - s_{t,d}\right|}{\sum_{d=1}^{45} \left|s_{t,d}\right|}$$

and the reported figure is the flat mean over trajectories and steps,

$$e \;=\; \frac{1}{B\,(T - t_0)} \sum_{b=1}^{B} \sum_{t=t_0+1}^{T} r_t^{(b)}$$

with $t_0 = \texttt{history_horizon} = 32$: the first 32 steps are teacher-forced and excluded. The denominator is recomputed at every step as a 45-term sum in normalised space, so it can pass through zero, which is why this metric goes non-finite on low-dimensional state groups and why a second one exists.

Normalised RMSE fixes the denominator once, over the training episodes only:

$$\mathrm{nRMSE}_t \;=\; \frac{\sqrt{\dfrac{1}{45}\sum_{d=1}^{45} \mathrm{MSE}_{t,d}}}{\dfrac{1}{45}\sum_{d=1}^{45} \sigma_d^{\mathrm{tr}}} \quad \text{with} \quad \mathrm{MSE}_{t,d} = \frac{1}{B}\sum_{b=1}^{B} \big(\hat{s}_{t,d}^{(b)} - s_{t,d}^{(b)}\big)^2$$

where the scale constant is

$$\sigma_d^{\mathrm{tr}} \;=\; \mathrm{sd}\big(\{\, \tilde{s}_{i,d} \;:\; \mathrm{episode}(i) \in \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{train}} \,\}\big)$$

computed once, stored in `results/step4_0a_results.json`, and never recomputed per step or derived from held-out data. A value of 1.0 means no better than predicting the training mean. **The aggregation is form 1**: pool the per-dimension mean squared errors, then divide, a ratio of means. A mean of per-dimension ratios gives whichever dimension has the smallest scale unbounded leverage; the rest of this appendix gives both forms and the comparison the second one inverts.

Coverage at $\pm$kσ is the fraction of scalar (trajectory, forecast step, state dimension) triples whose absolute realised error falls within k times the σ predicted for that same triple:

$$\mathrm{cov}_{\pm k\sigma}(h) \;=\; \frac{1}{B\,h\,45} \sum_{b=1}^{B} \sum_{t=t_0+1}^{t_0+h} \sum_{d=1}^{45} \mathbf{1}\left[\, \frac{\left|\hat{s}_{t,d}^{(b)} - s_{t,d}^{(b)}\right|}{\sigma_{t,d}^{(b)}} \;\le\; k \,\right]$$

It is pooled over all three axes with equal weight per triple. It is **cumulative** over steps 1..h: coverage "at h" averages the whole rollout up to h and is not the value at step h, and every horizon-indexed quantity in this paper follows the same convention. Because it is built from an *absolute* error, $z \le k$ is the two-sided event, so the calibrated targets are $\mathrm{erf}(k/\sqrt{2})$: **68.27%** at $\pm 1\sigma$ and **95.45%** at $\pm 2\sigma$. **That nominal is checked rather than assumed.** Rescaling each model's σ by the single constant that makes mean|error|

/ mean σ equal a calibrated Gaussian's 0.7979 lands coverage above the rule's heavy-tail bound of 63.27% in every one of 48 model × horizon cells, with 0 below it (15 within its band around 68.27% and 33 above it; `M-65`), so the shortfalls reported below are a property of the scale and not of the tail.

The overconfidence factor is how many times larger the typical realised error is than the typical predicted σ:

$$\rho(h) \;=\; \frac{\mathrm{mean}_{b,t\le h,d}\left|\hat{s}^{(b)}_{t,d} - s^{(b)}_{t,d}\right|}{\mathrm{mean}_{b,t\le h,d}\;\; \sigma^{(b)}_{t,d}}$$

It too is a **ratio of means**, because a mean of ratios is unbounded whenever a single σ approaches zero, which is exactly the regime §6.3 puts these models in. $\rho = 1$ is *not* calibration: a calibrated Gaussian has mean|error| / $\sigma = \sqrt{2/\pi} = 0.7979$. So ρ is reported as a magnitude of miscalibration and coverage as the calibrated reading, and both appear everywhere.

The two aggregations. §3.1 states that this paper uses **form 1**: pool the per-dimension mean squared errors across the 45 state dimensions, then divide by the pooled scale — a ratio of means. **Form 2** is the mean of per-dimension ratios.

The two differ because the state dimensions differ widely in scale. Form 2 gives whichever dimension has the smallest denominator unbounded leverage over the aggregate, and a dimension that is nearly constant in the training episodes has a very small denominator. Form 1 has no such lever: a dimension contributes in proportion to its share of the total squared error.

Why this appendix exists rather than a sentence. The choice between the two once inverted a published-model comparison in this project's own history — a result that favoured us under one aggregation and did not under the other. The claim was withdrawn on our own evidence and is kept in the record (`FINDINGS_LEDGER.md`). Form 2 figures appear nowhere in the body; they are retained in `results/step4_0a_results.json` for continuity with figures this project published before the inversion was found. This appendix gives the two definitions and the inversion rather than those figures, so continuity rests on that committed file and not on a deleted number.

The definition in force throughout the paper is the one §3.1 gives. Nothing in §5, §6 or §7 uses form 2.

H Findings not in the main text

The ledger tags some of its entries as contributions of this project. These are the confirmed ones the body does not state, or uses without stating the finding itself, each checked against its ledger entry. Code facts are cited by file and line at the pinned upstream commits; every measurement is read from the artifact named. Measurements are at 2,500 training iterations unless a row says otherwise or concerns the released checkpoint, and each row names its arena.

finding	evidence (ledger ID, artifact)	bearing on the paper
Paper-versus-code gaps		
No forecast decay factor exists: the training loss averages every forecast step with equal weight, though the paper describes a decay	C-09; `system_dynamics.py:186-231` and both config files	Our training does the same, so the loss is undecayed in the released code and in ours
The auxiliary heads (contact and termination) are trained on true next states, the state head on its own samples	M-13; `system_dynamics.py:217, 261`	In a rollout the auxiliary heads read predicted states they never trained on; this paper compares states only (§5.3) and does not measure them

finding	evidence (ledger ID, artifact)	bearing on the paper
Training feeds back a reparameterised sample, inference the mean	C-05; `system_dynamics.py:115, 217`	Our arms train and roll out the same way; for the released checkpoint, whose per-member σ has collapsed (§6.3), the sample is numerically the mean
Actions enter the network raw (the config's action mean and standard deviation are zeros and ones), and no action scale is recorded in either repository; measured against joint motion, they are not joint targets in radians	C-07, D-07; `anymal_d_flat_cfg.py`	A perturbation of one size means different things for actions and for states; no reported result perturbs either
The release's configuration, the paper (Table S9, 2,500) and the checkpoint's own tag state three different training lengths; the first author believes the configuration's is a typo	C-13; `base_cfg.py:97`, the checkpoint's `iter` field	§7.5: none of them reaches the released variance state at a constant rate
Pipeline defects		
The reset guard tests index *values* for truthiness, so a reset at the first row would be missed	B-02; `train.py:143`	Latent twice over: this dataset has no reset at its first row and marks none at all (§7.1)
The train/test split draws windows at random, and adjacent windows share all but one of their 40 rows, so the released test loss is not held out	B-03; `model_training.py:33`	The held-out arena (§3) is built from whole episodes and does not use this split
Measurements		
The data hold 21 plateaus of achieved base velocity, two per episode with a third in episode 7; the command itself is not recorded, and the plateaus match the simulator's command resampling	D-10; `results/step0_regimes.json`	A held-out episode is not a near-duplicate of a training one: the held-out pair tests generalisation across velocity commands, within one gait and terrain
`state_min_logstd`, on the slower gradient path C-11 identifies, drifts 5.2× slower than `log_delta_logstd`; extrapolated from one Arm A run's rates, the two imply about 150,000 and 270,000 iterations for the released variance state, an order of magnitude rather than a fitted count	R-25; `results/step6_3_min_logstd.json`	§7.5's conclusion does not rest on one parameter
Over overlapping trajectories on the held-out pair, which the released checkpoint trained on, its worst twentieth carry 92.6% of its squared error at h = 368 as each dimension's own scale weights it (form 2, which `g_z` dominates; Appendix G), and they start within two short ranges of rows, one per episode; on the 4 non-overlapping trajectories the largest is 1.2× the median	R-30; `results/taskAB_gate_r27.json`	A tail measured on overlapping trajectories can be one short stretch of data, which a count of independent trajectories (§3) exposes
The A/B relative-L1 gap at h = 368 (teacher forcing's error minus autoregressive training's, over 2 independent trajectories per episode) is positive on all ten episodes, from +0.73 up; episode 1, one of the held-out pair, gives +6.97, 2.5× the next largest, so the pair's +3.98 is 3.0× the other eight episodes' +1.33	R-39; `results/task4_arenas.json`	The direction is robust across episodes; a magnitude read from the held-out pair overstates the typical episode

finding	evidence (ledger ID, artifact)	bearing on the paper
Per state dimension, over the whole 368-step forecast, the released checkpoint loses to the hold-last floor on 18 of 45 across all ten episodes (20 independent 400-step trajectories) and on 8 on the held-out pair (4), including all three components of the gravity vector; Arm A at 10,000 iterations loses on 1 in each, `g_z`	R-45, and R-29 on overlapping trajectories; `results/task2_3_matched_trend.json`	Per dimension, a model trained from scratch fails far less often, even on the pair the checkpoint trained on and Arm A did not. In aggregate it does not: on the held-out pair the released checkpoint is ahead at h = 8 and level at h = 368 (R-45). One seed (seed 1, supplementary S2)
Over five checkpoints up to 10,000 iterations, the absolute A/B gap at h = 368 narrows as both arms improve (held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, +3.33 to +1.20; in-sample, n_independent = 16, +1.72 to +0.87), while the ratio does not shrink (3.34× to 4.43×, in-sample 2.33× to 9.70×). The held-out values are not monotone: both peak at the second checkpoint (+6.74, 12.38×), one anomalous Arm B value	R-46; `results/task2_3_matched_trend.json`	An absolute effect quoted early overstates what remains, a ratio does not, and §5 reports ratios at 10,000 iterations; one seed (seed 1, supplementary S2)
Our trained models respond to the action they are given: fed another trajectory's actions, Arm A's error at h = 8 on its in-sample arena's 16 trajectories rises by +227.8% at 2,500 iterations and +676.3% at 10,000 (rule X2, pre-registered: RESPONDS TO THE ACTION)	M-84, M-85; `results/action_sensitivity.json`	A world model must respond to actions before it can serve policy optimisation; ours do on this test, though every action in the data comes from one policy and no policy is trained here (§7.2, Appendix V)

§6.1 in full: the penalised quantity and the discarded term, from the first author. §6.1 keeps two sentences of this passage.

Eq. 4 specifies a **variance** while `system_dynamics.py:126` computes a **standard deviation**, which with $\lambda = 1$ differ by a square. We asked, and the first author confirms the code is operative: the penalty is applied to the standard deviation as intended, and Eq. 4 is "more of a high-level explanation" (personal communication, 21 August 2026, quoted with the first author's permission; the exchange is reproduced, anonymised, in the supplementary `SUPPLEMENTARY_CORRESPONDENCE.md`, and see Data and code). We measure the code's quantity throughout, which is the intended one.

The same correspondence confirms the discard directly: "the aleatoric term is not used in downstream training. It is reported in Fig. 3 (right) as an analysis of the model behavior." (The figure number follows arXiv:2504.16680**v1**; in the current v3 it is Fig. 4, and the crosswalk is in `results/original_paper_figures.json`.) So the discard is the intended design, not an implementation slip: the aleatoric head, the one the state loss and the bound loss shape and §6.3 explains, is computed on every imagination step to shape training and be inspected, and is never consumed.

I Related work in full, the PETS lineage of the bounded σ head, and how often its descendants substitute the objective

Where the parameterisation comes from. The bounded log-σ head that §6.3 shows has its optimum at $\sigma = 0$ is largely not this codebase's invention: its clamp is inherited, line for line, from the probabilistic ensembles of Chua, Calandra, McAllister and Levine (PETS, NeurIPS 2018). PETS's Appendix A.1 gives

```
logvar = max_logvar - softplus(max_logvar - logvar)
logvar = min_logvar + softplus(logvar - min_logvar)
```

and `architectures/mlp.py:92-93` is those two lines in log-standard-deviation rather than log-variance, with `system_dynamics.py:302` supplying PETS's regulariser on the bounds.

What is **not** inherited is the objective, and one line of the bounds. PETS uses "the negative log prediction probability as our loss function", and that likelihood's log-σ term opposes $\sigma \to 0$; `system_dynamics.py:283` substitutes squared error on a reparameterised sample, which has no such term. And `architectures/mlp.py:91` builds the upper bound as the floor plus a learned positive gap, where PETS keeps the two bounds independent. §6.3 needs both changes: the substitution removes the log-σ term, and the tie is why the bound regulariser does not take its place, since the floor cancels out of it. In a descendant that kept PETS's independent bounds, the same regulariser pushes the floor up while the objective pulls σ down onto it, a case §6.3 does not derive and we have not tested (ledger `M-72`). So **a descendant of this lineage that replaced the likelihood with a sampled squared error, and left nothing pushing its variance floor back up, would inherit the same optimum.** That is a hypothesis about mechanism, untested in any other descendant (§11).

How often the substitution is made, which narrows the hypothesis. Of 10 public repositories examined on 20 September 2026 under the protocol in `results/q1_search_protocol.md`, 10 carry the construction and 1 of those trains it against a sampled squared error, and that one only in an optional value-aware mode; the other 9 keep PETS's likelihood (`results/q1_pets_descendants.json`). The protocol counts a repository only if it has the bounded head, learnable bounds, and a loss that squares the error of a *sampled* prediction; squaring the error of the predicted *mean*, an option several of these repositories offer, leaves σ untrained rather than driving it to zero, and does not count. We read "learnable" as "trainable by the code, by default or not", a reading settled after the survey, because in `mbrl-lib` and in `va_mbpo`, the one repository that inherits, the bounds train only when a caller switches that on (ledger `M-73`). The survey did not check how each repository treats its variance floor, so 1 of 10 is an upper bound on how often both conditions hold. The survey looked at 13 in all; the other 3 lack the construction, so the protocol does not count them as examined, among them mainline `rsl_rl`: the bounded head exists in the fork this paper pins, not in the library it forks, and we do not count the fork, since counting what §6.3 measured as evidence that the result travels would be circular. The protocol capped the survey at 25 repositories; it stopped at 10 examined, 13 looked at, and its notes give no reason. We wrote the protocol before the search, but neither it nor its hash reached git before the results did, so that order rests on our own record; it is a search protocol, not one of Appendix E's decision rules. Search engines rank and truncate, so this is a sample of convenience, but on it the substitution is rare, and a reader who takes the hypothesis to reach widely infers more than the evidence supports.

J The $\sigma = 0$ optimum: the synthetic-noise test (rule M-50), the term-by-term gradient check, the runs behind the collapse rate, and section 6.4's source walkthrough

What §6.3 and §6.4 keep, and what is here. §6.3 keeps its derivation, the synthetic-noise verdict and the objective's two effects; §6.4 keeps the 89.15% sharing in its parameter counts and the mechanism. The passages below stood there as follows; the first two summarise sections of this appendix that state them in full.

§6.3's term-by-term summary. The derivation above covers two terms, and the objective has 7. Each term, back-propagated alone on one real batch, confirms it: 4 are live under the released configuration, exactly 2 reach σ (`state` and `bound`), and the other 5 give a gradient of exactly zero (`results/e4_sigma_gradients.json`, Appendix J).

§6.3's run-count summary. We predicted the collapse from this algebra before training, then observed it: across all 28 runs at the released width outside §5.2's sweep the log-σ range moves linearly in iteration count at a nearly identical rate within each objective, falling under sampled MSE and rising under the corrected one (Figure 4a). Appendix J lists the runs, the capacity-matched arm excluded from every rate, and the 22 the rate is fitted on.

§6.3's permutation detail on the corrected objective. Under the trajectory permutation test of §6.5, at h = 368, those counts give P = 0.0417 and 1.0000 out of sample, 0.0240 and 0.8746 in sample. The faithful arm's ordering is the one result in this family that points the same way in both arenas; it is also the weakest effect of the three, and it does not survive multiplicity correction either.

§6.4's source walkthrough. `system_dynamics.py:34` builds **one** `state_base`. `system_dynamics.py:35-41` replicates the *heads* `ensemble_size` times, and only the heads. In the forward pass `system_dynamics.py:87` evaluates the trunk **once** and `:90` hands the identical feature vector to every head; `system_dynamics.py:126` then computes the epistemic term as the standard deviation across those heads.

§6.4 on our own arms. This applies to our own arms identically, which is why §6.2's comparison is fair. Our ensemble-5 arms build one trunk the same way (`src/rwm_model.py:164-167`), evaluate it once (`:182`), hand the same vector to every head (`:185`) and compute the same spread (`:200`). Their tensor names and parameter counts match the released checkpoint exactly — 636,672 shared, 77,492 per head, 1,995,569 in total, on all 3 arms checked (`results/v1_ensemble_topology.json`). So §6.2's "our arms fail the same way at 10.5× at h = 100" compares two instances of one architecture, not two architectures.

§6.3's derivation says the collapse happens on any dataset, and that is testable. It matters because it is what answers the follow-up's own explanation: on the released CSV, "small stochasticity in the environment" and our reading are observationally identical, since the data may simply be nearly deterministic. So under a rule committed before the runs (rule M-50, Appendix E) we built data where it is not.

Synthetic data whose true noise level is **known** and varies by a factor of 25 across the input range, with a non-constant true mean; the **same** bounded log-σ head as the released model — `MLPStateHead` unmodified, including the double-softplus clamp, the learnable `state_min_logstd` and `state_log_delta_logstd`, and the bound loss at its configured weight — trained under each objective in turn on 4,000 points for 12,000 iterations at 3 seeds. Nothing else differs between the arms.

Two ways this is not the released setting. The head is built here over a **one-dimensional** state with no recurrent trunk in front of it, where the released one predicts 45 dimensions from a GRU. The trunk's absence is deliberate: the question is about the head's objective, and a GRU would add a confound. The dimensionality matters because the state loss sums over state dimensions, so at one dimension it is roughly 45× smaller relative to the bound term than in the released path. That makes this setting *more* favourable to σ surviving, and the collapse happens anyway.

objective	median $\hat{\sigma}$ / σ_true	$\hat{\sigma}$ spread across the input range	slope of log $\hat{\sigma}$ on log σ_true
`mse` — the implemented branch	**0.0460**	1.002–1.003×	+0.000493
`gaussian_nll` — the authors' unused branch	0.9779	1.02–3.67×	+0.1330

Ratios and slopes are means over 3 seeds; spreads are the range across them, because the mean of a spread hides which seeds recovered.

Under the implemented objective σ sits 21.7× below the true noise and does not track it at all: a spread of 1.003× where the truth spans 25×, and a slope below the 0.00309 the design can detect. Under the authors' own branch, same data and same head, σ recovers the true level to a median ratio of 0.9779, and every one of the 3 seeds the rule was discharged over clears the slope threshold. **Twenty seeds show that clearance is not general**: 11 of 20 clear it, so the all-seeds criterion would not have held at that sample. The rule's verdict stands as returned over its own 3 and is not re-opened by more seeds (§8); what twenty establish is that the hedge below was necessary. **The recovering arm is seed-variable, and the rule said so before the runs**: its slopes span 0.0078–0.3537, a factor of 45, and its 3 seeds recover σ spreads of only 1.02–3.67× against the truth's 25×. So what this experiment establishes is the **contrast**, that one objective tracks the noise at all and the other does not, and not the magnitude of the recovery, which this training budget does not pin down. **OBJECTIVE-DRIVEN**, which is the verdict the rule names for that pattern.

The statistic is the slope, not the correlation, because a correlation is scale-free: a $\hat{\sigma}$ that is essentially constant still returns a large one off its own numerical noise. Under a permutation null, the same data

with the input-to-noise pairing destroyed, a head whose σ spanned 1.0004× returned correlations as large as ±0.24, while its slope was 2e-05. The detection threshold is set at the slope corresponding to a 1.01× spread rather than at that noise floor, and the measured false-positive rate at zero signal is 0%.

What this does that §6.3's derivation alone could not. It removes the competing explanation rather than arguing against it: the stochasticity here is large, known and input-dependent, and the collapse happens anyway. The design's limit, stated in the rule, holds: the dilution ladder detects the signal at full strength and at no dilution below it, so this establishes that σ does not track the noise **at all**, not the magnitude of how badly.

§6.3's derivation covers two terms, and the objective has 7. Its completeness rests on the other 5 being inert with respect to σ, so each term is computed alone on one real batch (64 windows from the training episodes, at freshly initialised weights of the released architecture) and back-propagated alone, and the gradient reaching the log-σ tower, `state_log_delta_logstd` and `state_min_logstd` is recorded. A term that cannot move σ produces exactly zero on all three.

loss term	live?	weight	where the reference computes it	∂/∂ log-σ tower	∂/∂ `log_delta_logstd`	∂/∂ `min_logstd`
`state`	live	1.00	`system_dynamics.py:270-289`	0.000325	0.0509	0.0703
`sequence`	**dead**	1.00	`system_dynamics.py:274-277`	0	0	0
`bound`	live	1.00	`system_dynamics.py:301-302`	0	0.2	0
`kl`	**dead**	0.10	`system_dynamics.py:223`	0	0	0
`extension`	**dead**	1.00	`system_dynamics.py:233-268`	0	0	0
`contact`	live	1.00	`system_dynamics.py:233-268`	0	0	0
`termination`	live	1.00	`system_dynamics.py:233-268`	0	0	0

4 of the 7 configured terms are live at all under the released configuration: `sequence_loss` is dead code, guarded by a `prediction_type` the reference sets to `"single"` on both paths, and `kl` and `extension` are zero because their dimensions are. Of the 7, exactly 2 reach σ: `state` and `bound`. The remaining 5 produce a gradient of exactly zero, not merely a term the code suggests is irrelevant (`results/e4_sigma_gradients.json`).

We predicted the collapse from §6.3's algebra before training, then observed it. Three run counts appear below and they are not the same set. This project trained 33 runs for §5–§7, besides the 42 of §5.2 and §5.3 (Appendix B), of which 28 are at the released `rnn_hidden_size` of 256 and form the collapse family; the remaining 5 are the capacity-matched arm of rule M-49 (Appendix E) at width 124, a different architecture, excluded from every rate §6.3 quotes (Appendix B). Across all 28 runs of that family the log-σ range moves linearly in iteration count at a nearly identical rate within each objective, falling under sampled MSE and rising under the corrected one (Figure 4a). Rates are fitted on 22 of those 28: the 6 10,000-iteration runs continue seeds already counted at 2,500 and would double-weight them. Figure 4(a) shows all 28 runs of the collapse family and Figure 4(b) only the 22 the rate is fitted on, so the scatter and §6.3's quoted statistic describe the same set. The 33 runs, with the width column separating the collapse family from the capacity-matched arm:

arm	iterations	ensemble	objective	dataset	width	seeds	seed ids
Arm A	2,500	1	gaussian_nll	clean	256	5	0, 1, 2, 3, 4
Arm A	2,500	1	mse	clean	124	5	0, 1, 2, 3, 4
Arm A	2,500	1	mse	clean	256	5	0, 1, 2, 3, 4
Arm A	2,500	1	mse	contaminated	256	3	0, 1, 2
Arm A	2,500	1	mse	duplicated	256	3	0, 1, 2
Arm A	2,500	5	mse	clean	256	3	0, 1, 2
Arm A	10,000	1	mse	clean	256	3	0, 1, 2
Arm B	2,500	1	mse	clean	256	3	0, 1, 2
Arm B	10,000	1	mse	clean	256	3	0, 1, 2

K Section 6.5's two tables, and the per-dimension permutation tests behind them

What §6.5 keeps, and what is here. §6.5 keeps the teacher-forced arm's finding, the epistemic term's, its claim and the structural-excuse result. Its two tables and the paragraphs around them stood there as follows.

Adding the teacher-forced arm, trained for §5, sharpens the finding (our arms at 2,500 training iterations; the released checkpoint as released):

model	σ variation across inputs (CoV)	dims with r(σ, error) > 0 at h=368, held-out pair	perm P at h=368, held-out pair	perm P at h=368, training episodes
faithful Arm A	0.0076	39/45	0.0417	0.0240
corrected Arm A	0.0059	21/45	1.0000	0.8746
teacher-forced Arm B	**0.1188**	**45/45**	**0.2609**	**0.5565**
released checkpoint	0.0177	20/45	0.6957	0.9753

The CoV column is the aleatoric σ in every row, the only σ the ensemble-size-1 arms have. Our ensemble-5 arms (§6.6) have both: their aleatoric CoV is comparable to the other arms', and their *epistemic* term is far more input-dependent than any aleatoric head here, at 0.379–0.395 against the released checkpoint's 0.0177. **The count column is the out-of-sample arena** (n_independent = 4), so that all four models are compared on trajectories none of our arms trained on. For the released checkpoint's aleatoric head it is not the most informative arena: at h = 368 and n_independent = 20 over all ten episodes that head is 0/45, negatively correlated with error on *every* dimension, against 20/45 here; supplementary S3 quotes the larger arena.

Arm B's σ is 15.6× more input-dependent than the faithful arm's, and it has the largest mean correlation of the four (r = 0.257). It is still 315× overconfident.

The P column is a permutation P, which pairs each trajectory's σ with a different trajectory's realised error and so keeps the coupling between dimensions and the growth of error with depth that every trajectory shares. The binomial P-values an earlier draft attached to these counts are withdrawn (`S-15`), and the correction is large (Appendix K).

So σ *collapsing in magnitude* is objective-driven, and σ *becoming input-independent* is not. The teacher-forced arm collapses in magnitude exactly like the autoregressive ones — same objective, same rate — while retaining 15.6× more variation across inputs. Input-independence is a property of the autoregressive arms and the released checkpoint, and input-dependence and correct ranking are both achievable without the interval becoming meaningful. One candidate mechanism, stated as an untested hypothesis: autoregressive feedback narrows the input distribution toward the model's own manifold, leaving a heteroscedastic head less variation to key on.

The same pattern holds for the quantity the method uses, and this is where the correction bites hardest. At h=128 and h=368 the epistemic term correlates positively with realised error on **45 of 45** dimensions, matching the best aleatoric head here on the sign count, while being 39.7× overconfident at h = 368. **Figures in this paragraph are the held-out arena (n_independent = 4) unless labelled otherwise**, so the epistemic term and the four aleatoric heads are compared on identical trajectories; §6.2 quotes 34.4× for the same ratio at h = 368 and n_independent = 20, and the abstract and §12 use 33.4× at h = 100 on those 20 trajectories. Nor does it beat Arm B's head on strength: its mean correlation at h=368 is +0.151 against 0.257. The two rank comparably, and neither is close to an interval. Under the permutation null that count gives P = 0.0435 on the held-out pair and 0.0775 on the training episodes, both in-sample for the checkpoint, against 5.68e-14 from the independent-trials test. It still fails the horizon test the same way: σ grows 1.59× from h=1 to h=368 while error grows 13.33×.

Across arenas, and after correction for multiplicity. The two larger arenas, which are nested (every in-sample trajectory is among the all-ten ones), put the epistemic ordering's strength at *short* horizon, because at long horizon the forecast-depth trend every trajectory shares lifts the null until a full count is close to chance, which is what motivates §6.6's index control. Nothing here survives Holm–Bonferroni in any of the three arenas, and out of sample at the 400-step unit nothing could, since its smallest attainable P already exceeds the smallest Holm threshold (Appendix K).

The structural excuse, with its table. The structural excuse does not survive. One could argue that a model trained on an 8-step horizon cannot be expected to report calibrated uncertainty about step 368. It cannot report it about step 8 either. Inside the trained horizon, σ is flat while error grows (Figure 5; out-of-sample held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, in-sample for the released checkpoint; our arms at 2,500 training iterations, the released checkpoint as released):

model	σ growth, step 1 $\to$ 8	error growth, step 1 $\to$ 8
faithful Arm A	0.9241×	3.49×
corrected Arm A	1.0003×	3.41×
teacher-forced Arm B	1.0096×	6.11×
released checkpoint	1.0007×	1.79×

The faithful arm's σ *declines* (0.9241×) while its error grows 3.49×. The coverage collapse in Figure 3(b) is therefore driven entirely by growing error against a fixed σ.

The permutation tests. §6.5's P column is a permutation P, not a binomial one, and the binomial P-values an earlier draft attached to its counts are withdrawn (`S-15`). A binomial null treats the 45 state dimensions as independent trials, and they are not: position, velocity and torque for the same joint are physically coupled, and base linear and angular velocity are coupled through the gait. More importantly, error grows with rollout depth in every trajectory, so *any* σ that also grows with depth correlates with *any* trajectory's error, including one it was never paired with.

We therefore permute whole trajectories. The null pairs each trajectory's σ with a different trajectory's realised error, which keeps both marginal distributions and the entire cross-dimension dependence structure and destroys only the association under test. The correction is large, and largest exactly where we leaned hardest. The worst-affected cell is teacher-forced armB at h=368, in the in-sample arena. At h = 368 it moves from 5.68e-14 to 0.5565, a factor of about 10^{13}, because under a null that keeps the dependence a random re-pairing already yields 43.8 of 45 dimensions positive on average, so observing 45 of 45 is close to unremarkable. A fair coin centres the count at 22.5 of 45; the dependence-preserving null centres it between 5.1 and 43.8 depending on model, horizon and arena.

The larger arenas agree with each other against the smallest. At n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories on the held-out pair, in-sample for the checkpoint, the epistemic ordering looks strongest at long horizon (0.0417 at h=128, 0.0435 at h=368) and unremarkable at short (0.4348 at h=1). Both larger arenas invert that. In sample (n_independent = 16): 0.0052 at h=1, 0.0070 at h=8, against 0.3794 at h=128. Over all ten episodes (n_independent = 20): 0.0056, 0.0069 and 0.3762, with h = 100 at 0.2769, between h=32's 0.0344 and h=128's 0.3762. Two larger arenas at four and five times the sample say the effect is strongest at *short* horizon, though they are not independent: all 16 in-sample trajectories are among the 20.

The null means explain why, and the explanation is the one that motivates §6.6. At long horizon the shared forecast-depth trend lifts the null to 41.6 of 45 at h = 128, so a count of 45 is close to what chance alone delivers; at h = 1 the null sits near 15.4 and the same count is genuinely surprising. The out-of-sample arena is not wrong so much as blind: at 4 trajectories its smallest attainable P-value is 0.04167, so it cannot tell a strong effect from a marginal one at any horizon. **That blindness belongs to the 400-step unit, not to the arena**: a 33-row unit gives 60 independent units on the same two episodes, and 14 at h = 100 (rule M-64, Appendix E). We did not recompute this permutation family at the shorter unit, so what the short units change is the scope of the design claim, not any verdict: the arena is underpowered at h = 368, which needs the full 400 rows, and is no longer demonstrably so at h = 128 and below. Running it there is one pass over stored rollouts, and we did not do it. The small arena's numbers are reported because it is the only arena out-of-sample for our own arms, not because it is the better measurement.

Nothing here survives multiplicity correction, in any of the three arenas. Holm–Bonferroni over each arena's 30 model × horizon cells at $\alpha = 0.05$ rejects 0 out of sample, 0 in sample and 0 over all ten episodes. Out of sample that is a property of the design: with 4 independent trajectories the smallest attainable P-value is 0.04167, which already exceeds the smallest Holm threshold 0.001667, so no effect of any

size could have been rejected there. In sample the miss is real: the smallest P in the family is teacher-forced armB h=128 at 0.0027 against a threshold of 0.001667.

L Section 5 in detail: the floor, seeds and short horizon, the data budget, the baselines' pooled readings and the RSSM, the long-horizon cells and multiplicity, and the reimplementation beside the released checkpoint

Three passages of §5 in full. §5 keeps two sentences of each of the next three paragraphs, which stood there as follows.

Against a baseline, because neither number means anything without one. The hold-last floor, predicting that nothing changes, scores **0.9930** in the h = 368 cell, and autoregressive training beats it by **2.8**× there and by 2.0× at h = 100. **Teacher forcing is 1.66× worse than assuming nothing changes at all** at h = 368, and 1.27× worse at h = 100: the arm that reaches a lower training loss predicts the future worse than a model that makes no prediction, at every horizon we measured on the 400-step unit, the sharper statement of what exposure bias costs here; but on M-64's shorter units, each 32 + h rows long and non-overlapping (60 at h = 1, 50 at h = 8, 30 at h = 32, 14 at h = 100 and 12 at h = 128 on these episodes), at the same checkpoint and on the same two episodes, it beats the floor at h = 1, 8, 32 and 100 and loses to it only at the longest horizon those units reach, so that statement holds on the 400-step unit and not on the shorter one. **The floor is not a weak baseline everywhere**: at h=1 it beats the autoregressive arm as well, scoring 0.0796 at h = 1 against autoregressive training's 0.1447, the only horizon where the autoregressive arm loses to predicting no change on the 400-step unit; on the 33-row unit both arms beat the floor at h = 1 (0.1315 and 0.1121 against 0.1687). At 50 Hz one step is 20 ms and the state barely moves, so that is what one should expect.

Seeds, and what four trajectories can show. Seed spread is not symmetric between the arms: Arm A ranges 0.3341–0.3894 across seeds (7.9% relative), Arm B 1.4241–1.9710 (17.3%). Teacher forcing is more than twice as variable across seeds as autoregressive training at this horizon, so a single-seed comparison of these two arms is unreliable. For a single seed the bootstrap over trajectories gives the 95% interval [0.56, 2.05] on n = 4 independent trajectories; by the n = 4 caveat of §3 its tails move in steps of 0.39%, so it corroborates the sign test rather than being the primary evidence. The four per-trajectory gaps behind §5's three-seed table (Arm B minus Arm A, three seeds pooled, at h = 368) are **+2.8705, +0.8949, +0.7445, +0.6562**. All 4 of 4 are positive, the direction of the sign test's 10 of 10 episodes, but one trajectory carries +2.8705 against a smallest of +0.6562, which no interval on four units shows. At h = 100 the four are +1.0925, +0.8170, +0.2800, +0.1549; this appendix notes where other sections store theirs.

What is small, and where it resolves. At h = 8, the horizon the model is trained on, the advantage is small, and it resolves only with the longer training and all 3 seeds. §5's by-horizon table, at 10,000 iterations with 3 seeds pooled, gives an h = 8 gap of +0.0485 [+0.0271, +0.0844], which excludes zero, a factor of 1.16×. The single seed the rule was run on (seed 1) gives an h = 8 gap of 0.008 at the same 10,000-iteration checkpoint, and its interval includes zero. At the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints, with all 3 seeds pooled, the out-of-sample gap excludes zero in **0 of 4** h = 8 cells (both trajectory lengths crossed with both checkpoints). An earlier rule of ours, anchored at h = 8 and evaluated at those same checkpoints (rule M-16, Appendix E), returned **CANNOT BE SETTLED AT THIS BUDGET**. **The advantage is small at the training horizon and large beyond it.**

The data budget (§5.1). §5.1 keeps two sentences of the following.

The base paper's headline is a sample-efficiency result: policies transfer to hardware from 6,000,000 state transitions of world-model pretraining against ~250M for the model-free baseline (Table I). That is a claim about policy learning and hardware, which we cannot test, but its *world-model* half is a quantity we can count exactly.

Our arms consume 7,991 distinct state transitions: the 7,999 rows of the eight training episodes less one per episode (8 of them), since an episode's first row has no predecessor, a transition being a consecutive pair of rows inside one episode. It is deliberately not the 7,687 training windows, which overlap almost

completely (consecutive 40-row windows start one row apart), nor the 640,000 window draws a 2,500-iteration run makes, which resample the same data with replacement. Against the reference's 6,000,000, that is **751× less data, 0.133% of its world-model budget**.

A dynamics model trained on 0.133% of the reference's data still reproduces the training result, 4.61× at h = 368 and 2.58× at h = 100 over 3 seeds (the rule ran on seed 1), and still beats the hold-last floor, by 2.8× and 2.0× at those two horizons. That is what this paper can add to the sample-efficiency question without training a policy.

Three limits. It is not a reproduction of the 6,000,000-against-250M comparison, which is about policy learning. It says nothing about whether a policy trained inside our model would transfer to hardware, or anywhere. And our model is evaluated on the narrow distribution it trained on (one robot, one gait, one terrain, velocity commands from a single bounded box), where the reference's 6,000,000 transitions span considerably more; a smaller data budget buys less than it appears to when the evaluation distribution shrinks with it.

Two passages of §5.3 in full. §5.3 keeps a short summary of each, with every verdict; they stood there as follows.

On the in-sample arena's 16 trajectories, with nRMSE pooled as §3.1 defines it (computed afterwards, post hoc; ledger R-77), two readings differ from the per-trajectory average the rules' evaluator used. Teacher-forced, at h = 1 all three baselines are ahead of RWM: D, signed as the rules sign it (positive favours RWM), is -0.160 [-0.286, -0.002] for the MLP, -0.186 [-0.328, -0.013] for the RSSM and -0.052 [-0.089, -0.005] for the transformer, so M-75's reading there is DOES NOT REPRODUCE where the average gave CANNOT BE SETTLED: the same one-step lead for teacher forcing as §5's. Trained autoregressively, the MLP's deficit at h = 100 is no longer resolved (+0.017 [-0.017, +0.044]), so M-76's reading there is PARTIAL where the average gave RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE. Neither changes a verdict; both rules govern at h = 368 on relative-L1.

Our RSSM is not an informative comparison. Teacher-forced, it is the most accurate of this section's models one step ahead, 0.0761 against RWM's 0.1232 and the floor's 0.0796, though not resolvably, and it has collapsed open-loop by h = 32, where its 1.0182 is above the floor's 0.5950. The original adds that an RSSM trained autoregressively performs comparably to RWM; ours does not, 10.6405 against RWM's 0.5856 at h = 368. A diagnostic committed before its readings existed (rule X1, ledger M-80; exploratory, it re-opens neither rule) asks why. Its Part A reads the forecast differently, feeding the prior's expected or sampled latent in place of its most likely one: the error at h = 32 falls to 0.7165 and 0.6914, still above the floor, so it returns **NOT EVALUATION-LIMITED** (M-81). Its Part B is descriptive: over the history, the teacher-forced RSSM's one-step error from its prior is 1.16× to 1.27× its error from its posterior at the same recurrent state (the autoregressive one's at most 1.02×), with 16.4 to 20.0 nats of KL divergence between them per step. Its Part C retrains the teacher-forced RSSM at seed 0 for 2,500 iterations, once with PlaNet's KL settings and once with DreamerV2's layer-normalised recurrent cell. Neither rescues it: read from its most likely latent at h = 32, they score 1.2588 and 1.4685 against the floor's 0.5950, with 3 and 2 of the 4 trajectories above their own floor value; a rescue needs the mean below the floor's and every trajectory below its own. So rule X1 returns **NOT RESCUED BY THE SETTINGS TRIED** (ledger M-83). The failure may still be our RSSM rather than the architecture: Table S7's latent is ambiguous, we read it in DreamerV2's naming (`BASELINE_SPECS.md`, the RSSM rows), and X1 tried only the two settings above, on one seed, neither of them PlaNet's latent overshooting (Hafner et al., ICML 2019), which trains the prior's multi-step predictions in latent space and which PlaNet's own final RSSM agent did not need. So the architecture claim rests on the MLP and the transformer.

Teacher forcing's two definitions (§4, §5). §4 and §5 each keep a sentence of the following.

From §4, on the original's heatmap: For the teacher-forced (32, 1) it prints 3.99 against 0.47 at the centre, 8.5× worse, on evaluation data and at a horizon it does not state; our sweep's (32, 1) is 6.35× worse on relative-L1 at h = 368 and 2,500 iterations. Our 4.61×, at 10,000, uses a different definition of teacher forcing (`docs/presubmission/ORIGINAL_SPECS.md` §2); the next paragraph relates the two.

From §5: Arm B predicts each of the window's 8 forecast targets from true inputs, where the original's teacher forcing is N = 1; the sweep's (32, 1), trained that way, is 6.35× worse than the centre at h = 368 at 2,500 iterations (§5.2), so the direction holds under both definitions.

The diverged baseline rows (§5.3). † marks a diverged row, one where any seed's mean relative-L1 at h = 368 exceeds 10 times the hold-last floor's (`results/pooled_nrmse_rescore.json`, post hoc). Runaway rollouts dominate those three rows' means; per seed they are MLP, teacher-forced: 182, 16.0 and 238; transformer, teacher-forced: 11.2, 10.4 and 23.9; RSSM, autoregressive: 9.87, 10.8 and 11.3. No verdict depends on that magnitude, only on the sign: each such row's 4 per-trajectory differences from RWM are all positive, so every bootstrap resample favours RWM whatever their size.

The long-horizon cells. At long horizons §5's pattern is consistent across the design. Under the cluster bootstrap, the out-of-sample gap excludes zero in **4 of 4** long-horizon cells, both trajectory lengths crossed with the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints. These figures are relative-L1; the nRMSE aggregation is reported separately and does not change the direction.

Multiplicity. Those 4 cells sit in a family of 8 out-of-sample comparisons. All 4 of 4 still exclude zero at a Bonferroni level of 0.05/8, and Holm–Bonferroni rejects **4 of 4**. §5's sign test is unaffected either way.

How good the reimplementation is as a model, next to the artifact it reimplements. §5's tables compare two training rules with each other and §6.2's compares calibration, so neither puts the released checkpoint and our arms side by side on absolute accuracy. Both aggregations, for these models and for §5.3's architecture baselines, on one arena:

model	nRMSE h = 1	rel-L1 h = 1	nRMSE h = 8	rel-L1 h = 8	nRMSE h = 100	rel-L1 h = 100	nRMSE h = 368	rel-L1 h = 368
released checkpoint	0.0544	0.0563	0.0697	0.0808	0.5028	0.3304	0.9051	0.6041
Arm A — autoregressive, faithful MSE	0.1262	0.1232	0.3029	0.3289	0.4913	0.4798	0.5425	0.5856
Arm A — autoregressive, `gaussian_nll`	0.1204	0.1195	0.2867	0.3154	0.4603	0.4413	0.5245	0.5608
Arm B — teacher-forced	0.0879	0.0929	0.3064	0.3392	1.0363	1.0849	3.7927	4.5684
MLP, teacher-forced (§5.3) †	0.1393	0.1539	0.3624	0.4086	1.1399	1.2057	112.5344	145.1650
MLP, autoregressive (§5.3)	0.1364	0.1470	0.3016	0.3492	0.5452	0.5400	1.4383	1.4628
RSSM, teacher-forced (§5.3)	0.0707	0.0761	0.3393	0.3686	2.0376	2.2128	5.3890	6.3718
RSSM, autoregressive (§5.3) †	0.1223	0.1354	0.6004	0.6211	3.1128	3.2660	9.2508	10.6405
transformer, teacher-forced (§5.3) †	0.1202	0.1239	0.3773	0.3969	2.0195	2.0607	13.4730	15.1548
transformer, autoregressive (§5.3)	0.1329	0.1384	0.2562	0.3025	0.5821	0.5821	2.0110	1.8771
hold-last floor	0.0989	0.0796	0.4117	0.3298	0.9537	0.7558	1.0897	0.9930

Arena, stated once for the whole table: out-of-sample held-out pair, episodes 1 and 8, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 4; in-sample for the released checkpoint. Arm rows are the mean over 3 seeds at 2,500 training iterations (the `weights_2500.pt` checkpoint), with per-seed values in `results/head_to_head_accuracy.json`; nRMSE is form 1 (§3.1), and both metrics are cumulative over forecast steps 1..h. Every RWM row is read from the stored rollouts behind §6.2's calibration tables, so no model is run to build it. The architecture-baseline rows (§5.3) come from their own evaluator on the same four trajectories, whose relative-L1 reproduces the Arm A row exactly; their nRMSE is pooled as §3.1 defines it, recomputed afterwards with the same evaluator (post hoc, `results/pooled_nrmse_rescore.json`), and † marks a diverged row (§5.3). **This table is at 2,500 iterations and §5's by-horizon table at 10,000**, which is why Arm A's relative-L1 at h = 368 reads 0.5856 here and 0.3582 there: the same arm, trained longer.

Both metrics put the released checkpoint first at h = 1 and h = 8, they name different leaders at h = 100, and at h = 368 both put an Arm A variant ahead of it: the reimplementation is behind the artifact it reimplements at short horizons and ahead of it at the longest horizon we measure. That reading flatters the released checkpoint, because the split is ours: the arena is out-of-sample for our arms and in-sample for it, which trained on all ten episodes (the in-sample caveat of §3).

Stored per-trajectory values elsewhere. §6.8's and supplementary S2's paired contrasts at §5's n = 4 store their four per-trajectory values in `results/r2_independent_ensemble.json` and `results/m49_capacity_matched.json`; §6.2's two held-out tables, at n_independent = 4, give intervals only, coarse for the same reason (the n = 4 caveat of §3).

Rule X3, fold by fold (§5). Rule X3 was committed and pushed before any of its runs existed (ledger M-86; Appendix E gives its lead time) and is discharged in M-94. It is exploratory and re-opens no rule: rule

M-23 stands. The gap is Arm B's seed-mean relative-L1 minus Arm A's at h = 368. Each fold's interval is exact over all 256 ordered resamples of its trajectories; the pooled one is M-23's three-seed bootstrap, 20,000 draws (seed 0), whole trajectories, every seed carried.

fold (episodes held out)	trajectories	gap at h = 368 [95% interval]	each episode's mean gap
{1, 8} (section 5)	4	+3.9828 [+0.9907, +9.4848]	1: +6.9749, 8: +0.9907
{0, 2}	4	+0.6554 [+0.5172, +0.8630]	0: +0.5512, 2: +0.7596
{3, 4}	4	+1.4966 [+1.0403, +1.9528]	3: +1.0403, 4: +1.9528
{5, 6}	4	+1.6282 [+1.1379, +2.4999]	5: +2.0714, 6: +1.1850
{7, 9}	4	+3.3743 [+3.1063, +3.5926]	7: +3.1561, 9: +3.5926
all five, pooled	20	**+2.2275 [+1.3683, +3.5053]**	10 of 10 positive, P = 0.002

Arena: each fold's held-out pair, out-of-sample for both arms, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories per fold and 20 pooled (n_independent = 20). Checkpoints: Arm A and Arm B at 2,500 iterations, 3 seeds per arm per fold. Bold, the reading, **REPLICATES ACROSS FOLDS**. The per-episode sign test is part of the rule and carries no verdict of its own: 10 of 10 episodes positive, exact two-sided P = 0.002. Alongside: at h = 100 the pooled gap is +0.3573 [+0.2624, +0.4678], and Arm B's mean error is 5.85× Arm A's at h = 368. The folds are fixed, not drawn: two of the new ones hold both their episodes from the same speed half, unlike §5's stratified fold.

M Section 6.2 in detail: every horizon, the held-out-pair version, the ensemble-5 arms, and the reading checks (the resampling unit, the spread across dimensions, the permutation column)

What §6.2 keeps, and what is here. §6.2 keeps its released-checkpoint table's h = 1 and h = 100 rows and two sentences on the ensemble-5 arms. The rest stood there as follows; §6.2's note on the permutation column read: "The last column of the released checkpoint's table gives permutation P-values over whole trajectories; none survives Holm–Bonferroni across the arena's 30 cells, so it is a consistency check on direction (Appendix M)."

The held-out-pair version (§6.2). §6.2 states that restricting the checkpoint to the held-out pair would buy no independence and cost four fifths of the sample; that version, at n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, is in the supplementary material (`results/task_b2_epistemic.json`). Its epistemic column agrees in direction with this one at all 6 of 6 horizons; its aleatoric column agrees at 4 of 6, flipping sign at h=8 and h=100, where both readings sit close to chance and the aleatoric σ is in any case 1,827× (h = 1) to 20,669× (h = 368) too small for its ordering to be the interesting quantity.

§6.2's four-model table. On the held-out pair, the four models stood as follows.

model	mean |error| / mean σ, whole 368-step rollout	coverage at $\pm1\sigma$, h=1	coverage at $\pm1\sigma$, h=100
faithful Arm A (sampled MSE)	52.2× [39.6, 69.7]	11.67% [7.96, 15.19]	2.17% [1.59, 2.75]
corrected Arm A (`gaussian_nll`)	10.9× [7.8, 14.7]	42.78% [24.44, 62.04]	9.8% [6.80, 12.81]
teacher-forced Arm B	315× [177, 509]	12.96% [7.04, 20.93]	1.22% [0.84, 1.61]
released checkpoint	7,878× [5,410, 9,934]	0.56% [0.00, 1.67]	0.08% [0.06, 0.11]

Our arms are at 2,500 training iterations; the released checkpoint is as released. Every cell carries a 95% interval from a cluster bootstrap over whole trajectories, n_independent = 4, quantised as the n = 4 caveat of §3 describes; where three seeds contribute, seeds are pooled inside each draw rather than resampled, because seeds are not trajectories (§8).

All four rows are the held-out pair — the two episodes withheld from our own arms, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories — because that is the only arena on which our arms can be scored fairly. On the aleatoric head every model is overconfident by between one and four orders of magnitude (Figure 3); that is the quantity §6.1 shows the method discards. The released checkpoint's 7,878× is its whole 368-step rollout on those same 4 trajectories, for comparability with the arms; its best-sampled figure is the 11,683× below,

cumulative to h = 100 at n_independent = 20. **Both are correct, on a different arena and a different horizon**, and neither is out-of-sample for that checkpoint (the in-sample caveat of §3).

§6.2's released-checkpoint table at every horizon. Over all 10 episodes, n_independent = 20 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, the released checkpoint as released:

h	aleatoric err/σ [95% CI]	aleatoric $\pm1\sigma$	epistemic err/σ [95% CI]	epistemic $\pm1\sigma$ [95% CI]	epistemic $\pm2\sigma$	dims r>0	permutation P
1	1,827× [915, 3,110]	0.11%	**8.3**× [6.1, 9.7]	16.22% [13.44, 18.89]	30.11%	44/45	0.0056
8	3,034× [1,638, 4,849]	0.08%	15.1× [10.3, 19.2]	9.99% [8.60, 11.32]	19.76%	45/45	0.0069
32	4,525× [2,492, 7,196]	0.07%	22.6× [15.5, 28.7]	6.95% [5.99, 7.85]	13.68%	45/45	0.0344
100	11,683× [7,970, 15,846]	0.04%	**33.4**× [28.7, 39.0]	4.61% [4.12, 5.09]	9.27%	45/45	0.2769
128	14,934× [10,564, 19,700]	0.03%	34.2× [30.6, 38.2]	4.37% [3.96, 4.81]	8.75%	45/45	0.3762
368	20,669× [15,666, 25,688]	0.02%	34.4× [29.8, 40.3]	3.59% [3.27, 3.92]	7.19%	45/45	0.0804

The larger sample changes one thing materially. At n_independent = 4 the epistemic ordering looked like chance at short horizon, 23 of 45 dimensions at h=1. At n_independent = 20 it is 44 of 45 at h=1, with mean r = +0.662, the *strongest* mean correlation of any horizon, and the in-sample permutation test agrees (Appendix K). The short-horizon "chance" result was an artifact of four trajectories, not a property of the model.

The ensemble-5 arms (§6.2). The released checkpoint is no longer the only ensemble measured. Three Arm A arms at ensemble size 5 (§6.6, 3 seeds, out-of-sample, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, 2,500 training iterations) give, averaged over seeds:

h	epistemic err/σ [95% CI]	$\pm1\sigma$ [95% CI]	$\pm2\sigma$	dims r>0
1	2.1× [1.7, 2.5]	35.93% [29.63, 42.22]	60.37%	35.0/45
8	6.3× [4.4, 7.5]	14.10% [11.02, 17.18]	26.62%	37.3/45
32	8.0× [5.9, 9.8]	10.79% [8.53, 13.71]	20.50%	34.3/45
100	**10.5**× [9.0, 11.5]	8.19% [6.80, 9.59]	16.11%	44.0/45
128	11.0× [9.5, 11.9]	7.79% [6.81, 8.77]	15.34%	44.0/45
368	**13.0**× [11.9, 13.9]	6.30% [5.84, 6.77]	12.51%	40.7/45

Our arms are **better calibrated than the released checkpoint and fail the same way**: 10.5× over-confident at h = 100 against its 25.7× on the same held-out pair (33.4× over all ten episodes), with 8.19% coverage where a calibrated Gaussian gives 68.27%. §6.4 establishes that the two are the same architecture in the respect that matters here, so this is a comparison of like with like. Being closer to calibrated is not being calibrated.

Two pre-registered checks on how §6.2's numbers are read. The first (rule M-62, Appendix E) asks whether any verdict depends on resampling 400-step trajectories rather than whole episodes, which two trajectories share. It returns **NO MOVE**: in the one arena with power at that level, all ten episodes (n = 20 falling to 10), the pooled correlation's interval widens by 27% and the double-demeaned one's width changes by a factor of 0.98, and neither crosses zero. The other 4 cells it names are out-of-sample, where an episode bootstrap has n = 2 and three distinct resamples, or, for the per-horizon multiplier cell, one episode per direction and no interval at all; the rule said so in advance, and they are reported as uninformative rather than as intervals.

The second (rule M-63, Appendix E) asks whether the one-step failure is a few bad channels or all of them, since a pooled coverage is the unweighted mean of 45 per-dimension ones. It returns **UNIFORM**: the interquartile range across dimensions is 10.0 points against a 15-point threshold committed in advance, and the five worst dimensions carry well under half of the shortfall. **No channel is exempt.** The reading is coarse by construction: at h = 1 on 20 trajectories a per-dimension coverage moves in 5-point steps, a limit the rule fixed before the run.

The last column of §6.2's released-checkpoint table gives permutation P-values over whole trajectories, not binomial ones, on the same 20 trajectories as the counts beside them; Appendix K explains why a binomial null is inadmissible here. h = 100 is tested too, because it carries the abstract's headline figure. These are six tests on one family and none survives Holm–Bonferroni across the arena's 30 cells: the smallest is faithful

(mse) h=368 at 0.0037 against a threshold of 0.001667. Read the column as a consistency check on direction, not as six independent findings.

N Section 6.6 in detail and its robustness checks: r_dd per horizon, the free baselines' cost, depth controls, the decomposition, rule M-43, and the within-step control

What §6.6 keeps, and what is here. §6.6 keeps the counter table, the paired test, the free-baselines verdict and rule X6, with every verdict. The passages below stood there as follows; rule M-43's is stated in full again later in this appendix.

Why §6.6's paired test, not overlapping intervals. Comparing the two marginal intervals for overlap is the wrong comparison: both correlations are measured on the *same* trajectories, so their sampling errors move together and the marginal intervals are needlessly conservative. The paired difference, resampling whole trajectories and recomputing *both* correlations inside each draw, is the appropriate and more powerful test.

§6.6's shorter-unit note at h = 128. At the shorter unit of rule M-64 (Appendix E), 60 non-overlapping units over the same ten episodes give [+0.148, +0.351] for the same paired difference, so that horizon carries more weight than it did.

r_dd per horizon (§6.6). Per horizon, on the same 20 trajectories (the released checkpoint over all ten episodes) and the same kind of cluster bootstrap: it is a separate run, so its h = 368 interval differs from M-45's in §6.6, [+0.318, +0.576], in the third decimal, as this appendix's pooled interval does from §6.2's [+0.545, +0.694].

h	r_dd, double-demeaned	95% CI	excludes zero
1	—	—	—
8	+0.306	[-0.387, +0.713]	no
32	+0.186	[-0.032, +0.636]	no
100	**+0.385**	**[+0.283, +0.701]**	**yes**
128	+0.453	[+0.359, +0.713]	yes
368	+0.419	[+0.315, +0.573]	yes

(h = 1 has one forecast step per trajectory, so there is nothing within a rollout to demean against and r_dd is undefined rather than zero.)

The within-rollout effect is materially smaller than the pooled figure and not established at short horizon; at h = 1 the correlation ranks whole rollouts, on 20 trajectory-level points (Appendix N).

Rule M-43 (§6.6). Does it hold on a model we trained? Three Arm A arms at ensemble size 5 (2,500 training iterations, scored on the held-out pair), under a rule committed before the runs (rule M-43, Appendix E), lead the index in **12 of 12** seed-horizon cells, but the paired difference excludes zero at only 1 of 4 horizons, so the rule returns **DOES NOT GENERALISE**. At n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories it was under-powered, which we measured after the fact and should have checked before committing it (Appendix N).

The expectation (§6.6). We ran the baseline test expecting it to go the other way. A counter matching disagreement would have been the more consequential result, making the trust metric close to vacuous, since a counter is free. We record that as an expectation only: it was not committed to git before the data existed, so by this paper's own standard (§8) it is not a pre-registration. It did not go that way against the counter. It went that way against something else.

The two free baselines and their cost (§6.6). A claim that beats exactly one competitor is a claim about that competitor. Under a rule committed before either was computed (rule M-51, Appendix E, corrected by rule M-52), we added two baselines needing no ensemble and no second model: `step-size`, the magnitude of the model's own predicted state change $\|\mu_t - \mu_{t-1}\|$, which costs nothing because the rollout has already

made those predictions; and `entry-res`, its one-step error at the step *before* the forecast window opens, which costs **one extra rollout in this harness** and nothing in deployment, where a model consumes the history to build its recurrent state anyway. The first rule called both free without distinguishing those, and the second records the correction.

X6's alongside readings (§6.6). On the released checkpoint's 70 units of 132 rows over all ten episodes, its training data, at h = 100 the margin also exceeds the 0.1713 minimum detectable effect computed before the reading by rule M-51's method. Disagreement correlates +0.6808 with error there against step size's +0.3992, and keeps +0.6361 [+0.5567, +0.7466] with step size partialled out; alongside, on 150 units at h = 32 the margin is +0.2393 [+0.0950, +0.3131].

What survives removing each confound. A linear partial is not much of a control: error does not grow linearly with depth, and a control that under-fits the index leaves index-driven variance in the residual and flatters disagreement. The first five rows after the pooled baseline below are **depth controls**, each partialling out a different model of how far into the rollout you are; the last four **decompose** the pooled figure into its between-trajectory and within-trajectory parts, and the last of those was pre-registered before it was computed (rule M-45, Appendix E). **One row is not comparable to the others**: the rank partial is a correlation of ranks rather than of values, so its being larger than the pooled figure says nothing about how much depth explains. Every row is the released checkpoint over all ten episodes, n_independent = 20 400-step trajectories.

what is removed	correlation	95% CI	what survives it
nothing (pooled)	+0.605	[+0.545, +0.695]	—
the step index, linearly	+0.596	—	depth explains 0.010 of it, from +0.605
log(1 + index)	+0.589	[+0.512, +0.688]	a non-linear model of depth
a cubic in the index	+0.582	[+0.495, +0.676]	any polynomial trend in depth
any monotone function of depth (rank partial)	+0.906	[+0.856, +0.921]	depth in any monotone form
depth exactly, within each forecast step	**+0.739**	[+0.711, +0.852]	positive at 368 of 368 steps, median +0.737[1]
forecast-step means only	+0.589	—	the within-step control, pooled
trajectory means only	+0.470	[+0.389, +0.604]	—
everything within a trajectory — the 20 trajectory means alone	+0.878	[+0.817, +0.956]	do harder rollouts disagree more?
both, additively (r_dd)	**+0.419**	**[+0.318, +0.576]**	**at a given depth, in a given rollout, does disagreement know?**

[1] Adjacent forecast steps on the same 20 trajectories are heavily dependent — structurally the same problem that §6.5's permutation null corrects for across the 45 coupled state dimensions (Appendix K). The count is descriptive; the interval [+0.711, +0.852] is the statistic, and no P-value attaches to 368/368.

The weakest figure across the 5 depth controls is +0.582, so disagreement is not re-encoding the clock: at a fixed depth it still knows which rollouts are going wrong. But depth was never the only confound. Per-episode difficulty, the released checkpoint's error on each episode scored with the causal action pairing (§7.2), spans 0.523 to 1.585 and is barely correlated with commanded speed (+0.088 across the ten episodes), so if harder trajectories simply have both larger error and larger disagreement, the pooled correlation would look exactly as it does with disagreement carrying no within-rollout information at all. Two things pointed there: the 20-point h = 1 figure of +0.994, which is not the shape of a genuine per-step signal, and the within-step control coming out *above* the pooled figure, the signature of a between-unit effect.

The verdict. The between-trajectory correlation is +0.878 and the two components contribute 51.7% and 48.3% of the pooled covariance, so a large part of what §6.6 reports is a between-rollout effect. That reinterprets the within-step control: it is a mean of 368 between-trajectory correlations, which is why it reads +0.739 against the pooled +0.605 rather than below it. The decisive statistic is the double-demeaned one, and it survives: +0.419 [+0.318, +0.576] at n_independent = 20, against the rule's pre-committed threshold that the interval exclude zero and a minimum detectable effect of 0.183 from the bootstrap's standard error; a dilution study missed an effect of 0.086 and caught one of 0.172. **The rule returns DISAGREEMENT CARRIES WITHIN-ROLLOUT INFORMATION**: with both the rollout and the depth held constant, disagreement still tracks error rather than merely reporting which episode is hard.

Two qualifications go with that. The within-rollout effect is **materially smaller than the pooled figure**, +0.419 against +0.605, so a practitioner should expect disagreement to separate *rollouts* better than it separates *moments within a rollout*. And it is **not established at short horizon**: r_dd's interval excludes zero at h=100, h=128, h=368 and spans zero at h=8 and h=32, where too few steps exist to demean against. At h = 100 it is established, at +0.385 [+0.283, +0.701].

The h = 1 figure survives the same test, but it is not what it looked like. At h = 1 the panel has one column, so +0.994 is a correlation over 20 *trajectory-level* points and nothing within a rollout is being tested. Disagreement correlates +0.006 with commanded speed and +0.027 with per-episode difficulty, and partialling both out of the disagreement–error correlation leaves +0.995: it does not move, so the figure is real and not a difficulty artifact. It is nevertheless a statement about **ranking whole rollouts at one step ahead**, on 20 points, and §9 states it that way.

Does it hold on a model we trained? Everything else in §6.6 is measured on the released checkpoint, because our main arms run at ensemble size 1 where the epistemic term is identically zero. We therefore trained three Arm A arms at **ensemble size 5**, at 2,500 training iterations and identical in every other setting, under a rule committed to git before the runs existed (rule M-43, Appendix E). It asked that disagreement lead the index at every horizon, and that the paired difference exclude zero at a majority of them.

It returns DOES NOT GENERALISE. The first condition passes completely: disagreement leads the index in **12 of 12** seed-horizon cells, every paired estimate positive, +0.204 to +0.545. The second fails: the paired difference excludes zero at 1 of 4 horizons, not a majority. We report the verdict the rule returns and do not rewrite the rule, nor its denominator: it was committed over 4 horizons, and adding h = 100 after the fact would change what "a majority" means in a discharged rule. §6.6's released-checkpoint table follows the six-horizon grid, because no pre-registration is stated over it, so the two counts are deliberately different.

What separates the two conditions is sample size, and we measured that rather than asserting it. Our own arms can only be scored out-of-sample on the held-out pair, n_independent = 4, where the released checkpoint's finding used 20. Subsampling four trajectories at a time from a twenty-trajectory pool, the rule's criterion fires on 75% of draws on average and on only 24% at h=8. That estimate is an **upper bound**, because the pool it subsamples is in-sample for these arms, where the effect is +0.425 to +0.790 against +0.204 to +0.545 on the held-out pair. So the rule was under-powered at the sample size it faced, decisively at one horizon. We do not claim it could not have passed, only that it was committed without checking what it could detect: a failure of ours, the same one the ledger records as M-24, a rule anchored without regard to the regime it would be applied in.

Reported as a companion and not as a discharge: on all ten episodes (n_independent = 20 400-step trajectories, **in-sample** for these arms, which trained on eight of them) the same measurement excludes zero at 4 of 4 horizons and would have satisfied both conditions. It cannot discharge the rule, which is stated over the out-of-sample arena; we record it only so the comparison with the released checkpoint's 20 is like for like.

Why the within-step control is undefined for the forecast index. The within-step control holds the forecast step fixed and correlates across trajectories, so it annihilates any quantity that is constant across trajectories at a fixed step — which is the forecast index, whose within-step correlation is therefore undefined rather than zero. It does **not** annihilate a per-trajectory scalar like `entry-res`, which varies across exactly the axis the control varies over. Rule M-51 said the opposite, and `M-54` records the correction.

O Rule M-44 in full: an ensemble that shares nothing

§6.8's table for rule M-44. §6.8 keeps the verdict and the h = 100 figures; the table stood there as follows.

h	independent err/σ	shared-trunk err/σ	independent $\pm1\sigma$	shared-trunk $\pm1\sigma$
1	1.4×	2.1×	50.00%	35.93%
8	3.4×	6.3×	22.64%	14.10%
32	4.4×	8.0×	17.92%	10.79%
100	**5.2**×	**10.5**×	**15.31%**	**8.19%**
128	5.3×	11.0×	15.03%	7.79%
368	5.1×	13.0×	15.00%	6.30%

Same trajectories (the held-out pair), same harness, n_independent = 4, every model at 2,500 training iterations. The shared-trunk column is the mean over 3 seeds; the comparison below is paired against each of them separately.

§6.4 establishes the topology as a fact and the mechanism as a hypothesis. Rule M-44 tests the hypothesis, under a rule committed to git before any of the artifacts below existed (rule M-44, Appendix E), with a power check estimating what it could detect at the sample size it would face.

The contrast, and why it is affordable. Training 5 genuinely independent models from scratch costs about 4.8 h of wall clock on two cores at these runs' iteration count, against the 49.8 h Appendix B gives for the 33 runs of §5–§7 it times (§5.2's sweep and §5.3's baselines are counted apart). Arm A at ensemble size 1 already existed at seeds 0, 1 and 2; we added two more at about 0.9 h each, 1.7 h in total, and scored the 5 together as an ensemble **at evaluation time**. There is no new training code and no new architecture, and the disagreement across 5 independently initialised *full models* is exactly the contrast §6.4 asks for. The rollout protocol mirrors the shared-trunk one in every respect except the one under test: each member sees the same input state, each keeps **its own** recurrent hidden state, and the ensemble mean is fed back to all of them.

The rule returns MECHANISM SUPPORTED. All 6 of its 6 conditions hold, against every one of the 3 shared-trunk seeds. At h = 100 the independent ensemble's overconfidence factor is 0.485–0.503× the shared-trunk arms', a **2.03**× improvement against a pre-registered minimum detectable effect of 1.45×, and its $\pm 1\sigma$ coverage is 6.69 to 7.33 points higher, a mean of +7.12 against an MDE of 2.26. Every paired interval excludes zero. **Members that share a feature extractor do produce a smaller spread, and the effect is large enough to matter.**

Where the improvement comes from, which is not all one thing. The overconfidence factor is error over σ, so it improves if σ grows *or* if error shrinks, and only the first is the trunk-sharing mechanism; five independent models also denoise better than five heads on one trunk, an ordinary ensembling effect. Splitting the improvement into its two multiplicative parts:

h	σ larger by	error smaller by	total	share from σ	share from accuracy
1	1.56×	0.97×	1.52×	106%	-6%
8	1.81×	1.02×	1.84×	97%	3%
32	1.68×	1.08×	1.83×	87%	13%
100	**1.65**×	1.23×	2.03×	**71%**	29%
128	1.62×	1.29×	2.09×	65%	35%
368	1.49×	1.70×	2.53×	43%	57%

On the held-out pair's 4 independent trajectories, independent against shared-trunk ensembles, all at 2,500 iterations. Shares are of the log improvement, so they add to 100%. A share above 100% at h=1 means the independent ensemble is very slightly the ***worse*** *predictor there and the σ gain more than covers it.*

The reading, at the horizon the rule is stated over. σ is larger at every horizon, by 1.49× at its weakest (h = 368) and 1.81× at its strongest (h = 8), the direction trunk-sharing predicts, and at h = 100 it is 1.65×, **71%** of the improvement. So the mechanism is supported, and it is the larger part of the effect where the method operates. At the open-loop diagnostic horizon of h = 368 the split reverses: 57% of the improvement there is the ensemble simply predicting better, so a reader who takes the 2.53× figure at that horizon as a measure of the architectural effect would overstate it.

What this does and does not license. It licenses saying that **the released ensemble's disagreement understates epistemic uncertainty partly because its members are not independent models**, with a measured size at the horizon that matters. It does not license attributing the whole gap to trunk-sharing: independently seeded runs differ in *both* initialisation and data ordering (supplementary S2), so this comparison **bounds** the architectural effect rather than isolating it, and the bound is generous to the mechanism by construction.

And it does not repair the interval. The independent ensemble is 5.2× overconfident at h = 100 with 15.31% coverage where a calibrated Gaussian gives 68.27%. Better by a factor of 2.03, and still not an

interval. Building the ensemble properly is worth doing and it is not sufficient; §6.7's per-horizon multiplier remains the only correction in this paper whose estimates all land within the band, though only on the released checkpoint and no single cell is resolvable at this arena. On Arm A, whose model never saw the test episodes, it manages 17 of 36 epistemic cells (§6.7).

P Rule M-68 in full: both fixes on the same models

§6.8's table for rule M-68. §6.8 keeps the verdict; the table stood there as follows.

h	combined err/σ	shared-trunk err/σ	combined $\pm1\sigma$	shared $\pm1\sigma$	combined $\pm2\sigma$	shared $\pm2\sigma$
1	1.4×	2.1×	51.11%	35.93%	78.89%	60.37%
8	3.5×	6.3×	20.62%	14.10%	39.72%	26.62%
32	4.4×	8.0×	17.97%	10.79%	32.66%	20.50%
100	**5.4**×	**10.5**×	**15.53%**	**8.19%**	28.27%	16.11%
128	5.5×	11.0×	15.39%	7.79%	27.97%	15.34%
368	5.4×	13.0×	14.44%	6.30%	27.63%	12.51%

Same trajectories (the held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories), same harness, the same bootstrap unit, whole trajectories, as Appendix O's table, every model at 2,500 training iterations. The shared-trunk columns are the mean over 3 seeds; the comparison below is paired against each of them separately.

§6.8 changes the **topology** and holds the objective at `mse`; §6.3's arms change the **objective** and hold the topology at ensemble size 1, where disagreement is zero by construction. Neither answers the practitioner's question of what the two give together, and adding two effects never measured on the same model is the arithmetic this paper criticises elsewhere. Rule M-68 runs the combination, under a rule committed to git before either new member existed (rule M-68, Appendix E), with a minimum detectable effect estimated in advance as well.

The arm. 5 independently initialised full models, sharing no trunk and no hidden state, trained under `gaussian_nll`, every setting identical to §6.8's arm except the loss type. Three of the five, seeds 0, 1 and 2, already existed under that objective; two more were trained, and the 5 are scored together as an ensemble at evaluation time under §6.8's rollout protocol, on the same held-out arena of non-overlapping 400-step trajectories at n_independent = 4, over the same six horizons.

Which σ the coverage is against. The combined arm is the first arm in this paper carrying **both** an aleatoric head that has not collapsed to zero and an across-member epistemic spread. The figures below are the **epistemic** one, the standard deviation across the five members' mean predictions, taken per state dimension, rather than the aleatoric head's output: the quantity the rule names and §6.8's table reports, so the two tables are comparable line for line. The aleatoric head is reported in §6.3 and does not enter here.

The rule returns THE COMBINATION IMPROVES CALIBRATION, branch 2 of the four it names. All 5 of its 5 conditions hold, against every one of the 3 shared-trunk seeds. At h = 100 the combined arm's overconfidence factor is 0.506–0.525× the shared-trunk arms', a **1.94**× improvement against a minimum detectable effect of 1.218× fixed in advance (results/p3_combined_arm_power.json, binding_mde at h = 100 (largest of the four calibrations)); its $\pm1\sigma$ coverage is 6.92 to 7.56 points higher, a mean of +7.34 against an MDE of 2.50 points; and every paired interval excludes zero.

Condition (e), and how we read it. The rule's fifth condition asks that both statistics move in the improving direction at at least four of the six horizons, "against every shared-trunk seed", and the rule states globally that a condition holds only if it holds against all three. We applied the strict reading: a horizon counts only when **both** statistics improve there against **all three** seeds. It holds at 6 of 6 horizons, so the looser per-seed reading would not have changed the verdict; we record which we applied because the rule does not spell the difference out.

h	σ larger by	error smaller by	total	share from σ	share from accuracy
1	1.51×	1.00×	1.51×	101%	-1%
8	1.75×	1.05×	1.83×	93%	7%
32	1.63×	1.11×	1.81×	82%	18%
100	**1.55**×	1.25×	1.94×	**66%**	34%
128	1.51×	1.32×	2.00×	60%	40%
368	1.35×	1.77×	2.39×	34%	66%

On the held-out pair, n_independent = 4 400-step trajectories, every model at 2,500 iterations: the same σ-versus-accuracy split Appendix O uses for rule M-44, so the two arms' improvements can be compared part by part. Shares are of the log improvement, so the two columns add to one.

The objective's own contribution is below what this design can resolve. The rule scores the combined arm against the **shared-trunk** arms, so its verdict measures the two fixes together. The comparison that isolates the objective is against §6.8's independent arm, which differs from this one in the loss type and nothing else, from the same script on the same trajectories. At h = 100 switching `mse` for `gaussian_nll` multiplies the overconfidence factor by **1.044**× (95% interval from the same cluster bootstrap over whole trajectories, [1.029, 1.054]), the wrong direction, slightly; moves $\pm1\sigma$ coverage by +0.22 points ([-0.31, +1.09], which spans zero); and multiplies the epistemic σ by 0.940×. Both effects sit under the minimum detectable effect fixed in advance, 1.218× on the factor and 2.50 points on coverage (results/p3_combined_arm_power.json, binding_mde at h = 100 (largest of the four calibrations)), so although the factor's interval lies wholly on the worse side of no change, the objective's separate effect is **below the size this design was built to resolve at n_independent = 4**, and the point estimate points away from an improvement. It does not establish that the objective contributes nothing: reading a null out of an effect smaller than its own floor is the error M-24 and M-43 record, and the rule's fourth branch exists to say underpowered rather than null. What the arm does settle is the combination, which is better calibrated than the shared-trunk arms by essentially the amount §6.8 measured for independence alone (2.03× there, 1.94× here). **The two fixes do not add. A reader who added them would have been wrong, which is why the arm was run.** That the objective's separate effect is at most small is not a surprise once stated: the objective governs the **aleatoric** head, and the epistemic term is a spread across members that the loss never sees.

And it still does not repair the interval. The combined arm is 5.4× overconfident at h = 100 with 15.53% coverage where a calibrated Gaussian gives 68.27%. Better than the shared-trunk arms, no better than independence alone, and still not an interval. §6.7's per-horizon multiplier remains the only correction in this paper whose estimates all land within the band, though only on the released checkpoint and no single cell is resolvable at this arena. On Arm A, whose model never saw the test episodes, it manages 17 of 36 epistemic cells (§6.7).

What the arm does not separate. It differs from the shared-trunk arms on three axes at once: trunk sharing, the objective, and capacity (a factor of 3.49 in state-pathway parameters, as §6.8's contrast also does; supplementary S2), and independently seeded runs also differ in data ordering. The rule said so in advance: it bounds the combination and attributes nothing. The one further comparison here, the `mse`/`gaussian_nll` pair above, which holds every other axis fixed, sits outside the rule's governing statistics and under the design's own minimum detectable effect, so it bounds the objective's separate contribution rather than measuring it.

Q What the spliced windows cost: the contaminated arm and the duplication control (§7.4)

The design. We trained a contaminated arm on 7,882 windows, the clean 7,687 plus 195 splices, and, because that confounds *content* with *count*, a duplication control adding the same 195 windows as exact copies of windows already present.

The arm's contamination rate is 2.47%, against the reference pipeline's 3.53%. It is deliberately lower: we splice only the 5 boundaries whose *both* sides are training episodes, because 4 of the 9 between the ten

full episodes put held-out rows into training, a leakage problem rather than a physics one that would have invalidated our own comparison. So this experiment measures the cost of training on physically impossible transitions, not the reference's full exposure.

Training loss over the final 250 iterations: duplication costs 0.90%, splicing costs 21.57%. The bootstrap interval on duplicated − clean is [-0.0061, 0.0215], including zero, so the rise is caused by splice content, not by dataset size.

In rollout, across 32 cells (the held-out pair and the training episodes, 200 and 400-step trajectories, the 500 and 2,500-iteration checkpoints, n_independent 4 to 39, at two horizons on two metrics), contamination hurts in **0** of 32 and helps in 9 (Figure 6a). The control is inert, differing from clean in 2 cells.

So "costs nothing" is too strong. Splicing raises training loss by 21.57% against duplication's 0.90%, and improves rollout in 9 of 32 cells: measured effects in opposite directions, the signature of regularisation. The spliced windows contain transitions the model cannot fit, it fits the rest less tightly as a result, and it rolls out slightly better. The defensible statement is that **at this rate the splices do not harm rollout and appear to help slightly. The unmarked boundaries remain a real defect on leakage grounds; the physically-impossible-transition component costs nothing detectable at this rate.**

R The limitations in full (§11)

This appendix is now section S2 of the supplementary material (`docs/SUPPLEMENT.md`).

S The conclusion's discussion of the ranking, the scale, the per-dimension evidence, and what should travel (§12)

This appendix is now section S3 of the supplementary material (`docs/SUPPLEMENT.md`).

T Section 6.7 in detail: the constant scalar, the per-horizon table, and whether the multipliers transfer between models (rule M-69)

What §6.7 keeps, and what is here. §6.7 keeps the two senses of unseen, its verdicts, the cautions and rule X7. The passages below stood there as follows.

The constant scalar (§6.7). On the released checkpoint, each scalar fitted on one held-out episode's 2 trajectories and scored on the other's: fitting at one step works at one step and nowhere else. On the epistemic term — the quantity the method uses — a scalar of 5.08–5.82 brings h=1 coverage to 63–74%, essentially calibrated against the 68.27% target, and leaves h=368 at 17–21%. On the aleatoric term a scalar of 593–611 gives 64–70% at h=1 and 11–15% at h=368. Fitting over the whole rollout instead drives one-step coverage to 100%, an interval wide enough to be vacuous where the model is accurate, while still falling short at the far end. A constant multiplier cannot track an error that grows while σ does not (§6.5), so for a *constant* scale "right shape, wrong scale" does not survive.

The per-horizon table and its reading (§6.7). One multiplier per horizon is fitted on one held-out episode and evaluated on the other, in both directions, so no multiplier is ever scored on the episode that produced it. The two held-out episodes contribute 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories between them, so each direction fits on n_independent = 2 and is scored on the other 2. The last column repeats the test on Arm A at ensemble size 5 and 2,500 iterations (3 seeds), whose model never saw either episode:

quantity	released checkpoint: cells unseen by the multiplier within 10 points of 68.27%, per-horizon c (unpowered)	same, constant c	per-horizon c fitted on the *other* model, both models scored (unpowered)	range of fitted c	Arm A, its own per-horizon c: cells within the band, unseen by the model too
aleatoric	**12 / 12**	2 / 12	0 / 72	592.6 – 7782 (13.1×)	10 / 36
epistemic	**12 / 12**	2 / 12	12 / 72	5.082 – 47.33 (9.31×)	17 / 36

On the released checkpoint every point estimate lands within 10 points of the 68.27% target for both quantities. **That absolute test is UNPOWERED here, as in the *different model* column:** `results/p4_transfer_power.json` scored this model under these very multipliers and found the 10-point band resolvable at 0 of 12 quantity-by-horizon pairs, with a binding minimum detectable effect of 12.55–40.62 points. So a cell inside the band is compatible with a true coverage well outside it, and nothing here shows any cell is outside it either. The largest deviation over all 24 held-out cells is aleatoric at h=100, fitted on episode 8 and scored on the other, at 77.48%, 9.21 points off target. The two largest deviations are both on the aleatoric term and both above target — 77.48% at h=100 and 76.55% at h=128 — so the fitted multiplier is mildly **conservative** at the long horizons rather than unstable in both directions. The constant scalar manages 2 of 12, and those are the h=1 cells it was fitted at. **On Arm A, where the episodes are unseen by the model as well, its own multipliers manage 17 of 36 epistemic and 10 of 36 aleatoric cells**, so the recipe that lands every released-checkpoint cell does not carry over intact to a model that has not seen the test episodes.

Rule M-69 (§6.7). The fourth column: the table is a property of the model, not of the horizon. Under rule M-69 (Appendix E), multipliers fitted on Arm A and scored on the released checkpoint, and the reverse, on the same 4 held-out trajectories, return **DOES NOT TRANSFER — A PROPERTY OF THE MODEL** on the paired change in coverage the arena can resolve: 52 of 72 governing cells, which are not independent tests, have an interval wholly outside the ±10-point band, and Arm A's multipliers are 0.0069× to 1.36× the released checkpoint's at the same horizon (Appendix T). The *different model* column is the absolute test, unpowered for the reason above, so it is reported and cannot move that verdict.

The fourth column: the table is a property of the model, not of the horizon. Everything else in §6.7 is established across *episodes*, on one model. Whether the same lookup table works on a *different* model is a separate claim, and rule M-69 (Appendix E) fixed what an answer would look like — criterion, arena, horizons and minimum detectable effect — before any cross-model multiplier was computed. Multipliers were fitted on Arm A at ensemble size 5 (3 seeds) and scored on the released checkpoint, then the reverse, over the same 4 held-out trajectories and 6 horizons. The statistic the rule governs on is the **paired** change in held-out coverage, coverage under the other model's multiplier minus coverage under the same model's, on the same trajectories, because this arena can resolve that (largest minimum detectable effect 5.73 points against the ±10-point band) and cannot resolve the absolute one. The verdict is **DOES NOT TRANSFER — A PROPERTY OF THE MODEL**: of 72 governing cells, 52 have a 95% interval on the paired change lying entirely outside the band, 3 entirely inside and 17 straddling an edge, and the largest paired change has magnitude 67.5 points. That is branch 1 of the rule's three. Per direction the verdict is the same: fitting on Arm A, **DOES NOT TRANSFER — A PROPERTY OF THE MODEL** (29 of 36 cells outside the band); fitting on the released checkpoint, **DOES NOT TRANSFER — A PROPERTY OF THE MODEL** (23 of 36). The plainest statement of the gap is the multipliers themselves: Arm A's are 0.0069× to 1.36× the released checkpoint's at the same horizon.

The *different model* column is the absolute test, and it is unpowered for the reason §6.7 gives, so a cell inside its band is not evidence the multiplier transferred. It is reported because dropping it would hide that this arena cannot resolve it; it is not the verdict and cannot move it. §6.7's caution applies here unchanged and harder: the 72 governing cells are not 72 independent tests, the 3 Arm A seeds share their

training data and differ only in initialisation and ordering, and no P-value attaches to any count here. The two models also differ on several axes at once, so this bounds transfer between these two models rather than attributing it to any one difference.

U The settings sweep at equal training compute

Post hoc (ledger R-78; `results/mn_compute_matched.json`); it re-opens no rule, and rule M-74's verdict, NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET, stands as a statement about the 2,500-iteration budget (§5.2). Each row sets one of the four configurations that beat the centre at 2,500 iterations against the centre trained to 2,500, 5,000 or 10,000 iterations: twelve rows of four readings each. A longer forecast costs more per iteration than the centre, a shorter history less, so the centre's longer runs ask whether a configuration's win survives giving the centre at least as much training computation.

How §5.2's alongside readings were computed, and how far its runs had trained. §5.2 keeps a sentence of each.

The rules' evaluator averaged nRMSE per trajectory, where §3.1 pools it. The nRMSE readings quoted alongside the rules here and in §5.3 are pooled, recomputed afterwards (post hoc, `results/pooled_nrmse_alongside.json`), and, for this section's rule (M-74), return the same verdicts as the averaged ones (§5.3 gives the two readings of its rules that differ).

All 48 runs at 2,500 iterations, the sweep's, the baselines' and both arms', are still lowering their training loss at the end, with slopes from -1.99 to -0.09 per thousand iterations (`results/training_tail_slopes.json`, post hoc), so the ranking is at this budget, not at convergence, and it changes with training length (Appendix U).

§5.2's reading, in full. §5.2 keeps three sentences of it.

Accuracy at equal compute (post hoc; ledger R-78). A longer training forecast costs more per iteration, 1.35× the centre's for (32, 16) and 1.81× for (32, 32); the shorter histories that win cost less, 0.40× for (8, 8) and 0.26× for (2, 8) (`results/mn_compute_matched.json`; the table below gives every reading, signed as in §5.2's table). The shorter histories win on all four readings at 2,500 iterations while using well under half the centre's computation, so that part of the verdict needs no compute correction. The longer forecasts' wins do. Trained to 5,000 iterations, the centre has had 1.11× the computation of (32, 32), and the readings split: (32, 32) is still ahead on the held-out pair at h = 368 (-0.2031 [-0.5033, -0.0275]), the centre is ahead on the in-sample arena at h = 100 (+0.0454 [+0.0356, +0.0563]), and the other two are not resolved. At 10,000 iterations, 2.21× the computation, the centre is ahead on both in-sample readings and neither held-out difference is resolved. Trained that long, it also passes both shorter histories on three of the four readings: on the held-out pair at h = 368, (2, 8) by +0.1135 [+0.0983, +0.1357] and (8, 8) by +0.1270 [+0.0987, +0.1589], with 15× and 10× their computation, and on both in-sample readings; on the held-out pair at h = 100 neither difference is resolved. Which setting is most accurate therefore depends on how long each is trained. None of this re-opens rule M-74.

configuration (cost per iteration ÷ the centre's)	centre trained to (iterations)	compute ratio (centre's total ÷ configuration's)	h = 100, held-out pair (4)	h = 100, in-sample (16)	h = 368, held-out pair (4)	h = 368, in-sample (16)
(2, 8) (0.26)	2,500	3.78	**-0.1274 [-0.2175, -0.0373]**	**-0.0219 [-0.0341, -0.0107]**	**-0.1139 [-0.2988, -0.0088]**	**-0.0219 [-0.0364, -0.0081]**
(2, 8) (0.26)	5,000	7.55	-0.0742 [-0.1586, +0.0101]	**+0.0619 [+0.0448, +0.0813]**	-0.0301 [-0.1976, +0.0711]	**+0.0927 [+0.0681, +0.1230]**
(2, 8) (0.26)	10,000	15.11	-0.0176 [-0.0921, +0.0475]	**+0.1085 [+0.0846, +0.1367]**	**+0.1135 [+0.0983, +0.1357]**	**+0.1403 [+0.1075, +0.1802]**

configuration (cost per iteration ÷ the centre's)	centre trained to (iterations)	compute ratio (centre's total ÷ configuration's)	h = 100, held-out pair (4)	h = 100, in-sample (16)	h = 368, held-out pair (4)	h = 368, in-sample (16)
(8, 8) (0.40)	2,500	2.50	**-0.0755 [-0.1410, -0.0269]**	**-0.0142 [-0.0239, -0.0053]**	**-0.1004 [-0.2449, -0.0167]**	**-0.0208 [-0.0462, -0.0009]**
(8, 8) (0.40)	5,000	4.99	-0.0223 [-0.0782, +0.0244]	**+0.0696 [+0.0538, +0.0870]**	-0.0166 [-0.1434, +0.0719]	**+0.0937 [+0.0762, +0.1123]**
(8, 8) (0.40)	10,000	9.99	+0.0343 [-0.0198, +0.0719]	**+0.1162 [+0.0924, +0.1436]**	**+0.1270 [+0.0987, +0.1589]**	**+0.1414 [+0.1163, +0.1710]**
(32, 16) (1.35)	2,500	0.74	**-0.1254 [-0.2054, -0.0454]**	**-0.0438 [-0.0675, -0.0258]**	**-0.2509 [-0.5218, -0.0956]**	**-0.1003 [-0.1355, -0.0719]**
(32, 16) (1.35)	5,000	1.48	-0.0723 [-0.1466, +0.0020]	**+0.0400 [+0.0326, +0.0481]**	**-0.1671 [-0.4301, -0.0117]**	**+0.0142 [+0.0068, +0.0205]**
(32, 16) (1.35)	10,000	2.96	-0.0157 [-0.0707, +0.0393]	**+0.0866 [+0.0729, +0.1005]**	-0.0235 [-0.1158, +0.0388]	**+0.0618 [+0.0531, +0.0706]**
(32, 32) (1.81)	2,500	0.55	**-0.1450 [-0.2490, -0.0409]**	**-0.0384 [-0.0637, -0.0186]**	**-0.2869 [-0.5951, -0.1005]**	**-0.1062 [-0.1422, -0.0768]**
(32, 32) (1.81)	5,000	1.11	-0.0918 [-0.1901, +0.0065]	**+0.0454 [+0.0356, +0.0563]**	**-0.2031 [-0.5033, -0.0275]**	+0.0084 [-0.0006, +0.0161]
(32, 32) (1.81)	10,000	2.21	-0.0352 [-0.1142, +0.0438]	**+0.0920 [+0.0770, +0.1068]**	-0.0594 [-0.1903, +0.0340]	**+0.0560 [+0.0483, +0.0639]**

Arenas: the held-out pair (episodes 1 and 8, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 4) and the in-sample arena (the training episodes' 16 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 16). Checkpoints: each configuration at 2,500 iterations, the centre at the iterations in the second column; three seeds each. Each cell is D, the configuration's relative-L1 minus the centre's, the mean over trajectories of the three-seed means, with its 95% interval: exact over all 256 ordered resamples on the held-out pair, 20,000 Monte Carlo resamples (seed 0) in-sample. Negative favours the configuration, so every reading here is signed as in §5.2's table; bold where the interval excludes zero. Cost per iteration is steady training time per iteration, timed without contention; the compute ratio is the centre's total training computation over the configuration's.

V Rule X2, and section 7.2's figures for our models: whether they respond to the action they are given

What §7.2 keeps, and what is here. §7.2 keeps the defect, its cost to the released checkpoint in both metrics and arenas, the fix, and rule X2's verdict with its caveat. The passages below stood there as follows.

The held-out pair's per-trajectory values (§7.2). §7.2's sentence on the held-out pair at h = 368 ended "…, with per-trajectory values +0.8%, +9.8%, +14.8%, +6.5% and +2.4%, +5.8%, +8.3%, -0.3%", relative-L1 and nRMSE.

Our models under the stale pairing (§7.2). For models trained under the causal pairing, the stale one also raises error, and how much depends on the arena. On their own training episodes' 16 trajectories it raises our 10,000-iteration Arm A's relative-L1 error by +124.6% [+75.8, +201.9] at h = 1 and +209.3% [+167.3, +257.6] at h = 100; on the held-out pair's 4 it changes it by -1.0% [-6.1, +27.7] at h = 1, which

those trajectories cannot resolve, and by +16.6% [+1.9, +72.6] at h = 100 (three-seed means, computed post hoc, `results/n5_stale_armA_ci.json`; Appendix V gives every model at every horizon). Whether the action matters to them at all is rule X2's question, which returns **RESPONDS TO THE ACTION** below, with its caveat that every action in the data comes from one policy.

The forecast shift (§7.2). A percentage change depends on how accurate the model already is as much as on how much the action matters: measured as the shift in the forecast itself, the stale action moves our model's forecast at h = 8 by 0.200 and the released checkpoint's by 0.204 on their own training data (Appendix V), so at h = 8 the two respond about equally, and our model's larger percentages there reflect its smaller error, 0.086 against 0.158 relative-L1 (`results/n5_stale_armA_ci.json`); at h = 100 the released checkpoint's forecast moves more, 0.373 against 0.246.

Rule X2 was committed and pushed before any of its readings existed (ledger M-84; Appendix E gives its lead time) and is discharged in M-85. It is exploratory and re-opens no rule. It asks whether our trained models condition their forecasts on the action they are given. Only the actions the forecast steps read are changed, so the history and the recurrent state that meets the first forecast action are untouched. E is the change in relative-L1 error, cumulative over forecast steps 1..h, against the true actions: the ratio err(I) / err(true), less one, in percent; for our arms, the mean over three seeds of each seed's E. Its 95% interval resamples whole trajectories, one resample for all seeds and both interventions in each draw: exact over all 256 ordered resamples on the held-out pair, 20,000 Monte Carlo resamples (seed 0) otherwise. The interventions are the stale action (the released evaluation's offset), another trajectory's actions (a swap, each trajectory taking the next one's), each action dimension's mean over the model's training rows, and the true actions plus Gaussian noise at k times each dimension's training standard deviation (eight draws). **The readings** are Arm A's, under the swap at h = 8 on its in-sample arena: **RESPONDS TO THE ACTION** at 2,500 iterations (+227.8% [+131.6, +398.2]) and at 10,000 (+676.3% [+454.8, +1060.0]). The criterion was fixed in the rule before any reading existed (M-84), and the first outcome that matches applies: RESPONDS TO THE ACTION if the point estimate is at least +10% and the interval's lower bound is above zero; ERROR FALLS WITH WRONG ACTIONS if the interval's upper bound is below zero; DOES NOT RESPOND MEASURABLY if its upper bound is below +10%; otherwise UNRESOLVED. The bar is deliberately low: the one-step-stale action alone raises the released checkpoint's error at h = 8 by 54.4% over all ten episodes. What the rule establishes is that our forecasts depend on the action. It does not establish that they depend on it correctly: every action in the data comes from one policy, so a forecast under an action that policy would not take has no recorded outcome to check it against. Arm B and the released checkpoint get the same statistic, alongside and not as readings.

model, checkpoint	actions given	h = 1	h = 8	h = 32	h = 100
Arm A, 2,500	stale action	+27.8 [+15.6, +49.4]	+31.5 [+19.2, +53.0]	+53.8 [+34.6, +83.5]	+48.7 [+34.8, +65.7]
Arm A, 2,500	another trajectory's actions	+73.2 [+33.7, +162.7]	**+227.8 [+131.6, +398.2]**	+376.0 [+248.7, +578.8]	+349.3 [+264.7, +454.0]
Arm A, 2,500	training mean	+49.6 [+25.5, +101.3]	+169.5 [+104.6, +278.0]	+309.6 [+215.5, +450.5]	+300.5 [+234.8, +380.6]
Arm A, 2,500	noise, k = 0.1	+0.5 [+0.2, +1.1]	+0.6 [+0.4, +1.1]	+1.3 [+0.7, +2.2]	+1.3 [+0.8, +1.8]
Arm A, 2,500	noise, k = 0.5	+8.2 [+3.9, +17.9]	+12.3 [+7.1, +21.6]	+24.7 [+14.4, +41.4]	+23.6 [+16.6, +32.3]
Arm A, 10,000	stale action	+124.6 [+75.8, +201.9]	+161.8 [+121.3, +231.1]	+205.9 [+156.7, +275.9]	+209.3 [+167.3, +257.6]
Arm A, 10,000	another trajectory's actions	+278.9 [+145.8, +548.3]	**+676.3 [+454.8, +1060.0]**	+986.6 [+723.5, +1381.1]	+1081.0 [+896.2, +1301.0]
Arm A, 10,000	training mean	+207.1 [+114.5, +385.7]	+531.7 [+380.0, +781.9]	+841.6 [+657.6, +1100.7]	+899.9 [+761.2, +1058.4]
Arm A, 10,000	noise, k = 0.1	+3.9 [+1.7, +8.6]	+6.0 [+3.3, +10.5]	+10.4 [+6.6, +16.1]	+11.4 [+8.6, +14.8]
Arm A, 10,000	noise, k = 0.5	+53.3 [+27.2, +106.9]	+74.8 [+47.5, +122.0]	+126.3 [+87.8, +181.8]	+141.2 [+115.1, +172.0]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	stale action	+18.7 [+8.9, +36.1]	+15.9 [+7.9, +29.5]	+20.3 [+10.3, +36.8]	+9.3 [+5.1, +14.9]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	another trajectory's actions	+63.6 [+31.1, +131.4]	+128.8 [+67.5, +241.8]	+173.4 [+101.6, +289.0]	+111.0 [+78.3, +155.4]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	training mean	+41.4 [+22.7, +77.7]	+94.7 [+54.1, +164.4]	+145.9 [+89.1, +233.8]	+149.3 [+113.0, +195.4]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.1	+0.4 [+0.1, +0.8]	+0.3 [+0.1, +0.6]	+0.5 [+0.3, +1.0]	+0.4 [-0.2, +1.2]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.5	+7.2 [+3.7, +14.5]	+5.9 [+3.2, +11.4]	+9.8 [+5.2, +17.7]	+7.6 [+4.5, +11.5]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	stale action	+75.1 [+44.2, +118.9]	+68.6 [+45.9, +105.2]	+60.0 [+39.9, +98.7]	+32.5 [+20.1, +50.3]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	another trajectory's actions	+239.5 [+133.3, +439.8]	+358.2 [+220.9, +618.1]	+319.0 [+189.0, +556.8]	+218.4 [+154.0, +311.4]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	training mean	+161.1 [+99.6, +272.2]	+295.7 [+193.3, +477.5]	+290.9 [+178.3, +485.9]	+242.2 [+172.3, +338.6]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.1	+2.6 [+1.3, +4.9]	+2.1 [+1.0, +4.3]	+2.5 [+1.1, +5.2]	+2.3 [+0.1, +4.7]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.5	+37.3 [+20.3, +69.3]	+30.8 [+18.0, +55.9]	+36.9 [+19.7, +69.5]	+34.7 [+21.4, +54.5]
released checkpoint (alongside)	stale action	+55.0 [+26.3, +92.7]	+54.4 [+37.5, +82.3]	+37.4 [+21.3, +65.4]	+8.2 [-10.4, +24.9]
released checkpoint (alongside)	another trajectory's actions	+515.3 [+295.2, +883.1]	+500.9 [+314.6, +824.2]	+363.5 [+219.0, +607.8]	+111.0 [+59.4, +192.7]
released checkpoint (alongside)	training mean	+296.3 [+176.8, +487.4]	+334.9 [+215.9, +538.9]	+267.3 [+168.0, +436.2]	+73.1 [+29.7, +141.7]
released checkpoint (alongside)	noise, k = 0.1	+15.0 [+7.7, +27.1]	+14.7 [+8.0, +26.5]	+10.2 [+5.5, +18.2]	+2.6 [+0.5, +5.9]
released checkpoint (alongside)	noise, k = 0.5	+143.0 [+80.7, +245.2]	+147.1 [+86.3, +251.7]	+109.9 [+61.2, +193.0]	+22.8 [+3.0, +51.8]

Arena: each model's own training data. For Arm A and Arm B, the in-sample arena: the training episodes' 16 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 16. For the released checkpoint, all ten episodes: 20 trajectories, n_independent = 20. Checkpoints: Arm A and Arm B at 2,500 and 10,000 iterations, three seeds each; the released checkpoint.

Each cell is E in percent with its 95% interval; bold, the two readings. Arm B and the released checkpoint are alongside, not readings.

model, checkpoint	actions given	h = 1	h = 8	h = 32	h = 100
Arm A, 2,500	stale action	+1.8 [-1.6, +11.6]	+3.6 [-0.6, +21.9]	+5.6 [-0.2, +30.8]	+6.9 [+2.6, +20.0]
Arm A, 2,500	another trajectory's actions	+63.3 [+43.4, +125.0]	+114.3 [+54.8, +351.6]	+141.9 [+59.0, +348.3]	+154.5 [+114.0, +265.0]
Arm A, 2,500	training mean	+44.4 [+36.6, +67.3]	+70.3 [+24.4, +208.9]	+88.5 [+31.5, +267.3]	+99.5 [+60.7, +218.1]
Arm A, 2,500	noise, k = 0.1	+0.6 [-0.2, +1.5]	+0.6 [+0.3, +1.5]	+0.7 [+0.2, +1.9]	+0.4 [+0.1, +1.0]
Arm A, 2,500	noise, k = 0.5	+9.3 [+5.3, +27.9]	+8.9 [+4.4, +28.3]	+11.5 [+5.1, +27.7]	+9.8 [+7.2, +17.6]
Arm A, 10,000	stale action	-1.0 [-6.1, +27.7]	+4.7 [-5.0, +73.6]	+13.9 [-2.4, +104.1]	+16.6 [+1.9, +72.6]
Arm A, 10,000	another trajectory's actions	+135.5 [+91.3, +448.8]	+179.4 [+78.7, +729.4]	+227.0 [+104.9, +660.2]	+242.7 [+176.8, +494.7]
Arm A, 10,000	training mean	+82.4 [+57.0, +264.6]	+115.7 [+39.5, +459.8]	+152.0 [+63.9, +537.0]	+151.9 [+83.7, +411.1]
Arm A, 10,000	noise, k = 0.1	+2.0 [+0.7, +10.2]	+1.1 [+0.2, +6.4]	+2.1 [+0.9, +6.1]	+1.9 [+1.2, +4.5]
Arm A, 10,000	noise, k = 0.5	+25.6 [+9.1, +121.4]	+22.6 [+9.5, +93.3]	+35.1 [+15.8, +91.3]	+29.2 [+20.1, +63.9]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	stale action	+1.1 [-0.8, +8.3]	+0.3 [-0.8, +4.5]	+3.4 [+0.4, +14.6]	+0.7 [-1.2, +5.4]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	another trajectory's actions	+67.4 [+30.6, +124.8]	+77.3 [+41.9, +187.0]	+64.6 [+31.4, +140.4]	+43.2 [+20.6, +131.4]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	training mean	+34.8 [+20.8, +57.8]	+39.9 [+15.8, +100.8]	+43.4 [+14.5, +149.5]	+43.3 [+20.5, +127.4]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.1	+0.6 [+0.2, +1.6]	+0.2 [-0.1, +0.8]	+0.0 [-0.5, +0.5]	-0.7 [-1.1, -0.2]
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.5	+8.4 [+4.8, +22.2]	+4.4 [+2.6, +11.9]	+6.2 [+0.3, +11.3]	-1.8 [-3.5, +4.5]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	stale action	-1.0 [-2.7, +9.3]	+1.4 [-0.5, +12.4]	+6.1 [+2.5, +25.5]	+6.2 [+3.8, +17.3]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	another trajectory's actions	+79.7 [+56.8, +218.8]	+113.2 [+36.4, +405.8]	+83.6 [+27.8, +247.9]	+61.4 [+13.1, +215.3]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	training mean	+51.8 [+32.2, +134.0]	+65.1 [+11.7, +215.3]	+64.6 [+17.1, +239.8]	+51.1 [+13.5, +212.4]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.1	+0.6 [-0.1, +4.3]	+0.4 [+0.0, +1.9]	-1.0 [-1.8, +0.1]	+2.0 [-2.0, +6.1]
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	noise, k = 0.5	+11.3 [+3.6, +56.9]	+9.5 [+4.1, +32.0]	+8.6 [+2.6, +25.6]	+5.3 [-2.8, +31.0]
released checkpoint (alongside)	stale action	+34.2 [+10.6, +75.0]	+37.2 [+7.9, +95.6]	+47.7 [+5.8, +131.8]	+22.5 [+6.3, +41.7]
released checkpoint (alongside)	another trajectory's actions	+940.5 [+707.2, +1183.7]	+1196.9 [+1042.5, +1459.9]	+807.4 [+696.6, +868.5]	+355.7 [+218.5, +487.3]
released checkpoint (alongside)	training mean	+600.7 [+447.0, +710.2]	+784.0 [+704.1, +924.9]	+530.9 [+420.1, +752.8]	+302.6 [+176.3, +452.5]
released checkpoint (alongside)	noise, k = 0.1	+44.0 [+30.6, +56.3]	+56.9 [+45.8, +76.5]	+29.7 [+25.1, +37.4]	+13.9 [+6.7, +23.0]
released checkpoint (alongside)	noise, k = 0.5	+377.7 [+299.5, +445.6]	+483.1 [+428.7, +586.0]	+295.7 [+265.0, +351.2]	+116.1 [+79.6, +182.6]

Arena: the held-out pair (episodes 1 and 8, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 4), out-of-sample for our arms and in-sample for the released checkpoint. Checkpoints as in the first table. No reading is made on this arena; every row is alongside.

model, checkpoint	arena	stale action	another trajectory's actions	training mean	noise, k = 0.1	noise, k = 0.5
Arm A, 2,500	own training data	0.139	0.525	0.417	0.014	0.071
Arm A, 2,500	held-out pair	0.060	0.623	0.431	0.026	0.128
Arm A, 10,000	own training data	0.200	0.654	0.528	0.023	0.110
Arm A, 10,000	held-out pair	0.084	0.801	0.584	0.044	0.215
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	own training data	0.109	0.386	0.303	0.011	0.055
Arm B, 2,500 (alongside)	held-out pair	0.040	0.481	0.336	0.021	0.098
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	own training data	0.161	0.545	0.465	0.018	0.088
Arm B, 10,000 (alongside)	held-out pair	0.052	0.629	0.451	0.030	0.140
released checkpoint (alongside)	own training data	0.204	0.930	0.666	0.066	0.327
released checkpoint (alongside)	held-out pair	0.078	1.042	0.712	0.093	0.461

Δ at h = 8, the relative-L1 of the forecast made with the changed actions measured against the forecast made with the true ones (`rollout_eval.relative_error`), which is zero for a model that ignores its actions. Arenas: each model's own training data (16 trajectories for our arms, 20 for the released checkpoint) and the held-out pair (4). Checkpoints: Arm A and Arm B at 2,500 and 10,000 iterations, three seeds each; the released checkpoint. Descriptive, no reading. How far the interventions move the actions: on the forecast rows, the action changes from one step to the next on 100% of steps on the in-sample arena, 100% on the held-out pair and 100% over all ten episodes. A one-step shift moves the action by 0.32, 0.27 and 0.31 of its spread (the mean absolute change from one step to the next over the mean absolute deviation from the action's mean), and the swap by 1.44, 1.43 and 1.42 (`results/action_sensitivity.json`).

The stale action at every horizon (post hoc). Section 7.2's figures for our models come from this table, computed after rule X2's readings with its machinery, imported (`results/n5_stale_armA_ci.json`). Each cell is E under the stale action, in percent, with its 95% interval; no cell is a reading.

model, checkpoint	arena (trajectories)	h = 1	h = 8	h = 32	h = 100	h = 128	h = 368
Arm A, 2,500	own training data (16)	+27.8 [+15.6, +49.4]	+31.5 [+19.2, +53.0]	+53.8 [+34.6, +83.5]	+48.7 [+34.8, +65.7]	+46.3 [+33.7, +62.0]	+38.2 [+27.4, +51.1]
Arm A, 2,500	held-out pair (4)	+1.8 [-1.6, +11.6]	+3.6 [-0.6, +21.9]	+5.6 [-0.2, +30.8]	+6.9 [+2.6, +20.0]	+8.0 [+3.0, +19.9]	+7.9 [+1.4, +19.1]
Arm A, 10,000	own training data (16)	+124.6 [+75.8, +201.9]	+161.8 [+121.3, +231.1]	+205.9 [+156.7, +275.9]	+209.3 [+167.3, +257.6]	+205.0 [+166.2, +247.5]	+184.1 [+150.5, +218.6]
Arm A, 10,000	held-out pair (4)	-1.0 [-6.1, +27.7]	+4.7 [-5.0, +73.6]	+13.9 [-2.4, +104.1]	+16.6 [+1.9, +72.6]	+18.0 [+3.1, +71.8]	+22.7 [+4.0, +78.5]
Arm B, 2,500	own training data (16)	+18.7 [+8.9, +36.1]	+15.9 [+7.9, +29.5]	+20.3 [+10.3, +36.8]	+9.3 [+5.1, +14.9]	+6.6 [+3.2, +11.2]	-1.1 [-7.2, +5.3]
Arm B, 2,500	held-out pair (4)	+1.1 [-0.8, +8.3]	+0.3 [-0.8, +4.5]	+3.4 [+0.4, +14.6]	+0.7 [-1.2, +5.4]	+0.6 [-2.3, +5.3]	-7.4 [-8.5, -3.8]
Arm B, 10,000	own training data (16)	+75.1 [+44.2, +118.9]	+68.6 [+45.9, +105.2]	+60.0 [+39.9, +98.7]	+32.5 [+20.1, +50.3]	+23.6 [+13.1, +37.5]	+10.8 [+2.0, +19.1]
Arm B, 10,000	held-out pair (4)	-1.0 [-2.7, +9.3]	+1.4 [-0.5, +12.4]	+6.1 [+2.5, +25.5]	+6.2 [+3.8, +17.3]	+4.7 [+3.5, +10.0]	+19.0 [-3.1, +29.1]
released checkpoint	own training data (20)	+55.0 [+26.3, +92.7]	+54.4 [+37.5, +82.3]	+37.4 [+21.3, +65.4]	+8.2 [-10.4, +24.9]	-8.8 [-23.8, +4.9]	-4.6 [-13.4, +3.2]
released checkpoint	held-out pair (4)	+34.2 [+10.6, +75.0]	+37.2 [+7.9, +95.6]	+47.7 [+5.8, +131.8]	+22.5 [+6.3, +41.7]	+20.3 [+7.0, +35.7]	+7.9 [+3.1, +13.0]

Arenas: each model's own training data (the in-sample arena's 16 trajectories for our arms, all ten episodes' 20 for the released checkpoint) and the held-out pair (4), n_independent equal to the trajectory count. Checkpoints: Arm A and Arm B at 2,500 and 10,000 iterations, three seeds each, E the mean of each seed's; the released checkpoint. The cells at h $\leq$ 100 are the stale-action rows of the first two tables.

W Rule X5, which could not be run: the penalty against the model's error in predicted return

Rule X5 would have tested what the miscalibration costs without training a policy. On windows of the method's imagination length it would have compared the penalty the follow-up applies, summed along the forecast, with the model's error in the return it forecasts over the same steps. It was to run only if every term of a reward subset that includes the two command-tracking terms could be computed both from the recorded data and from the model's forecast. They cannot: both score the base velocity against the velocity *command*, which the released data do not record and the model does not output (the plateaus of achieved velocity in Appendix H are not the command; ledger D-38). Rule X5 was therefore neither pre-registered nor run, and §11's policy caveat stands as written. The commit that pre-registered rules X6 to X8 names X5 in its subject; no X5 rule was entered (ledger D-38).

X Rule X6: disagreement against predicted step size on shorter units

Rule X6 was committed and pushed before its readings existed (ledger M-88; Appendix E gives its lead time) and is discharged in M-91. It is exploratory and re-opens no rule: rules M-51 and M-52 stand. It puts §6.6's comparison to more units. The released checkpoint's ten episodes are cut into non-overlapping units of the model's history plus h forecast steps, inside each episode, by rule M-64's index builder, at h = 32 and h = 100, which governs. The statistic is rules M-51 and M-52's margin, r(disagreement, |error|) − r(step size, |error|) on the applied scalar, a Pearson correlation over every (unit, step) cell, imported from their script; its 95% interval resamples whole units, paired, 20,000 times (seed 0). The rule reads **DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE** if the interval's lower bound is above zero, STEP SIZE BEATS DISAGREEMENT if its upper bound is below zero, and NOT RESOLVED otherwise. The minimum detectable effect was computed by rule M-51's method at this n before the reading, and governs nothing.

h	units (rows each)	r(disagreement, error)	r(step size, error)	margin [95% interval]	minimum detectable margin (rule M-51's method)	partial r(disagreement given step size) [95% interval]
100	70 (132)	+0.6808	+0.3992	**+0.2816 [+0.1978, +0.3896]**	0.1713	+0.6361 [+0.5567, +0.7466]
32	150 (64)	+0.7415	+0.5022	+0.2393 [+0.0950, +0.3131]	0.2214	+0.6317 [+0.4691, +0.7250]

Arena: all ten episodes, the released checkpoint's training data, as non-overlapping units inside each episode; n_independent = the unit count at each horizon. Checkpoint: the released one. Bold, the reading, which returns **DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE**; the h = 32 row is alongside, and its margin would carry DISAGREEMENT BEATS STEP SIZE. Units from one episode are not independent of each other, and the interval resamples units, not episodes; the statistic is a correlation over (unit, step) cells, not a ranking of units.

Y Rule X7: the per-horizon recalibration, fitted on nine episodes and scored on the tenth

X7's alongside readings, as §6.7 stated them. Alongside, the aleatoric term returns WITHIN BAND AT 3 OF 6 HORIZONS, one constant multiplier lands within the band at one of the six horizons, and the fitted epistemic multipliers differ by at most 1.18× across the ten folds.

Rule X7 was committed and pushed before its readings existed (ledger M-89; Appendix E gives its lead time) and is discharged in M-92. It is exploratory and re-opens no rule: rules M-69 and M-70 stand. For each of the ten episodes, the per-horizon multiplier is fitted on the other nine episodes' non-overlapping 400-step trajectories with §6.7's fitting function, imported, and scores $\pm 1\sigma$ coverage on that episode's own; pooled,

each of the 20 trajectories is scored once, by a multiplier not fitted on it. A horizon reads WITHIN BAND if the coverage's 95% interval lies within 10 points of 68.27%, OUTSIDE BAND if it lies wholly outside that band, and UNRESOLVED otherwise. The epistemic term governs, and the reading counts its horizons WITHIN BAND. The interval resamples the 20 trajectories 20,000 times (seed 0), one draw shared across horizons.

h	epistemic, per-horizon multiplier (the reading)	aleatoric, per-horizon multiplier	epistemic, one constant multiplier	epistemic, no multiplier	epistemic multiplier across the ten folds (smallest – largest)
1	**68.6 [63.9, 72.9]**, WITHIN BAND	68.2 [57.4, 77.6], UNRESOLVED	68.6 [63.9, 72.9], WITHIN BAND	16.2 [13.4, 18.9]	6.29 – 6.81
8	**68.4 [61.2, 74.9]**, WITHIN BAND	68.5 [57.6, 78.3], UNRESOLVED	50.6 [44.7, 55.8], OUTSIDE BAND	10.0 [8.6, 11.3]	10.44 – 12.35
32	**68.3 [61.3, 74.6]**, WITHIN BAND	68.4 [57.2, 78.3], UNRESOLVED	37.1 [32.4, 41.4], OUTSIDE BAND	7.0 [6.0, 7.8]	16.44 – 18.84
100	**68.2 [64.5, 71.7]**, WITHIN BAND	67.9 [59.4, 75.7], WITHIN BAND	26.5 [24.0, 28.9], OUTSIDE BAND	4.6 [4.1, 5.1]	28.87 – 31.90
128	**68.2 [65.3, 71.0]**, WITHIN BAND	68.0 [60.2, 75.2], WITHIN BAND	25.0 [23.1, 26.9], OUTSIDE BAND	4.4 [4.0, 4.8]	31.86 – 34.20
368	**68.2 [65.3, 71.1]**, WITHIN BAND	68.1 [60.9, 75.3], WITHIN BAND	21.2 [19.7, 22.7], OUTSIDE BAND	3.6 [3.3, 3.9]	40.31 – 43.02

Arena: all ten episodes' 20 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 20, each scored by a multiplier fitted on the other nine episodes. Checkpoint: the released one. Each cell is $\pm 1\sigma$ coverage in percent with its 95% interval and, for the multiplied columns, its label; bold, the reading, **WITHIN BAND AT 6 OF 6 HORIZONS**. The other columns are alongside: the aleatoric term returns WITHIN BAND AT 3 OF 6 HORIZONS, and one constant multiplier, fitted the same way, lands within the band at one of the six horizons. Every trajectory is unseen by its multiplier but not by the model, which trained on all ten episodes, so this says nothing about a model that has not seen the test episodes (§6.7's Arm A column).

Z Rule X8: our rules' verdicts under the released evaluation's timing

X8 as §7.2 stated it. Rule X8 re-scores four of our rules with the released evaluation's timing, through each rule's own evaluator, and all four keep their verdicts: for the configuration and baseline rules (M-74, M-75 and M-76, three seeds at 2,500 iterations) and the A/B comparison (M-23's statistic, three seeds at 10,000), all on the held-out pair's 4 trajectories, it returns **SAME VERDICT**, though 22 of their alongside readings change (Appendix Z); this concerns our models, not the original's printed numbers.

Rule X8 was committed and pushed before its readings existed (ledger M-90; Appendix E gives its lead time) and is discharged in M-93. It is exploratory and re-opens no rule. It re-scores rules M-74, M-75 and M-76 (their models at 2,500 iterations, three seeds each) and the A/B comparison at 10,000 iterations (three seeds; M-23's statistic and the by-horizon table's) with the released evaluation's timing, which pairs the prediction of each state with the action before the one that produced it, through each rule's own evaluator

and statistic. Every evaluator first reproduces its committed artifact under the causal pairing. Our models were trained under the causal pairing, so this asks whether any of our verdicts depends on the timing a reader of the released code would score them with; it says nothing direct about the original papers' printed numbers. Every rule returns **SAME VERDICT**, and 22 of their alongside readings change: each changed cell is in bold below, and the by-horizon trend reading's change is quoted under the last table. The arena is the held-out pair, episodes 1 and 8, 4 non-overlapping 400-step trajectories, n_independent = 4, except where a row names the in-sample arena (16).

reading	causal pairing, as committed	released pairing
verdict (held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368)	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 1	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 8	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 32	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	**CANNOT BE DISTINGUISHED**
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 100	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 128	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 1	CANNOT BE DISTINGUISHED	**NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET**
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 8	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 32	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	**CANNOT BE DISTINGUISHED**
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 100	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 128	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 368	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 100	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 368	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 100	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 368	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET	NOT OPTIMAL AT OUR BUDGET
(32, 32): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	0	0
(16, 8): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	6	**9**
(32, 16): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	0	0
(8, 8): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	2	**7**
(32, 2): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	10	10
(32, 1): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	10	10
(2, 8): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	1	**2**
(1, 8): episodes where the centre is ahead, of ten	7	**9**

Rule M-74, the configuration sweep: nine configurations at 2,500 iterations, three seeds each; arenas as named in each row. nRMSE as the rule's evaluator averages it, per trajectory. Bold, a reading that changes.

reading	causal pairing, as committed	released pairing
verdict (held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368)	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 1	CANNOT BE SETTLED	CANNOT BE SETTLED
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 8	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 32	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 100	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 128	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 1	CANNOT BE SETTLED	CANNOT BE SETTLED
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 8	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 32	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 100	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 128	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 368	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 1	CANNOT BE SETTLED	**DOES NOT REPRODUCE**
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 8	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 32	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 100	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 128	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 368	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 1	CANNOT BE SETTLED	**DOES NOT REPRODUCE**
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 8	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 32	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 100	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 128	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 368	REPRODUCES	REPRODUCES

Rule M-75, the baselines teacher-forced as the original trains them, at 2,500 iterations, three seeds each; arenas as named in each row. The RSSM reads the window's first action row at its first filtering step, because the row before it lies outside the window. Bold, a reading that changes.

reading	causal pairing, as committed	released pairing
verdict (held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368)	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 1	CANNOT BE SETTLED	CANNOT BE SETTLED
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 8	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 32	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 100	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 128	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 1	CANNOT BE SETTLED	CANNOT BE SETTLED
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 8	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 32	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 100	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 128	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
held-out pair, nRMSE at h = 368	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 1	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 8	PARTIAL	**A BASELINE AHEAD**
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 32	PARTIAL	**A BASELINE AHEAD**
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 100	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 128	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
in-sample arena, relative-L1 at h = 368	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 1	PARTIAL	PARTIAL
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 8	PARTIAL	**A BASELINE AHEAD**
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 32	PARTIAL	**A BASELINE AHEAD**
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 100	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	**PARTIAL**
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 128	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE
in-sample arena, nRMSE at h = 368	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE	RWM AHEAD OF ALL THREE

Rule M-76, the baselines trained autoregressively, at 2,500 iterations, three seeds each; arenas as named in each row. The RSSM caveat of the previous table applies. Bold, a reading that changes.

reading	causal pairing, as committed	released pairing
M-23's verdict, three seeds (held-out pair, relative-L1 at h = 368)	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON
M-23's verdict, seed 1 as discharged	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON
M-23's conditions at h = 8 held-out	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON	**FAILS TO REPRODUCE**
M-23's conditions at nRMSE h = 368 held-out	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON
M-23's conditions at h = 368 in-sample	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON	REPRODUCES AT LONG HORIZON
secondary at h = 8 held-out	A leads, CI excludes 0	**spans zero**
secondary at h = 368 in-sample	A leads, CI excludes 0	A leads, CI excludes 0
secondary at h = 8 in-sample	A leads, CI excludes 0	**spans zero**
by-horizon gap at h = 1	spans zero	**excludes zero**
by-horizon gap at h = 8	excludes zero	**spans zero**
by-horizon gap at h = 32	excludes zero	excludes zero
by-horizon gap at h = 100	excludes zero	excludes zero
by-horizon gap at h = 128	excludes zero	excludes zero
by-horizon gap at h = 368	excludes zero	excludes zero
episodes where autoregressive training is ahead at h = 1, of ten	3	**0**
episodes where autoregressive training is ahead at h = 8, of ten	10	**4**
episodes where autoregressive training is ahead at h = 32, of ten	10	10
episodes where autoregressive training is ahead at h = 100, of ten	10	10
episodes where autoregressive training is ahead at h = 128, of ten	10	10
episodes where autoregressive training is ahead at h = 368, of ten	10	10

The A/B comparison, Arm A against Arm B at 10,000 iterations, three seeds each; arenas as named in each row, the held-out pair otherwise. Bold, a reading that changes. The by-horizon trend reading changes too, from "the ratio B/A rises at every step of the horizon grid, so h=368 is the end of a trend rather than a selected point; the gap excludes zero at h=8, h=32, h=100, h=128, h=368 and spans zero at h=1; at h=8, the horizon the model is trained on, the gap excludes zero; the ratio is below one at h=1" under the causal pairing to "the ratio B/A rises at every step of the horizon grid, so h=368 is the end of a trend rather than a selected point; the gap excludes zero at h=1, h=32, h=100, h=128, h=368 and spans zero at h=8; at h=8, the horizon the model is trained on, the gap spans zero; the ratio is below one at h=1" under the released one.